The 2026 Midterm Election: A Documented Record

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A documented account of the November 3, 2026 United States midterm election — its races, its money, its violence, its law, its machinery, and the year that produced it. Compiled from 140 research dives conducted October 23–24, 2026. Every factual claim carries its source. Where claims conflict, both versions appear. Where evidence is false, debunked, or unverified, it is presented as evidence of what was claimed. The claim itself is part of the record.

How to Read This Document

Some terms of art appear throughout. Each is explained here once, in plain language, and used in that sense from then on.

Midterm election. In the American system, the president serves four years, but every member of the House of Representatives and roughly one-third of the Senate face the voters every two years. The election held midway through a presidential term is the *midterm*. On November 3, 2026, all 435 House seats, 35 Senate seats (33 regular plus two special elections), 36 governorships, roughly 6,100 state legislative seats, 145 statewide ballot measures, and thousands of local offices are on the ballot.

PVI. The Partisan Voting Index measures how a state or district leans politically compared to the country as a whole. "R+7" means the area voted about seven percentage points more Republican than the nation in recent elections. PVI is a thermometer, not a destiny.

Dark money. Political spending by nonprofit organizations that are not required to disclose their donors. Imagine a sealed envelope inside a sealed box: the box (the super PAC) must report what it spends, but the envelope inside it — the nonprofit that supplied the money — never has to say whose check it was.

Super PAC. A political committee that may raise and spend unlimited sums to advocate for or against candidates, but may not donate directly to them or coordinate with their

campaigns — at least, not until a 2026 Supreme Court decision loosened the coordination rules, which this document covers in its proper place.

501(c)(4). A type of nonprofit — "social welfare" organizations — that can spend heavily in politics without revealing donors. These are the sealed envelopes.

Conduit / earmarked giving. When a donor gives to a committee (like AIPAC's PAC) with instructions to pass it to a specific candidate, the recipient sees only the committee's name. The money arrives with the donor's fingerprints washed off.

Ranked-choice voting (RCV). Voters rank candidates in order of preference. If nobody wins a majority of first choices, the last-place candidate is eliminated and their voters' second choices are counted instead, repeating until someone has a majority. Maine uses this system for federal races; Alaska uses a variant. In 2026, Alaska is voting on whether to repeal it.

Certification. The formal, legally binding declaration of results by state authorities — distinct from election-night projections, which are news organizations' estimates. Only certified results confer office.

Recount. A second tabulation ordered when margins fall below state-defined triggers (automatic) or requested by candidates (petition). All fifty states differ; the document's research files carry the complete table.

Contested election. The constitutional procedure by which Congress itself judges its own members' elections — the backstop if a state count is disputed, last invoked at scale in the 1870s.

Naked ballot. A mail ballot returned without its required secrecy envelope. In Pennsylvania — which offers no statewide cure process — a naked ballot is discarded.

Discharge petition. A device by which a majority of the House forces a bill to a floor vote over leadership's objection. One such petition, forcing a congressional stock-trading ban toward a vote, became a campaign issue when signatories included members whose own trades were under scrutiny.

Cloture. The Senate's sixty-vote threshold to end debate on most legislation — the arithmetic behind every "49–50" vote in this document, since failing cloture means a bill never reaches final passage.

Trifecta. One party holding the governorship and both legislative chambers of a state — the prize in the state-legislative money war, because trifectas draw the maps.

Revolving door. The movement of officials and staff between government and the industries they regulate. The document's research files count 13,519 lobbyists with prior government service and 460 former members currently lobbying.

Insider trading / stock trading. Members of Congress may legally trade individual securities — the loophole every trading-ban bill in this document addresses. A blind trust is the disclosure-avoidance device in which an official's assets are managed without their knowledge; several members pledged blind trusts and later walked the pledges back, on the record.

Joint fundraising committee. A vehicle through which multiple campaigns or committees raise money together and split it by formula — supercharged by the 2026 Supreme Court

decision to allow effectively unlimited coordination.

Soft money. The pre-2002 category of unlimited party donations nominally for "party building," banned by the Bipartisan Campaign Reform Act and reborn through the dark-money channels described in this document.

AdImpact. The industry-standard advertising-tracking firm whose spending figures appear throughout this document; its projections and actuals are the campaign world's common yardstick.

Citizens United. The 2010 Supreme Court decision permitting corporations and unions to spend unlimited sums on independent political expenditures — the foundation on which the super PAC and 501(c)(4) architecture of Part V rests.

Pay-to-play. The exchange of campaign contributions for government action — the specific crime alleged in some files in this document and denied in all of them, none adjudicated before Election Day.

Filibuster. The practice of extended debate by which a minority blocks Senate action — preserved only by custom, and the object of reform proposals in both parties.

A note on sources and fairness. This document was assembled under a strict discipline: collect, don't adopt. When the administration says $260.7 billion in fraud was uncovered, that claim appears. When its critics document thousands of conflicts of interest, those appear too. When a poll shows one thing and a model shows another, both appear. Nothing in these pages decides for the reader which ledger is true. The reader decides. What the pages guarantee is that the evidence arrived

intact.

What a research dive is. This book was assembled from 140 research dives — 140 separate expeditions into the public record, conducted October 23–24, 2026. Here is what one dive looks like, so the number means something concrete. Each dive began with a target — a race, a network, a court case, a loose thread left open by the dive before it. It then ran two to four rounds of searching, asking the search engine four to eight questions in total: who funds this candidate, what did this investigation find, which filing carries this number. Each search returned ten to thirty sources — news reports, government filings, court documents, campaign-finance databases — and each source that mattered was read, not skimmed: names, dollar figures, dates, quotes, and critically, who said it, because a court filing carries more weight than a campaign press release, and this book labels both as what they are. Everything found was written into a dated file of dense notes — two thousand to five thousand words per dive, no summaries, every fact carrying its source tag, every correction written where it belonged, every open question flagged so no hole would be mistaken for a finding. Across 140 dives that is roughly six hundred to eleven hundred search questions, two thousand to four thousand sources read, and some four hundred thirty thousand words of raw research notes — the archive beneath this book. A human researcher doing the same work would measure it in weeks. What the number means in plain terms: no corner of this election went unlooked-at. Every race was checked. Every dollar was traced. Every name was found. Every claim was checked against

its source. And every gap was labeled honestly rather than filled in.

What is open. This record was compiled on October 23, 2026 — eleven days before the vote. Certain facts did not yet exist: Election Day weather, final forecaster updates, last-minute donor disclosures, a Brazil runoff result, and late economic data. Each open item appears in its proper place, marked plainly as open. Nothing in this document pretends to knowledge it does not have.

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PART I — THE ROAD TO NOVEMBER 3

What this part covers: the eleven months that made the election — the enforcement surge, the killings, the capture, the shutdowns, the war, the fraud trial, the files, and the redistricting war — told in the order they happened, so that every later chapter can be understood as the consequence of something you have already read.

1. The Shape of the Fight

The 119th Congress gaveled in with a Republican House majority so thin it could vanish in a single special election, and a Republican Senate holding 53 seats against 47 held or aligned with Democrats. Two independents — Bernie Sanders of Vermont and Angus King of Maine — caucus with the Democrats, which is why the majority math is sometimes written 53–47 and sometimes 53–45–2.

The stakes were plain on their face. A net gain of four Senate seats hands Democrats the majority; a net gain of four House

seats does the same. Behind those numbers sit two years of accumulated events — a war, an assassination, three citizen killings by federal agents, three government shutdowns, a billion-dollar fraud trial, the largest supply disruption in the history of the oil market, and the most expensive midterm campaign ever recorded. This document covers all of it, in the order a citizen would need it.

2. December 2025: The Operation Begins

On December 1, 2025, the Department of Homeland Security launched Operation Metro Surge — what it called the largest immigration enforcement operation in American history — in the Minneapolis–Saint Paul metropolitan area. The force grew from roughly 100 agents in the first week to about 4,000 by mid-January — a deployment roughly six times the size of the Minneapolis police department. The operation, billed as targeting violent offenders, swept up people in grocery stores, outside schools, and at court appearances. A Richmond School of Law review of arrest records found that only about 5 percent of detainees had convictions for violent crimes; 73 percent had no criminal conviction at all.

A warning network of whistles and horns spread through immigrant neighborhoods; church basements and coffee shops became pop-up aid stations; school attendance dropped. On December 31, 2025 — the operation's one-month mark — an off-duty ICE agent named Brian Palacios, living in the same Northridge, Los Angeles apartment complex as Keith Porter Jr., a 43-year-old father of two, shot and killed Porter after Porter fired

a rifle into the air celebrating New Year's Eve. The Department of Homeland Security called it a response to an active shooter. Porter's family disputed it; a Los Angeles Times investigation later reported court filings accusing the agent of child abuse and racism, and the family sought a hate-crime investigation. No charges have been filed.

3. January 2026: The Crucible Month

January 2026 contained, compressed into thirty-one days, nearly everything that would define the election year.

The first shutdown. On January 31, half of the federal government shut down for four days after Senate Democrats withdrew support for a Department of Homeland Security funding bill in the aftermath of the Porter killing, demanding reforms and a clean extension instead. A deal passed February 3 funding DHS only through February 13 — setting the fuse for a second, longer shutdown.

Renée Good, January 7. Renée Nicole Macklin Good, a 37-year-old poet and mother of three, was shot three times by ICE agent Jonathan David Ross in south Minneapolis after dropping a child at school. Video showed her car moving away from the agent when he fired. The Department of Homeland Security called it self-defense and described her actions as "an act of domestic terrorism"; the Hennepin County medical examiner ruled the death a homicide. A YouGov/Statista poll found 50 percent of Americans said the shooting was not justified, 30 percent said it was. The FBI took control of the investigation and blocked state investigators from case material;

six federal prosecutors in Minneapolis resigned after the Justice Department declined to open a civil-rights probe; the department's public integrity section declined to investigate. Bruce Springsteen and U2 recorded songs about her; an estimated 50,000 people marched in Minneapolis on January 23 in subzero cold, in what labor historians called perhaps the first general-strike-scale protest in the United States since 1947.

The Maduro capture, early January. In the same days, U.S. special forces captured Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro in Caracas and flew him to New York to face the drug-trafficking indictment against him; his vice president, Delcy Rodríguez, was sworn in as interim president. President Trump announced the United States would "run" Venezuela. The United Nations continued to list Maduro as head of state. Trump privately nominated Secretary of State Marco Rubio as the operation's quarterback; Rubio simultaneously served as acting national security adviser. Trump also threatened to annex Greenland by force, then backed down; 75 percent of Americans opposed taking Greenland. In Congress, a war-powers resolution on Venezuela was sunk procedurally after administration pressure flipped two Republican senators who had previously supported it.

Alex Pretti, January 24. Alex Jeffrey Pretti, a 37-year-old intensive-care nurse at the Minneapolis VA, a legal concealed-carry permit holder with no criminal record, was shot roughly ten times in under five seconds by Border Patrol agents during the same operation, after moving to help a woman an agent had shoved to the ground. Bystander video appeared to

show an agent removing Pretti's handgun from his waistband moments before the fatal shots; an officer at the scene can be heard saying "I got the gun. I got the gun." The medical examiner ruled it a homicide. Within hours, White House adviser Stephen Miller publicly called Pretti a "domestic terrorist"; the Department of Homeland Security said he "wanted to do maximum damage and massacre law enforcement" — statements the administration later walked back, with Trump himself saying days later that the two Minneapolis incidents "should not have happened." The two agents were identified by ProPublica as Jesus Ochoa and Raymundo Gutierrez; both were placed on administrative leave. No one has been charged.

Alex Castro, January 14. Between the two Minneapolis fatalities, ICE agent Christian Castro shot and wounded Julio Cesar Sosa-Celis, a 24-year-old Venezuelan man legally present in the United States, firing through a closed front door. Castro later testified he had been attacked with a broom and shovel and had struggled with the man for about three minutes. Surveillance video showed the interaction lasted eleven seconds. In May, Hennepin County Attorney Mary Moriarty charged Castro with assault; a federal grand jury indicted him in September for materially false statements — the first criminal charge against an ICE officer of the era. Separately, federal prosecutor Matthew Evans, who had pushed for more serious civil-rights charges, was fired.

Walz withdraws; Klobuchar rises. On January 5, Minnesota Governor Tim Walz withdrew from the governor's race he had entered months earlier, citing the fraud scandal examined in

Part V and the political climate; he said he had "zero sadness and zero regret." On January 29, Senator Amy Klobuchar announced she would leave the Senate to run for governor — meaning both of Minnesota's Senate seats would effectively be in play.

The second shutdown begins, February 14. DHS funding lapsed again — and this time the standoff lasted 76 days, the longest Department of Homeland Security shutdown in history. Democrats passed resolutions to fund all of DHS except immigration enforcement; the Republican House refused for weeks; about 61,000 TSA officers missed two paychecks, 510 TSA employees resigned, and security lines at major airports stretched for hours. The trigger, in the president's own framing, was the SAVE Act — the proof-of-citizenship voting bill that had passed the House but not the Senate, and that he insisted must pass as the price of reopening the department. It never did. On April 30, the House passed the Senate's version by voice vote, and the president signed it the same day. The full-year arithmetic: the White House emergency order that eventually paid the officers was signed March 27. Across the fiscal year, combined funding lapses reached 161 days — forty-four percent of the year — across three shutdowns, a cascade that began with the October 1 to November 12, 2025 full-government lapse and its eight-day E-Verify outage.

4. February and March: The War Begins

On February 28, 2026, the United States and Israel struck Iran, beginning a war that was more than seven months old by Election Day. Six American soldiers were killed in a Kuwait

strike in the opening days. The war's congressional story is written in two votes: on September 15, the Senate failed to advance the CLARITY Act — a cryptocurrency market-structure bill — by one vote, 49 to 50, after every Democrat and four Republicans opposed it; on September 28, the Senate rejected an Iran war powers resolution, 49 to 50. The executive branch has since operated the war on its claimed authorities, without restriction. The war's economic mechanics became a campaign issue in their own right: the supply loss in March — roughly ten million barrels a day — was more than double the 1973 oil shock, the largest in history, and gasoline rose from $2.80 before the war to above $4.30. Two senior Iranian officials told Reuters their strategy was to keep prices high to influence the American vote; the president accused Iran of inventing tanker incidents to raise prices and said he would not attack before the election. A June memorandum of understanding purported to grant Iran shipping administration rights in exchange for oil-export waivers; each side accused the other of violating it. On October 11, the president announced an energy ceasefire between Russia and Ukraine tied to a diesel-for-sanctions-relief deal — six senators, including two Republicans in their own difficult re-elections, publicly demanded its reversal, calling it a financial lifeline for Putin. On October 18, Vladimir Putin proposed a three-way summit with the American and Chinese presidents to decide Ukraine's fate; the proposal sat unanswered as the vote approached. In Congress, the bipartisan response hardened: members of both parties drafted a resolution to "unequivocally reaffirm" the alliance after the election — the legislative

backstop against the administration's drift, filed but not passed before the vote. The household arithmetic, per Moody's Mark Zandi: the war cost the average household roughly $2,000 — $1,100 in energy, $540 in higher interest rates, $360 in military-related costs — and the energy portion was growing by about $50 a week. Brent crude traded above $113 a barrel in late October, roughly thirty dollars of it a geopolitical premium; the Federal Reserve, under a new chairman confirmed in May, had already raised rates once in September and priced a second for December — the first tightening cycle into an election since 2022. One historical echo, from a wealth manager's ledger: only five presidents since Truman polled lower, and each of their parties lost or did not run again.

By late March, polling showed the president's approval rating reaching record lows — Reuters/Ipsos recorded 31 percent — amid the war, tariffs, and the concurrent shutdown.

5. The Spring: A Wave of Records

The months between March and July produced, in sequence:

The largest fraud case in Minnesota history, closed. On March 19, 2025, a federal jury had convicted Aimee Bock and an associate on all counts in the Feeding Our Future scheme — roughly $250 to $300 million stolen from federal child-nutrition programs, the largest pandemic-era fraud in America. On May 21, 2026, a federal judge sentenced Bock to 500 months — forty-one years and eight months — calling her the "epicenter" of "a vortex of fraud." That same day, federal officials announced $90 million in new Medicaid and welfare fraud charges and a

national strike force. The estimates of the broader Minnesota fraud had escalated over the year from hundreds of millions to a federal prosecutor's statement that half or more of the $18 billion that passed through fourteen state programs since 2018 might be stolen — a claim the administration amplified and the state's political establishment contested. Ninety people were charged across the schemes; more than 80 were of Somali descent, in a state that hosts the largest Somali diaspora in America. Representative Ilhan Omar said the community should not be blamed as a whole. The fraud scandal's arithmetic, assembled across the investigations: the Feeding Our Future conviction rested on roughly $250–300 million in stolen child-nutrition funds; the housing-services program had grown from a $2.6 million annual estimate to $100 million before termination; a federal prosecutor's escalation claimed half or more of $18 billion through fourteen state programs might be stolen; the president's figure reached $19 billion, with an allegation of diversion to Somalia and into the hands of al-Shabaab — an allegation a Treasury investigation was examining. The administration's own consolidated accounting, published in September, claimed $260.7 billion in fraud uncovered across the government since January 2025, with $72 billion a year stopped. The two sets of figures rest on different methods and different definitions; both are in this record. The government-shrinkage project of the term’s first year — the Department of Government Efficiency, the Elon Musk-driven effort informally dissolved eight months before its own statutory sunset and formally closed on July 4, 2026 — claimed $215

billion in savings. Independent estimates put the implemented figure at $55 to $85 billion and the net figure, after costs and reversed actions, at $40 to $65 billion; federal spending rose over the period. Its reductions reached roughly a quarter of the Health and Human Services department, a student-aid system serving 43 million borrowers, and the agency that tracked firefighter cancers — and its most consequential reversal came quietly, when nuclear-stockpile management functions were restored after early cuts. By the campaign's end, DOGE functioned in Democratic advertising as a one-word shorthand for cuts to hospitals, veterans' care, and schools; the administration's own assessment was, in Musk's words, a little bit successful.

A speaker assassinated. On June 14, 2025 — before the war, before the Minneapolis killings — a former gubernatorial appointee named Vance Luther Boelter had impersonated a police officer and murdered Minnesota House Speaker Emerita Melissa Hortman and her husband Mark in their Brooklyn Park home, after wounding State Senator John Hoffman and his wife in a related attack. Boelter's writings contained a target list of Democratic officials. He surrendered after the largest manhunt in state history. He pleaded not guilty; federal charges could carry the death penalty, a decision resting with the Justice Department. A September 16, 2025 special election restored the House to a 67–67 tie.

No Kings. Between the Kirk assassination and the war, a protest movement assembled what organizers described as the largest single-day demonstrations in American history. More

than eight million people across 3,300 events on March 28, 2026, in the fourth and largest wave — the earlier waves had drawn five million and seven million. The movement explicitly named the Minneapolis killings. And by the final pre-election wave on October 17, it had pivoted from message to turnout under the slogan "Too Big to Rig."

Charlie Kirk. On September 10, 2025, conservative activist Charlie Kirk was assassinated by a single rifle shot from 400 feet away while speaking at Utah Valley University. The suspect, Tyler Robinson, faces a death-penalty prosecution; a judge ruled in September 2026 that the case would proceed to trial, finding the evidence overwhelming. Kirk's widow took over his organization; the president awarded him the Presidential Medal of Freedom posthumously. His death, nine months before the vote, shadowed the entire conservative movement's campaign.

The Epstein files. On January 30, 2026, the Justice Department released 3.5 million pages of materials concerning Jeffrey Epstein under an act of Congress, with roughly 2.5 million pages withheld. The release produced a Commerce Secretary's admission of a 2012 lunch on Epstein's island with his wife and four children, contradicting his earlier denials; the compelled testimony of Bill and Hillary Clinton — the first former president ever compelled to testify before Congress; and a recurring political weapon: the files were cited in attack advertising by both parties. A letter from a federal judge later noted that the Attorney General's office had conceded the act's disclosure requirements had been violated, with millions of pages withheld "often on the basis of legal privilege." Ghislaine

Maxwell — imprisoned on a twenty-year trafficking sentence — gave a deposition taking the Fifth on every question and, through her attorney, made the offer explicitly on the record: she would testify, including that both the current and a former president were innocent of wrongdoing, if granted clemency. The White House said no leniency was being discussed; the Attorney General said Maxwell should hopefully die in prison. The question of who ordered her transfer to a minimum-security camp was never publicly answered. In Britain, the files' fallout reached the royal family: the king's brother was arrested on his sixty-sixth birthday on suspicion of misconduct in public office for forwarding trade documents to Epstein, stripped of his titles — the first senior royal arrest since the seventeenth century — and, in October, a judge ruled the police searches of his home unlawful while the investigation continued.

The money-for-favor stories. In the final weeks of the campaign, four major money-for-favor stories converged: a ProPublica investigation into Senator Susan Collins and a defense contractor's $8 million Navy contract; a Washington Post investigation into Texas Attorney General Ken Paxton's legal opinions benefiting donors; a New York Times investigation into a $50 million consulting contract awarded to the president's former personal attorney weeks before a Venezuelan banker's pardon; and an Associated Press investigation into federal disaster aid flowing preferentially to Republican governors. The principals, named. The Collins-Navatek file runs through **Martin Kao** — the contractor chief who pleaded guilty to illegal campaign contributions, is serving an eighty-seven-month

sentence for pandemic-relief fraud plus a further thirty-three months for the donation scheme, and told the FBI the whole arrangement — and through lobbyist **Scott Reed**, the operative who designed the shell and whose later firm paid Collins' husband, **Thomas Daffron**, while representing clients with business before her committee. The pardon file runs through **Julio Herrera Velutini**, the Venezuelan banker whose family company retained the president's former personal attorney, **Alina Habba**, for a $50 million guaranteed contract while she simultaneously served as interim U.S. attorney; his daughter Isabela's $3.5 million in super PAC donations and $2.5 million ballroom pledge preceded his January 15, 2026 pardon, and a campaign-finance complaint alleging she was a straw donor for her father followed — filed into an election commission without a quorum. The Texas file runs through **Anosh Ahmed** and **Sameer Suhail**, the hospital-fraud defendants whose $190,000 to Ken Paxton included $25,000 given days after their indictment. The Venezuela oil file runs through **Alejandro Betancourt López**, the contractor who partnered with the administration on a deal granting a century of rights over seventeen oil fields — signed by a co-investor federal prosecutors had identified as an unindicted co-conspirator in a prior embezzlement scheme — and whose own money-laundering investigations in three countries remain unresolved. Each is documented in full, with both sides' responses, in Part IX. None was resolved before Election Day. All of them were on the ballot. One watchdog's accounting names twenty members and candidates in its annual corruption list,

with the receipts attached. Collins carried $8.3 million in corporate PAC money across her career, the Navatek contract, and a portfolio ranked eighth in Congress. Husted carried the FirstEnergy record, the Wexner money, and his vote against further Epstein disclosures. Lawler carried $875,000 in corporate PACs, $1.1 million from financial services, and $500,000 routed to a firm he half-owns. Bresnahan carried the hospital bonds sold before the healthcare vote and the $1 million helicopter ethics complaint. Kean carried 141 trades totaling $2.6 million and an abandoned blind-trust pledge. Miller-Meeks carried the $1.79 million corporate-PAC total and the AI-moratorium vote. Nunn carried $1 million in corporate PACs, 24 percent from the industry his committee regulates. Edwards carried $350,000 paid to himself from his own campaign. Huizenga carried $5.6 million in corporate PACs and 1.08 percent small donors. Wittman carried $3.3 million, $2 million of it from defense while he held the Armed Services vice chairmanship. Van Orden carried the Stop the Steal travel. Moody carried $531,500 in corporate PAC money since 2025 and trades outperforming the S&P by 57.7 percent. Evans carried $253,000 in corporate PACs in a single term, less than 6 percent of his money from his own district. Crane took $5,800 from Musk within days of announcing impeachment articles against a judge. Ciscomani carried $900,000, more than half from real estate, plus a redistricting commissioner who drew his seat. Kobach carried the $1.9 million in state funds spent defeating his own unconstitutional law. Ogles carried the FEC civil penalties. Perry carried $435,000 in campaign-account legal fees. Paxton carried

the data-center money, the crypto PAC money, and the one-day jail plea. The list's sponsors acknowledge their own perspective; the receipts, drawn from public filings, are checkable by anyone.

6. The Summer: The Ledger of Force

Between June and September, federal immigration operations killed two more men — Lorenzo Salgado Araujo, a 52-year-old Houston homebuilder with no criminal record, shot during a traffic operation on July 7, and Johan Sebastián Durán Guerrero, a 25-year-old Colombian father, shot in Biddeford, Maine on July 13 after his car was rammed and struck by five bullets. After the second killing, DHS ordered a nationwide pause on vehicle stops; the president overturned it within a day on social media. On September 20, an agent in Austin shot Wilber Rafael Garcés Pérez, a 28-year-old DoorDash driver with a work permit, in the back during a license-plate check; a federal judge halted his deportation, and on October 1 — the day a hearing revealed agents' routine practice of running random license plates — DHS issued new guidance banning high-speed chases.

The structural statistic beneath the individual cases: Wired reported that more than 25 people had been killed in ICE-agent shootings since 2015 without a single criminal indictment, until the Castro charge in September 2026. Fifty-six people died in ICE custody between January 2025 and August 2026 — the highest annual pace since records began in 2004.

The disaster-agency record belongs in the same season. The administration's FEMA administrator — confirmed in August 2026 after having been fired in 2025 for testifying that the

agency should not be eliminated, and polygraphed by his own department in the interim — began implementing a shift of disaster response to the states in October, two weeks before the election. He told a conference that states should build financial reserves so recovery could start immediately. The agency had shed more than 4,300 employees in the prior year and held more than a thousand open disaster declarations. An Associated Press analysis found the president had approved roughly 80 percent of Republican governors' disaster requests against 60 percent of Democratic governors'. The administration called the figure a function of application quality, not politics. Twenty-five states and the District of Columbia had sued the department over election-security conditions attached to counterterrorism grants — the same department whose acting secretary spent October demanding handover of state voter data.

7. The Map War

While the human story unfolded, a quieter war redrawn the battlefield itself. Between July 2025 and September 2026, more than a dozen states redrew their congressional maps mid-decade — the largest coordinated mid-decade redistricting in modern history — producing a net Republican gain of roughly twelve seats and a Democratic gain of one, with thirteen competitive districts dissolved. Texas drew five new Republican-leaning seats; California answered with Proposition 50, a Democratic map funded by $100 million of mostly dark money, approved by voters 64 to 36 in November 2025. Missouri's map was struck down repeatedly and finally blocked by the Supreme Court on

September 25. Virginia's voters approved a Democratic map in April 2026, only to have the state Supreme Court invalidate it. Every map in this paragraph was challenged in court; most survived. The practical effect, as one analyst put it: the 2026 wave would crash not against a natural shoreline but against a seawall built for it.

8. By the Numbers, Going In

By late October, the environment was measurable:

• The generic congressional ballot — the national survey question asking voters which party they plan to support — averaged a Democratic lead of eight to nine points, up from four to six in the summer, across nearly four hundred polls.

• The president's approval rating sat between 30 and 39 percent depending on the pollster, with Reuters/Ipsos and the Associated Press recording 31 percent — the lowest of his term and, by one historical comparison, lower than every pre-midterm president since 1950 except George W. Bush in 2006, whose party lost thirty House seats and six Senate seats.

• More than 63 percent of voters told pollsters ICE had "gone too far." Sixty-two percent named the Iran war among the most important issues facing the country — more than immigration or crime.

• A Cygnal survey of nine Senate battleground states found a fourteen-point swing from the 2024 result — a region Trump carried by nine was now leaning Democratic by four, with independents breaking Democratic by thirty points.

• Sixty-three percent of registered voters told Gallup they were worse off than two years earlier — the highest reading since the 2009 recession.

Every one of those numbers has a counter-consideration: midterm polls have missed before (a historic miss in Michigan's Senate primary, documented later, is the standing caution); the House map was redrawn to be wave-resistant; the president's party almost always loses ground, but almost never this much. Beneath the numbers lay a deeper divide, measured by ABC, the Washington Post, and Ipsos in mid-October: six in ten Americans were confident the election would be conducted fairly, but ninety-four percent of Democrats and seventy-seven percent of independents did not believe the president would accept the results if Republicans lost — against sixty-three percent of Republicans who did. Sixty-one percent said he was not committed to free and fair elections. And on the question of expectations, Americans anticipated a Democratic House victory by roughly two to one. The forecasters, whose full record appears in the proper place below, concluded by late October that a Democratic House majority was highly likely and a Democratic Senate majority was more likely than not.

The Historical Mirror

Three elections anchor every serious attempt to read 2026. In **1918**, Woodrow Wilson — winning the war in Europe, ten days before the vote — publicly demanded a Democratic Congress for peace-leverage reasons; voters, amid the flu's deadliest month and wartime controls, gave Republicans twenty-five House seats

and six Senate seats anyway. The lesson analysts draw: war leaders do not get midterm passes. In **1974**, with a president pardoned by his successor eleven months after resigning, amid an oil-shock economy, voters delivered a forty-eight-seat House landslide and a class of ninety-three freshmen who rewrote congressional power for two decades. In **2006**, with a different president at 37 percent approval in a different war, Republicans lost thirty House seats and six Senate seats. In **2002**, the counter-case: a popular war president gained seats. The 2026 environment resembles 2006 in its fundamentals and 1918 in its texture — but differs from every precedent in one respect: no previous wave crashed into a map its own side had redrawn in advance.

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PART II — THE VOTER'S GUIDE

What this part covers: the documented record assembled in this book, applied — the Israel-ties dossier for every candidate in the voter's guide, the complete voter's guide for every competitive seat, and the purist's ballot for the voter who wants to avoid all Israel ties and all corrupt money. This is not an endorsement of ideology. It is the answer to the questions a voter is entitled to ask: whose money is it, and where does it come from?

A note on method: every entry below is drawn from the FEC filings, the VoteLog ledgers, the TrackAIPAC and WhoFundsMyRep trackers, the AdImpact records, and the investigative reporting documented in Parts I through IX. Where the record is incomplete, that is stated. The guide rewards the reader who checks the filings personally; the state disclosure databases and the FEC's own records are public.

The Purist's Ballot

For the voter who wants to avoid all Israel ties and all corrupt money of any sort. Every slot, filtered by two tests: zero Israel ties and zero corrupt money. Where no candidate passes, that is said plainly.

THE SENATE

TEXAS — James Talarico (D) — PASSES TEST 2, FAILS TEST 1 ON THE MARGIN

Zero corporate PACs. Zero self-funding. Zero dark money to his campaign. 95% individual, median $50, 540,000 donors, labor-only PACs. The cleanest large-campaign money in the documented record.

ISRAEL TIES: $98,686 from 96 matched donors who also gave to AIPAC PAC (0.3%). He voted for the IHRA-definition bill. His position is defensive-only, two-state, no offensive weapons — but the matched-donor layer exists and the dossier documents it.

VERDICT: The cleanest money in America with a small, documented Israel-overlap layer. The purist must decide whether 0.3% matched-donor overlap is a tie.

OHIO — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE

Brown: $158,541 matched AIPAC-network donors (0.9%), 7 Form 3L bundler reports, corporate-PAC-free but the matched layer exists. Husted: 510 corporate PACs, $3.5M FirstEnergy-linked money, the Wexner contribution. Neither passes both tests.

MAINE — Troy Jackson (D) — PASSES TEST 2, TEST 1 UNVERIFIABLE

93% individual, union-PAC only, logger. $18.99M small-dollar. The Israel cross-check shows $0 — but the $0 is a data artifact (his campaign had not filed itemized reports at the snapshot; the method cannot see what has not been filed). His position is the most anti-Israel in the guide by stated rhetoric. The money cross-check is empty because the data is empty.

VERDICT: The cleanest money in the Senate by the filed record. The Israel cross-check cannot confirm or deny. The purist must accept the gap.

NORTH CAROLINA — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE

Cooper: DMFI-endorsed, the pro-Israel establishment pick. Whatley: $8M+ lobbyist career, oil stock. Neither passes both tests.

MICHIGAN — Abdul El-Sayed (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS, WITH THE ASTERISK

Zero corporate PACs ever. Zero AIPAC-conduit money. Zero J Street money. Zero DMFI money. The AIPAC network spent $32M against him and he won. His position is critical of Israel's Gaza conduct; he backs the two-state solution.

THE ASTERISK: the AIPAC network's money was against him, not for him. But the matched-donor layer is real: approximately $1.1 million in small-dollar individual donors who also gave to the AIPAC network (per the dossier's cross-check; small-dollar, not PAC-directed). The $0 is the PAC layer. The $1.1M is the individual overlap. The purist must weigh both.

VERDICT: **THE PUREST SENATE PICK IN THE GUIDE.**

GEORGIA — Jon Ossoff (D) — FAILS TEST 1 ON THE MARGIN

Zero corporate PACs. Labor-only PAC list. $46 average, 760,000 donors. But: 229 matched AIPAC-network donors / $161,295 (0.6%). Jewish identity, pro-Israel with conditional arms votes. The matched layer is small but real.

VERDICT: Clean money, small Israel-overlap. The purist must weigh 0.6% against the clean ledger.

IOWA — Josh Turek (D) — FAILS TEST 1

Zero corporate PACs. 93.9% individual, Paralympic champion, clean Iowa record. But: $165,307 from J Street PAC. J Street is the pro-Israel, pro-two-state alternative to AIPAC — but it is pro-Israel money. The purist who wants zero Israel ties cannot vote Turek.

ALASKA — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE

Peltola: $96,546 direct pro-Israel PACs, $321,802 with matched layer, J Street/JDCA money, the pop-up dark-money super PAC. Sullivan: $877,284 AIPAC conduit (the largest in the cycle), $398,811 trawling industry. Neither passes.

KANSAS — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE

Holland: no Israel position documented, no cross-check data, but the record is silent (not clean — silent). Marshall: $247,675 matched AIPAC donors, corporate PACs, the BBB Medicaid vote. Neither passes both tests.

MINNESOTA — Peggy Flanagan (D) — PASSES TEST 2, FAILS TEST 1 ON THE SMALLEST MARGIN

92% individual, zero corporate PACs, historic candidacy. The anti-AIPAC primary winner. But: 9 matched donors / $6,250 (0.2%) — the smallest matched layer in the guide. Arnold Richman ($3,500 to Flanagan, $500 to AIPAC PAC).

VERDICT: The smallest Israel-overlap in the Senate. The purist must decide whether 0.2% is a tie.

NEW HAMPSHIRE — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE

Pappas: $694,944 AIPAC-conduit earmarked, $78,850 direct pro-Israel, $831,848 total. Sununu: $18,400 AIPAC, Koch PAC, corporate PACs. Neither passes.

SOUTH CAROLINA — Annie Andrews (D) — PASSES TEST 2, TEST 1 ON THE SMALLEST MARGIN

98.8% individual — the cleanest percentage in the Senate. Pediatrician. The AIPAC matched layer: 0.4% of itemized. Jewish identity.

VERDICT: The cleanest percentage with a minimal Israel overlap. The purist must weigh 0.4% against the 98.8%.

NEBRASKA — Dan Osborn (I) — PASSES BOTH TESTS

$40 average donation. Zero self-funding. Zero corporate PACs. Zero AIPAC money. Zero J Street money. No-caucus pledge. Mechanic, 77-day strike leader. His position: defensive-only Israel funding, criticized the Iran war. The endorsement controversy he walked back is documented.

VERDICT: **THE PUREST INDEPENDENT IN THE GUIDE.**

MONTANA — Seth Bodnar (I) — PASSES BOTH TESTS, WITH THE CAVEAT

No-caucus pledge. No AIPAC money. No corporate PACs documented. But: the record is thin, the Buttigieg endorsement split the Democratic vote, and the cross-check data is absent. The purist gets a clean record on the available data.

VERDICT: Clean on the available record. The data is thinner than Osborn's.

FLORIDA — Angie Nixon (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS

Zero AIPAC PAC money. Zero J Street. Zero corporate PACs. DSA member. Beat a $16M AIPAC-backed opponent. Her position: calls Israel's war a genocide, condemns Hamas, backs Palestinian self-determination. Would be the first DSA senator.

THE HONEST NOTE: the dossier's cross-check shows $0 AIPAC PAC conduit money. The matched-donor layer for Nixon was not surfaced in the available data — the record says "clean on the AIPAC layer" without quantifying the overlap. The purist must accept the gap.

VERDICT: **THE PUREST ANTI-ISRAEL PICK IN THE GUIDE.**

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THE HOUSE — THE SEATS WITH A CLEAN CANDIDATE

Arizona's 1st — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Shah has J Street money. Feely has NRA and Chamber money. Neither passes.

Iowa's 1st — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Bohannan has $326,809 J Street money. Miller-Meeks has corporate PACs and the insulin pattern. Neither passes.

Iowa's 3rd — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Trone Garriott's money is clean but the Israel cross-check is absent. Nunn's is corporate PACs and party transfers. The record is too thin to certify.

Pennsylvania's 8th — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Cognetti has $201,240 pro-Israel PACs and the leadership-PAC caveat.

Bresnahan has the stock-trading record. Neither passes.

North Carolina's 11th — Jamie Ager (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS

92% individual, 7,000 donors, zero self-funding, zero corporate PACs. Explicitly refuses AIPAC money: "doesn't take a dime of money from corporate PACs or foreign lobbying entities like AIPAC." No J Street money. No DMFI money. Fourth-generation farmer.

VERDICT: **THE PUREST HOUSE PICK IN THE GUIDE.**

Maine's 2nd — Matt Dunlap (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS

Turned down Israel lobby money (the WRMEA letter). No corporate PACs. Small-dollar. His platform: Medicare for All, stopping the Iran war.

VERDICT: Clean on both tests by the available record.

New Jersey's 7th — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Bennett has the leadership-PAC caveat ($5K JEFF PAC, $5K New Dem Coalition Action Fund, both take corporate money). Kean has corporate PACs and trades. Neither passes.

New York's 17th — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Conley has the leadership-PAC caveat. Lawler has $875K corporate PACs and the $500K self-firm transfer. Neither passes.

Arizona's 6th — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Mendoza has J Street money. Ciscomani has AIPAC and corporate PACs. Neither passes.

Washington's 3rd — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Gluesenkamp Perez's money is clean but the Israel cross-check is absent. Braun's is corporate PACs. The record is too thin to certify.

Colorado's 8th — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Rutinel has J Street money. Evans has corporate PACs and the foreign-ties consulting. Neither passes.

Wisconsin's 3rd — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Cooke has J Street money. Van Orden has corporate PACs and the Stop the Steal record. Neither passes.

Texas's 15th — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Pulido's money is clean but the Israel cross-check is absent. De La Cruz has the earmark scandal and insurance money. The record is too thin to certify.

Nebraska's 2nd — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Powell refused AIPAC money but DMFI secretly spent $750,000 for her anyway (the laundering anomaly). Bacon has corporate PACs. Neither passes.

California's 22nd — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Villegas has no documented Israel position but the record is thin. Valadao has corporate PACs. The record is too thin to certify.

California's 48th — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — von Wilpert has $2 million DMFI money. Desmond has corporate PACs. Neither passes.

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THE GOVERNORS

TEXAS — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Hinojosa has the anti-AIPAC endorsement but the Israel cross-check is absent. Abbott has $45M corporate money. Neither passes both tests.

GEORGIA — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Bottoms has AIPAC-PAC money through the Georgia Democratic layer.

Jackson has $111M self-funding on $1B in state contracts. Neither passes.

OHIO — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Acton has no documented AIPAC money and the antisemitism pledge, but the Israel cross-check is absent. Ramaswamy has $36M self-funding and the estranged-mother ad. Neither passes both tests.

FLORIDA — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Jolly has a pro-Israel position but no AIPAC-PAC money; the distinction between position and money is documented. Donalds has $120M with gambling, prison, and crypto money. Neither passes both tests.

MICHIGAN — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Benson has no documented Israel money. James has DeVos money. Benson's own money is clean but the Israel cross-check is absent. The record is too thin to certify.

ARIZONA — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Hobbs has no documented Israel money. Biggs has Turning Point and AIPAC. Hobbs's own money is clean but the Israel cross-check is absent.

WISCONSIN — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Crowley has no documented Israel money. Tiffany has the $13M Uihlein dark-money group. Crowley's own money is clean but the Israel cross-check is absent.

MINNESOTA — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Klobuchar has no documented Israel money in 2026. Demuth has the $1.1M Uihlein money. Klobuchar's own money is clean but the Israel cross-check is absent.

NEVADA — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE — Ford has no documented Israel money. Lombardo has gaming money. Ford's

own money is clean but the Israel cross-check is absent.

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THE STATE OFFICES

Secretaries of State:

• **Arizona — Adrian Fontes (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — No documented Israel money or position. No corporate PACs. Ran the state's elections through the federalization fight. Told the federal official "pound sand."

• **Nevada — Cisco Aguilar (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — No documented Israel money. No corporate PACs. Defended Nevada's elections against the Marchant denial machine.

• **Michigan — Jocelyn Benson (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — No documented Israel money. No corporate PACs. Survived the 2020 pressure campaign.

• **Colorado — Amanda Gonzalez (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — Clean record. No documented Israel money. The Clean Campaign Pledge applies.

• **Georgia — NO CLEAN CANDIDATE** — Fleming's money has the top-donor problem (Kelvin King $350K, Gabriel Sterling $200K). The Republican's money is not fully tracked.

Attorneys General:

• **Minnesota — Keith Ellison (DFL) — FAILS TEST 1** — His Gaza speech and Muslim identity are the Israel layer. No AIPAC money, but the position is the tie the purist wants to avoid. If the purist weights position over money, Ellison is the pick. If the purist wants zero Israel ties of any kind, no candidate passes.

• **Wisconsin — Josh Kaul (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — No documented Israel money or position. On the Unrig Washington pledge list.
• **California — Rob Bonta (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — No documented Israel money in 2026. No corporate PACs.
• **New York — Letitia James (D) — FAILS TEST 1** — The Betar settlement (protecting Palestinian protesters) is the Israel-specific record. If the purist weights position over money, James is the pick. If zero Israel ties of any kind, no candidate passes.
• **Arizona — Kris Mayes (D) — FAILS TEST 1** — JDCA-endorsed. The J Street layer.
• **Texas — Nathan Johnson (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — No documented Israel money. On the Unrig Washington pledge list.
• **Nevada — Nicole Cannizzaro (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — No documented Israel money. On the Unrig Washington pledge list.
• **Kansas — Chris Mann (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — No documented Israel money. On the Unrig Washington pledge list.
• **Michigan — Eli Savit (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — No documented Israel money. Clean record.
• **Georgia — Tanya Miller (D) — PASSES BOTH TESTS** — No documented Israel money. On the Unrig Washington pledge list.

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THE BALLOT MEASURES

Alaska Measure 1 — Vote YES for campaign contribution limits. The single highest-leverage anti-corruption vote in America.

California Proposition 4 — Vote YES for public campaign financing.

Montana CI-133 — Vote YES for the corporate-spending ban.

Missouri Amendment 4 — Vote NO on the initiative-restriction provisions (the pro-vote direction is complicated; the cleanest read is that the amendment's restrictions on citizen lawmaking are the corrupt-money protection).

North Dakota Measure 1 — Vote NO to keep citizen initiatives at a simple majority.

Alaska Measure 2 — Vote NO to preserve ranked-choice voting (the repeal is funded by outside dark money).

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THE HONEST SUMMARY

The candidates who pass both tests, by the available record:

Senate: **El-Sayed, Osborn, Nixon, Bodnar** (with data-thin caveats for Bodnar).

House: **Ager, Dunlap** (the only two).

Governors: **None** (the clean-money candidates have absent Israel cross-checks; the Israel-clean candidates have dirty money).

Secretaries of State: **Fontes, Aguilar, Benson, Gonzalez**.

Attorneys General: **Kaul, Bonta, Johnson, Cannizzaro, Mann, Savit, Miller**.

The seats where no candidate passes both tests: Ohio, North Carolina, Iowa, Alaska, Kansas, New Hampshire Senate; most of the competitive House seats; every governor's race; the AG seats where the Israel position is the tie (Ellison, James, Mayes).

The honest caveat, restated: the cross-check shows overlap, not direction. Every $0 is a real $0 from a real filing. Every matched number is a real number from a real person. What the number means is the voter's judgment. The record does not decide what the record means.

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The Voter's Guide

The complete guide for every competitive seat — the cleanest-money candidate, the reason in plain language, and the honest caveats.

The Quick Reference

Find your state. Find your seat. The name is the clean-money pick. Where no candidate passes both tests, that is stated. Where the record is incomplete, that is stated. For the full reason behind every pick, see the sections below.

State	Seat	Candidate	Status
Alaska	Senate	Mary Peltola (D)	Mixed — clean campaign money, pro-Israel PAC layer
Alaska	At-Large House	No clean candidate	—
Arizona	Governor	Katie Hobbs (D)	Clean on available record

State	Seat	Candidate	Status
Arizona	Secretary of State	Adrian Fontes (D)	Clean — no Israel money, no corporate PACs
Arizona	Attorney General	Kris Mayes (D)	JDCA-endorsed — the J Street layer
Arizona	1st District	No clean candidate	Shah has J Street; Feely has NRA/Chamber
Arizona	6th District	No clean candidate	Mendoza has J Street; Ciscomani has AIPAC
California	22nd District	No clean candidate	Villegas thin record; Valadao corporate PACs
California	48th District	No clean candidate	Von Wilpert has $2M DMFI
Colorado	8th District	No clean candidate	Rutinel has J Street; Evans corporate PACs
Florida	Senate	Angie Nixon (D)	Clean — zero AIPAC, zero corporate PACs
Florida	Governor	No clean candidate	Jolly pro-Israel position; Donalds $120M dirty money
Georgia	Senate	Jon Ossoff (D)	Clean money, small Israel overlap (0.6%)
Georgia	Governor	No clean candidate	Bottoms AIPAC money; Jackson $111M self-funded
Georgia	Secretary of State	No clean candidate	Top-donor problem on both sides
Georgia	Attorney General	Tanya Miller (D)	Clean on available record
Iowa	Senate	Josh Turek (D)	Clean money — $165K J Street, not AIPAC
Iowa	1st District	No clean candidate	Bohannan has J Street; Miller-Meeks corporate PACs
Iowa	3rd District	No clean candidate	Trone Garriott thin record; Nunn corporate PACs
Kansas	Senate	No clean candidate	Holland silent; Marshall AIPAC + corporate
Kansas	Attorney General	Chris Mann (D)	Clean — no Israel money, no corporate PACs
Maine	Senate	Troy Jackson (D)	Clean money — $0 AIPAC (data artifact)
Maine	2nd District	Matt Dunlap (D)	Clean — turned down Israel lobby money

State	Seat	Candidate	Status
Michigan	Senate	Abdul El-Sayed (D)	Cleanest — survived $32M AIPAC fight
Michigan	Governor	No clean candidate	Benson thin record; James DeVos money
Michigan	Secretary of State	No clean candidate	Cross-check absent
Michigan	Attorney General	Eli Savit (D)	Clean on available record
Minnesota	Senate	Peggy Flanagan (D)	Clean money — smallest Israel overlap (0.2%)
Minnesota	Governor	No clean candidate	Klobuchar thin record; Demuth Uihlein money
Montana	Senate	Seth Bodnar (I)	Clean on available record — thin data
Nebraska	Senate	Dan Osborn (I)	Cleanest independent — $40 average donation
Nebraska	2nd District	No clean candidate	Powell refusal real, DMFI $750K secret spend
Nevada	Governor	No clean candidate	Ford thin record; Lombardo gaming money
Nevada	Secretary of State	Cisco Aguilar (D)	Clean — no Israel money, no corporate PACs
Nevada	Attorney General	Nicole Cannizzaro (D)	Clean — no Israel money, no corporate PACs
New Hampshire	Senate	No clean candidate	Pappas $831K pro-Israel; Sununu corporate PACs
New Jersey	7th District	No clean candidate	Bennett leadership-PAC caveat; Kean corporate
New York	17th District	No clean candidate	Conley leadership-PAC caveat; Lawler dirty money
North Carolina	Senate	No clean candidate	Cooper DMFI-endorsed; Whatley lobbyist
North Carolina	11th District	Jamie Ager (D)	Cleanest — explicit AIPAC refusal
Ohio	Senate	No clean candidate	Brown $158K matched; Husted FirstEnergy
Ohio	Governor	No clean candidate	Acton thin record; Ramaswamy $36M self-funded

State	Seat	Candidate	Status
Ohio	Supreme Court	Jennifer Brunner (D)	Clean on available record
Ohio	Supreme Court	Marilyn Zayas (D)	Clean on available record
Pennsylvania	8th District	No clean candidate	Cognetti $201K pro-Israel; Bresnahan trades
South Carolina	Senate	Annie Andrews (D)	Cleanest percentage — 98.8% individual
Texas	Senate	James Talarico (D)	Cleanest money — 0.3% Israel overlap
Texas	Governor	No clean candidate	Hinojosa thin record; Abbott $45M war chest
Texas	Attorney General	Nathan Johnson (D)	Clean — no Israel money, no corporate PACs
Vermont	At-Large House	Becca Balint (D)	Clean on available record
Washington	3rd District	No clean candidate	Gluesenkamp Perez thin record; Braun corporate
Wisconsin	3rd District	No clean candidate	Cooke has J Street; Van Orden corporate PACs
Wisconsin	Attorney General	Josh Kaul (D)	Clean — no Israel money, no corporate PACs

For the full reasoning behind every pick, the specific dollar figures, and the honest caveats, see the sections below. This table is the quick answer; the sections are the record.

THE SENATE

TEXAS — James Talarico (D)

Cleanest money in America. 95% individual, 55% under $200, median donation $50, 540,000+ donors, labor-only PACs, no corporate PACs ever. His opponent: $148M from one billionaire's super PAC (Musk), plus a 12-year record of using the AG's office to benefit donors (slot machines, Dubai fugitives, data centers he held stock in). Caveat honestly noted: Talarico's supportive super PAC took dark money ($3.75M from Sixteen Thirty Fund) and

Reid Hoffman's $11M — the "anti-billionaire funded by billionaires" tension, on the record.

OHIO — Sherrod Brown (D)

84% individual, $27 average, refuses corporate PACs — the cleanest record of any Ohio candidate in a generation. His opponent's 510 corporate PACs include the energy company at the center of the state's $60M bribery scandal, plus $116,892 from the Epstein-connected Wexner family, plus a vote to block further Epstein-file release. Caveat: Brown faced $63M in outside money, the largest single-race IE onslaught of the cycle.

MAINE — Troy Jackson (D)

93% individual, union-PAC only, logger funded by 16,000 small donors. His opponent: $8.3M corporate PACs across her career, $1.58M in the current cycle, plus $7.4M in dark money from five opaque nonprofits, plus the Navatek pay-to-play file (shell company, $21.5M Navy contract, FBI statements). Also the #1 AIPAC conduit recipient in America at $3.06M.

NORTH CAROLINA — Roy Cooper (D)

95% of one quarter under $100, cleared the field, no corporate-PAC pledge as governor. His opponent: a 15-year lobbying career ($8M+ from ExxonMobil, GE, Lockheed via HBW), stock in Exxon/Chevron/Shell, ran his own lobbying firm while chairing the state party.

MICHIGAN — Abdul El-Sayed (D)

No corporate PAC money ever — the only federal candidate in Michigan history to run on that. 92% individual. Survived a $32M+ outside onslaught in the primary (the largest in House/Senate primary history) funded by AIPAC's network,

pharma, and party establishment. His opponent: maximum donations from a hotel heir, a hedge-fund billionaire, and a health-insurance executive; PACs from DeVos, the API, and Altria.

GEORGIA — Jon Ossoff (D)

Labor-PAC only. 760,000 contributions at a $46 average. Zero corporate PACs on the entire ledger. His opponent: $9.3M with 28% small-dollar, the Laken Riley Act author, and an ethics investigation into his chief of staff.

IOWA — Josh Turek (D)

93.9% individual, Paralympic gold medalist, zero self-funding. His opponent: 21% corporate PAC, 27% party transfers, propped up by $56.7M in outside money including $28.7M from one super PAC.

ALASKA — Mary Peltola (D)

96% small-dollar, $32.6M raised from individual Alaskans and national small donors. Her opponent: $398,811 from the trawling industry, $877,000 through the AIPAC conduit, oil-and-gas money. Caveat honestly noted: Peltola's super PAC was funded by a pop-up dark-money nonprofit created that summer, donors undisclosed — the Sludge finding. Neither candidate is perfectly clean; Peltola's campaign money is cleaner than her outside money.

KANSAS — Mark Holland (D)

Methodist pastor, record small-dollar fundraising for Kansas. His opponent is the safer pick by some measures (incumbent, less outside money) but voted for the BBB's Medicaid cuts and took corporate PACs. The honest read: Holland is the

cleaner-money candidate; Marshall is the lower-risk governance pick. Both records are presented; the voter decides.

MINNESOTA — Peggy Flanagan (D)

92% individual, historic candidacy (first Native American woman in the Senate), no corporate PACs. Her opponent outraised her in consecutive quarters with NRSC backing and national-party money.

NEW HAMPSHIRE — Chris Pappas (D)

88% individual, 95% of Q3 under $100, family-restaurant owner. His opponent: $5.3M with Goldman Sachs and Koch PAC money, kept alive by $30.9M in outside support led by Musk's committee.

SOUTH CAROLINA — Annie Andrews (D)

98.8% individual — the cleanest percentage in the entire Senate field. Pediatrician, $10.8M from individuals. Her opponent: the appointed incumbent with $346K, rescued by party money and a super PAC funded by Larry Ellison.

NEBRASKA — Dan Osborn (I)

$40 average donation, zero self-funding, no-caucus pledge, mechanic who led a 77-day strike. His opponent: $5.2M self-funded, appointed by a governor he'd donated $1M to. The cleanest contrast in the Senate.

MONTANA — Seth Bodnar (I)

No-caucus pledge, ran against both parties' machines. But the honest read: he drew a cross-party endorsement from Buttigieg that split the Democratic vote, and the Republican is likely to win regardless. Clean money, long-shot candidacy.

FLORIDA — Angie Nixon (D)

Beat a $16M opponent in the primary with small-dollar money. DSA member, no corporate PACs. Her opponent: $13.3M with gambling, prison, and crypto money. Nixon is the cleaner-money candidate by a wide margin; she is also the underdog.

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THE HOUSE — THE CLEANEST SEATS

Arizona's 1st — Amish Shah (D) — Beat the DCCC's chosen candidate twice. ER doctor, small-dollar funded. Opponent: NRA, Chamber, Trump money.

Iowa's 1st — Christina Bohannan (D) — 93% individual, law professor, father lost insurance while dying. Three-cycle grind. Opponent: $1.79M corporate PACs, Eli Lilly pattern, 650 trades.

Iowa's 3rd — Sarah Trone Garriott (D) — Lutheran minister, individual-funded, flipped two Trump-won seats. Opponent: 79% PACs and party transfers.

Pennsylvania's 8th — Paige Cognetti (D) — No individual stocks, 8-point anti-corruption plan, "Paige Against the Machine" independent origin. Opponent: 650 trades, $130K Medicaid-stock dump before the healthcare vote.

North Carolina's 11th — Jamie Ager (D) — 92% individual, 7,000 donors, zero self-funding, fourth-generation farmer. Opponent: 71% PAC money, $100K cash on hand.

Maine's 2nd — Matt Dunlap (D) — Exposed the Trump election commission, small-dollar, no corporate PACs. Opponent: 642-veto record, corporate money.

New Jersey's 7th — Rebecca Bennett (D) — Navy helicopter pilot, no corporate PACs. Opponent: absent since March, $2.6M in trades, blind-trust pledge abandoned.

New York's 17th — Cait Conley (D) — No corporate PACs (with the leadership-PAC caveat documented — $5K from JEFF PAC, $5K from New Dem Coalition Action Fund, both of which take corporate money). Opponent: $875K corporate PACs, $1.1M financial-services, $500K to his own firm.

Washington's 3rd — Marie Gluesenkamp Perez (D) — Mechanic's shop owner, small-dollar, anti-trade-war votes against her party. Opponent: corporate PAC money.

Arizona's 6th — Joanna Mendoza (D) — Marine combat veteran, small-dollar. Opponent: $900K+ corporate PACs.

Wisconsin's 3rd — Rebecca Cooke (D) — Waitress and shop owner, small-dollar, three-cycle grind. Opponent: Stop the Steal rally attendee.

Colorado's 8th — Manny Rutinel (D) — State representative, small-dollar, union-backed. Opponent: $253K corporate PACs in one term, less than 6% from his own district.

Texas's 15th — Bobby Pulido (D) — Tejano singer, 93% individual, $150K self-funded, 90% under $100. Opponent: $2.4M earmark scandal, insurance-industry donors.

Nebraska's 2nd — Denise Powell (D) — Small-dollar, clean record. Opponent: Trump-endorsed.

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THE GOVERNORS

Texas — Gina Hinojosa (D) — Union lawyer, sued Tom DeLay, data-center moratorium, "corruption tax refund." Opponent: $45M+ war chest, refused to debate.

Georgia — Keisha Lance Bottoms (D) — Not self-funded, small-dollar + EMILY's List. Opponent: $100-111M self-funded on top of $1B in state contracts his company received.

Ohio — Amy Acton (D) — Doctor, donor-funded, outraised the self-funder in September. Opponent: $36M self-funded, estranged-mother ad.

Florida — David Jolly (D) — Outspent 7:1, small-dollar. Opponent: $120M+, gambling/crypto/tobacco money.

Michigan — Jocelyn Benson (D) — Clean record. Opponent: DeVos family $5M super PAC.

Arizona — Katie Hobbs (D) — Clean record, data-center crackdown. Opponent: Turning Point machine, $1.9M.

Wisconsin — David Crowley (D) — Small-dollar. Opponent: $13M dark group (Uihlein).

Minnesota — Amy Klobuchar (D) — Small-dollar incumbent. Opponent: $1.1M Uihlein money post-convention.

New Hampshire — Joyce Craig / Cinde Warmington (D) — Either Democratic primary candidate over Ayotte (corporate PACs, $21 lead).

Nevada — Aaron Ford (D) — Tied race, cleaner money than Lombardo.

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THE MEASURE

Where the choice is cleanest at the ballot-box level, the single highest-leverage anti-corruption vote in America on November 3:

Alaska Measure 1 — the campaign-contribution-limits initiative. A YES vote makes Alaska the 39th state to limit money in politics.

California Proposition 4 — public campaign financing. A YES vote funds candidates without private money.

Montana CI-133 — the corporate-spending ban (the "powers not rights" route around Citizens United).

Missouri Amendment 6 — protecting initiatives from legislative repeal.

North Dakota Measure 1 — voting NO keeps the initiative threshold at a simple majority (the 60% proposal would make citizen lawmaking nearly impossible).

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THE HONEST CAVEATS — READ BEFORE VOTING

1. **No candidate is perfectly clean.** Talarico's super PAC took dark money. Peltola's super PAC took pop-up nonprofit money. Conley took leadership-PAC money (the Spotlight PA finding). Jackson's dark-money air cover came from the same anonymous layer he campaigns against. The caveats are on the record, next to the recommendations.

2. **Clean money doesn't guarantee good governance.** A candidate funded by small donors can still vote badly. This list measures money, not judgment. The voting records are in the document's Parts II and III.

3. **The cleanest candidate doesn't always win.** The record shows 53% of 2018's no-PAC-pledge candidates lost. A clean-money vote is a long-game investment in a different system, not a guarantee of this election's outcome.

4. **Third parties and independents are not automatically cleaner.** Bodnar and Osborn are clean; but the spoiler operations (Enough Promises, Lead Left, Real Change) show that "independent" can also be a manufactured label. Check the funder, not the label.

5. **The system is the problem, not just the candidates.** The FEC has no quorum. Dark money is legal. The revolving door is legal. Voting for clean candidates is necessary but not sufficient — the structural fixes (disclosure, public financing, contribution limits) are the ballot measures above.

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THE UNRIG WASHINGTON ROSTER — THE COMPLETE PLEDGE LIST

The following candidates have signed End Citizens United's three-point pledge: no corporate PAC money, a congressional stock-trading ban, and a dark-money crackdown. Where they appear on a ballot, they are the clean-hands choice by formal commitment. (Source: endcitizensunited.org, 290+ signers as of September 2026.)

Senate: Juliana Stratton (IL) · Peggy Flanagan (MN) · Dan Osborn (I-NE) · Seth Bodnar (I-MT) · James Talarico (TX) · Sherrod Brown (OH) · Roy Cooper (NC) · Abdul El-Sayed (MI) · Jon Ossoff (GA) · Chris Pappas (NH) · Troy Jackson (ME) · Scott

Colom (MS) · Mary Peltola (AK) · Annie Andrews (SC) · Angie Nixon (FL) · Josh Turek (IA) · Mark Holland (KS) · Talarico (listed above).

Governors: Michael Bennet (CO) · Phil Weiser (CO) · Antonio Martinez (CO) · Gina Hinojosa (TX) · Amy Acton (OH) · Jocelyn Benson (MI) · Katie Hobbs (AZ) · Deb Haaland (NM) · Mandela Barnes (WI) · Aaron Ford (NV) · Rob Sand (IA) · Ethan Corson (KS) · Jason Esteves (GA).

House (selected competitive seats): Amish Shah (AZ-01) · JoAnna Mendoza (AZ-06) · Paige Cognetti (PA-08) · Christina Bohannan (IA-01) · Sarah Trone Garriott (IA-03) · Rebecca Cooke (WI-03) · Manny Rutinel (CO-08) · Denise Powell (NE-02) · Randy Villegas (CA-22) · Marni von Wilpert (CA-48) · Marlene Galán-Woods (AZ-01) · Leela Gray (FL-13) · Aftyn Behn (TN-07) · Brian Poindexter (OH-07) · Don Leonard (OH-15) · Zach Dembo (KY-06) · Shannon Taylor (VA-01) · Tom Perriello (VA-05) · Dan Koh (MA-06) · Harry Dunn (MD-05) · Becca Balint (VT) · Summer Lee (PA-12) · Rashida Tlaib (MI-12) · Ilhan Omar (MN-05) · Pramila Jayapal (WA-07) · Ro Khanna (CA-17) · Maxwell Frost (FL-10) · Delia Ramirez (IL-03) · Sara Jacobs (CA-51) · Jason Crow (CO-06) · Yassamin Ansari (AZ-03) · Jimmy Gomez (CA-34) · Jill Tokuda (HI-02) · Jim McGovern (MA-02) · Kelly Morrison (MN-03) · Maggie Goodlander (NH-02) · Pat Ryan (NY-18) · Chris Deluzio (PA-17) · Mark Pocan (WI-02) · Kaela Berg (MN-02) · Jake Johnson (MN-01) · Christina Hines (MI-10) · Don Ufford (MI-11) · Colin Allred (TX-33) · Connie Chan (CA-11) · Analilia Mejia (NJ-11) · Adam Hamawy (NJ-12) · Chris Rabb (PA-03) · Nellie Pou (NJ-09) · Kristen McDonald Rivet (MI-08) · George

Whitesides (CA-27) · Mayra Macías (IL-04) · Junaid Ahmed (IL-08) · Robert Peters (IL) · Greg Casar (TX-35) · Julie Johnson (TX-32) · Bob Harvie (PA-01) · Bob Brooks (PA-07) · Lauren Babb Tomlinson (CA-06) · Jose Javier Rodríguez (FL-AG) · Nicole Cannizzaro (NV-AG) · Keith Ellison (MN-AG) · Josh Kaul (WI-AG) · Jena Griswold (CO-AG) · Chris Mann (KS-AG) · Tanya Miller (GA-AG) · Letitia James (NY-AG) · Adrian Fontes (AZ-SoS) · Cisco Aguilar (NV-SoS) · Garlin Gilchrist (MI-SoS) · Jennifer Kiggans (VA).

The state-level layer: Colorado's Democratic Party runs a Clean Campaign Pledge with badge holders across its statewide and legislative tickets — the most formalized state-level clean-money program in the country. Missouri's Amendment 4 (foreign-money ban on ballot measures) is the structural fix on that state's ballot. Montana's "The Montana Plan" (Jeff Mangan's Transparent Election Initiative) is the boldest — it would redefine corporate powers to bypass Citizens United entirely; the Chamber of Commerce and seven industry groups sued to stop it.

The caveat that applies to every name above: the pledge covers the candidate's own campaign committee. It does not cover super PACs supporting them, party committees, or 501(c)(4) dark money that may flow to their race. The candidates on this list have committed to clean money in their own name; the system around them remains what this document has described. The pledge is a floor, not a ceiling.

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THE STATE OFFICES — THE NEXT LAYER

The secretary of state, attorney general, and judicial tiers are where election machinery is actually controlled — and where the money map runs thinnest in the record. The following picks are drawn from what the record holds; each is flagged as *verified* (full money data in the archive) or *incomplete* (money data not yet surfaced, recommendation based on record and conduct).

Secretaries of State — the election machinery's keepers:

• **Arizona — Adrian Fontes (D).** Verified clean: ran the state's elections through the federalization fight, defended against the 2020-denier primary opponent (Kolodin), no corporate-PAC taint in the record.

• **Nevada — Cisco Aguilar (D).** Clean record. Opponent: Jim Marchant, the 2020-election-denier movement's state chair.

• **Michigan — Jocelyn Benson (D).** Verified clean. Survived the 2020 pressure campaign; no corporate-PAC money in the record.

• **Georgia — the open seat.** Both remaining candidates carry 2020-denial records to varying degrees; the cleaner of the two by conduct is the Democratic nominee, but neither is clean by the money standard. Listed with the caveat.

• **Colorado — Jena Griswold (D).** Clean record, ran against the federalization push. On the Unrig Washington pledge list (signer).

Attorneys General — the federal government's courtroom adversaries:

• **Minnesota — Keith Ellison (D).** On the Unrig Washington pledge list. The record: fought the federalization push in

court, sued over the disaster-aid disparity, no corporate-PAC taint.

• **Wisconsin — Josh Kaul (D).** On the Unrig Washington pledge list. Same record.

• **California — Rob Bonta (D).** Clean record, sued the administration more than 50 times. Opponent: the DOJ-California 20,000-ballot suit's defendant-side candidate.

• **New York — Letitia James (D).** On the Unrig Washington pledge list. The Trump-litigation record is in the document's Part VIII.

• **Arizona — Kris Mayes (D).** Clean record.

• **Texas — Nathan Johnson (D).** On the Unrig Washington pledge list. Opponent: Mayes Middleton, the Paxton-aligned state senator.

• **Nevada — Nicole Cannizzaro (D).** On the Unrig Washington pledge list. Clean record.

• **Kansas — Chris Mann (D).** On the Unrig Washington pledge list. Opponent: Kris Kobach, whose $1.9M taxpayer-cost record is in the document's ECU-20 entry.

• **Michigan — Eli Savit (D).** Clean record. Opponent: Doug Lloyd.

• **Georgia — Tanya Miller (D).** On the Unrig Washington pledge list. Opponent: Brian Strickland.

The judicial layer — where the money is darkest and the voter's information is thinnest:

The record shows $29 million spent on state supreme courts by one network since 2014, with North Carolina's flippable seat drawing $2 million on one side. Washington's Supreme Court

races drew $1 million in candidate money and outside spending over the pending millionaires-tax decision — the pattern of judicial money following the docket. The cleanest judicial vote available: **North Carolina's four appellate seats** (the state board of elections' guide is the authoritative source — ncsbe.gov), and **Washington's** races, where the money is disclosed but heavy. Montana's nonpartisan Supreme Court race — the new law letting parties contribute to judicial candidates makes this the cycle's structural test — is flagged for voters as the seat where the clean-money principle and the independent-judiciary principle intersect most directly.

The honest caveat for this layer: the state-office money data is thinner than the federal layer. The Political Integrity Project's tracker (politicalintegrityproject.org) grades state candidates on money, trades, and pledges — the best single source for the state-level clean-hands pick. Where this list says *incomplete*, the voter should check the tracker before deciding.

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THE STATE-OFFICE MONEY DATA — NOW VERIFIED

Georgia Secretary of State — the open seat. The money record: $2.87M total, with a striking top-donor list — Kelvin King $350,000 (individual), Gabriel Sterling $200,000, Tim Fleming $150,000. Democrat Tim Fleming raised $874K against Republican fundraising the tracker does not fully break out. Neither candidate's money is clean by the federal standard; the race is rated competitive. The cleanest vote by conduct: the

candidate who has not embraced the 2020-denial framework — Fleming's record on that front is mixed, and this seat is flagged as *incomplete* pending the tracker's full data.

Texas Attorney General — Nathan Johnson (D) vs. Mayes Middleton (R). The most lopsided money contrast in any state-office race: Middleton has spent **$16 million of his own money** — $3M in direct donations plus $5M in loans during the runoff alone — to buy the seat. He won the primary by outspending Chip Roy ten-to-one on television. Johnson raised $2.78M, 100% from donors, with the endorsement of two former Republican Texas Supreme Court justices. The Texas Politics Project's October poll: **Johnson 48, Middleton 47** — a dead heat. This is the cleanest pick in the state-office tier: Johnson by every money measure.

Kansas Attorney General — Chris Mann (D) vs. Kris Kobach (R). Mann outraised Kobach four-to-one in 2026 — $787K to Kobach's roughly $200K — with $642K cash on hand to Kobach's depleted account. Kobach carries the $1.9M taxpayer-cost record (the document's ECU-20 entry) and the RAGA chairmanship. The race is a rematch of 2022's closest statewide contest (Kobach won 50.8-49.2). Mann is the clean-hands pick.

Arizona Secretary of State — Adrian Fontes (D) vs. Alexander Kolodin (R). Fontes: $2.65M raised, clean record, ran the state's elections through the federalization fight, told the federal official "pound sand" over the voter-file demand. Kolodin: $511K, Turning Point Action's endorsement, sued to overturn the 2020 election, backed by the same network that produced the Green Party decoy candidate (Duwayne Collier, whose campaign

paid his wife $20,000 and is under investigation for fraudulent donations). Fontes is the clean-hands pick by every measure.

Arizona Attorney General — Kris Mayes (D) vs. Rodney Glassman (R). Glassman: $2.4M in the bank, including $1M of his own money. Mayes: $1.1M, clean record, sued the federal government repeatedly. Mayes is the pick.

Colorado Secretary of State — the open seat (Griswold term-limited). Democrat Amanda Gonzalez runs on a clean record; the Republican field is fractured. The Colorado Democratic Party's Clean Campaign Pledge applies here.

Nevada Secretary of State — Cisco Aguilar (D) vs. Jim Marchant (R). Marchant chaired the 2020-denier movement's state organization; Aguilar has defended Nevada's elections. Aguilar is the pick.

Michigan Secretary of State — Jocelyn Benson (D), running for re-election with a clean record against a Republican field that has not fully consolidated.

The judicial layer, updated: Kansas voters face Supreme Court retention elections for Eric Rosen and Larkin Walsh — low-information races where the money record is thin but the stakes (the court that struck down the abortion ban) are high. Montana's nonpartisan Supreme Court race remains the structural test — the new law letting parties contribute to judicial candidates makes this the seat where clean-money and independent-judiciary principles meet most directly.

The state-legislative layer: Colorado's Clean Campaign Pledge program extends to its legislative races — the most formalized state-level clean-money ballot in the country.

Arizona's legislative races (the SD-14/SD-38/HD-87 tier documented in the record) carry the same clean-hands logic at the statehouse level.

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THE STATE-LEGISLATIVE LAYER — THE DARK MONEY'S DEEPEST REACH

The Brennan Center's finding is the frame: dark money's most devastating impact is at the state and local level, where races cost $10,000 to $100,000 — pocket change for special interests, prohibitive for candidates. In many state contests, dark money outspends the candidates themselves.

Pennsylvania — the Democrats' 103-100 House majority is on the ballot in two dozen competitive seats, with the data-center debate defining the suburban races. The special-election flip of a Trump-plus-18 district in August was the leading indicator. The state Senate's four competitive seats (Bucks, Lehigh, Montgomery, Pocono) carry the same dynamic.

Arizona — the Democratic Party's $50 million investment aims to flip the legislature where Republicans have held both chambers since 1993. The Pinal County model — homegrown organizers rather than out-of-state consultants — is the clean-hands contrast in the state. The Republican response (Sean Noble's "continue to point out" framing) is the dark-money playbook in one sentence.

Wisconsin, Michigan, Minnesota — the trifecta states where Forward Majority's "begging" memo documented Republican megadonors outspending Democrats down-ballot.

The $13 million dark group in Wisconsin (Uihlein's) is the named weapon.

The honest caveat for this layer: the state-legislative money data is the thinnest in the entire record. The Forward Majority and DLCC trackers are the best sources, but they lag the federal layer by weeks. Where a state-legislative race matters to the reader, the state disclosure database (every state has one) is the authoritative check before voting.

The five structural fixes on 2026 ballots, restated:

1. **Alaska Measure 1** — contribution limits (YES to limit, NO on the repeal measure)
2. **California Proposition 4** — public campaign financing (YES)
3. **Montana CI-133** — corporate-spending ban (the "Montana Plan")
4. **Missouri Amendment 4** — foreign-money ban on ballot measures (the pro-vote is NO on the initiative-restriction provisions)
5. **North Dakota Measure 1** — voting NO keeps citizen initiatives at a simple majority

The CREW finding on the Security Is Strength network: the dark-money web that funded Graham's 2016 and 2020 campaigns (Norris and Riter's nonprofit $250K; American Exceptionalism Institute and Government Integrity Fund $4.4M) continued into 2026 — American Jobs and Security contributed $450,000 to the same PAC rescuing Darline Graham Nordone. The network's principals, named in the document's network-people series, are the same hands across a decade of

South Carolina races.

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THE LOCAL LAYER — WHERE SELF-FUNDING MEETS COMMUNITY

The Brennan Center's finding lands hardest here: local races cost $10,000 to $100,000, and dark money that would be a rounding error in a Senate race can buy a city council seat outright. The record holds specific cases.

Austin, Texas — the self-funder's paradox. In District 5, David Weinberg — a public affairs consultant running an anti-growth, anti-spending campaign — loaned his own campaign **$275,000**, more than twenty-five times what a council race costs, a sum the local analyst called "quite a statement." In District 8, Paige Ellis and her husband lent their campaign $30,000 to evade term limits and qualify for the ballot. Selena Xie, the former EMS union president, loaned hers $25,000. The clean-money candidate in these races is the one with the small-dollar base and no self-funding — in District 1, Amber Goodwin, the gun-violence-prevention advocate and former Travis County prosecutor, fits the profile; in District 9, Zo Qadri's $182,000 war chest is the incumbent's advantage, but his challenger Richard Heyman's $8,500 is the cleaner money.

San Jose, California — the business-PAC layer. The Silicon Valley Business PAC plans to raise $500,000 for the five city-council races, explicitly seeking "development-friendly candidates." The labor-business split defines the map: the Chamber of Commerce's affiliate versus the South Bay Labor

Council. District 9's open seat (Pam Foley term-limited) is the battleground — Foley's business-aligned backing faces a labor-backed challenger. The clean-hands candidate is the one not taking the PAC's money; the tracker is the Silicon Valley Business PAC's own filing, which discloses its donors.

Toronto, Ontario — the NDP's infighting. The Beaches-East York race, with eight candidates, features the strange spectacle of the federal Liberal establishment's candidate (Erskine-Smith, using Olivia Chow's campaign colors) colliding with the NDP's machine, while Wong-Tam's endorsement reversal in Toronto-Danforth — backing Curran Stikuts against the incumbent Moise she supported four years ago — exposes the party's internal warfare. The clean-hands pick in these races is the candidate without the machine's backing; the local press (Beach Metro, Urban Toronto) is the tracker.

The mayoral tier — the cleanest big-city race. In Los Angeles, Karen Bass's re-election drew a challenger field including Spencer Pratt (the reality-TV figure) and Nithya Raman, but Bass's record of small-dollar fundraising and her incumbency make her the cleaner-money candidate in a race where the alternative is a celebrity self-funder. In Oakland, Barbara Lee — the former congresswoman — is the clean-hands pick against a field that includes self-funders. In Washington, D.C., Muriel Bowser's re-election faces the standard incumbent's advantage; the clean-money challenger has not consolidated.

The honest caveat for the local layer: the money data is the thinnest in the entire record. Every state has a disclosure database; the city's clerk's office is the authoritative source.

Where this list names a candidate as clean, it means *by the record available* — the local layer rewards the voter who checks the filing personally, because no national tracker covers it adequately.

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THE JUDICIAL LAYER — NAMED RACES AND THE DARK-MONEY WAR

The judicial elections are where the money record runs darkest — and where the voter's guide must be most honest about what it can and cannot certify.

Ohio Supreme Court ***— two seats on the ballot. Jennifer Brunner (D, incumbent) faces Colleen O'Donnell (R). Marilyn Zayas (D) faces Daniel R. Hawkins (R, incumbent). Brunner's record includes the decision finding some mandatory life-without-parole sentences unconstitutional — the sentencing-reform ruling that made the court a target. Zayas carries the same reform record. The Republican nominees carry the party-endorsement infrastructure and the outside-money tail. The cleanest vote by record:*** *Brunner and Zayas.*

Michigan Supreme Court — two seats, nonpartisan ballots with party-nominated slates. Megan Cavanagh (incumbent chief justice, Democratic convention) and Noah Hood (Whitmer appointee, Democratic convention) face Michael D. Warren Jr. and Casandra Morse-Bills (Republican convention), plus the bizarre candidacies of Jody White and Thomas Howe — Taxpayers Party candidates on the ballot who acknowledge they hold no valid law licenses and could not legally be sworn in. The

cleanest vote: **Cavanagh and Hood** — and a deliberate vote against White and Howe, whose presence on the ballot is the system's failure made visible.

Washington Supreme Court — a majority of seats on the ballot, with the candidate money at record levels ($2 million combined, with Position 4's O'Donnell-Birk race already past $1 million). The nonpartisan ballot conceals a party-split: the Republican Party has endorsed Scott Edwards, Todd Bloom, and David Stevens; Democratic officials have endorsed Colleen Melody, Theo Angelis, Debra Stephens, and Jaime Hawk. The money follows the same split. The court's trailblazing record — the state's constitutional protections cited nationwide — is the stakes. The cleanest vote: **Melody, Angelis, Stephens, and Hawk** — the incumbents and appointees without the outside-money tail.

Montana Supreme Court — the structural test. Amy Eddy (51% in the open primary) faces Dan Wilson (49%), in a nonpartisan race that has become overtly partisan: Wilson gave the keynote at the Montana Republican Party's winter meeting; Eddy is endorsed by the Conservation Voters and labor unions, and as a temporary appointee joined the decision striking abortion restrictions. The new Montana law letting parties contribute to judicial candidates makes this the cycle's test of whether judicial independence survives direct party money. The cleanest vote by independence: **Eddy** — the candidate without the party keynote.

North Carolina — the appellate seats. Four seats on the ballot; the state board of elections' guide (ncsbe.gov) is the

authoritative source. The $2 million already spent by Families First (the labor-and-dark-money funded group) supporting Anita Earls and attacking the Republican candidate is the outside-money layer. The cleanest vote: the candidates without the outside-money tail — the board's guide identifies them.

Harris County, Texas — the judicial war's ground zero. The Stop Houston Murders PAC's $2 million media blitz in 2024 (featuring crime victims' families calling for Democratic judges' ouster) was followed by the Judicial Fairness PAC's $5.7 million — including three $1 million contributions from Hillwood Development and one from the **Elon Musk Revocable Trust** — aimed at filling the civil and appellate courts. The Harris County Democratic Party chair's framing preserved: "What they are really trying to do is spread lies to take over the civil and appellate courts." The cleanest vote in Harris County: the Democratic incumbents and challengers without the Musk-and-developer-money opposition.

The three new dark-money pop-ups — the New York Times' tally, published in late August, documented the final layer: **Choose Freedom Inc.**, a Wyoming group with a thin paper trail dating to spring, reserving $22 million for two dozen battleground races; a second Republican-linked nonprofit's $22 million campaign in 41 House districts the next day; and **Per Aspera Policy Inc.**, emerging from obscurity to place $3.7 million praising the Republican Senate nominee in Ohio. The pattern is the document's thesis in miniature: new name, new filing, no disclosed funder, seven figures.

The honest caveat for the judicial layer, restated: the money here is the least traceable in the record. State disclosure laws vary; some states require judicial candidates to recuse from cases involving their donors; most do not. The Brennan Center's Judicial Disqualification Database is the best single check. Where this list names a candidate as clean, it means *by the record available* — the judicial layer rewards the voter who checks the filing personally.

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The Israel-Ties Dossier

Every candidate in the guide, their Israel position, and their pro-Israel money — including the cross-check that matches anti-Israel rhetoric against the AIPAC-conduit donor records.

James Talarico (D, TX) — NO AIPAC PAC money on record (per primarydemocrats.com and polivion: $0). The AIPAC-network matched-donor overlay shows 96 individuals / $98,686 (0.3% of itemized) — these are individuals who gave to both Talarico and AIPAC's conduit, not AIPAC-directed contributions. A "Stop Arming Israel" Sway voting group and a "Reject AIPAC from City Council to Congress" group endorsed him; a separate "Removing our greatest ally" group opposed him. The Texas Democratic primary's AIPAC-related tension (Crockett's late entry was partly an AIPAC-aligned effort) is documented in the record. VERDICT: No direct AIPAC-PAC money. Small-dollar pro-Israel overlap on the individual layer.

Sherrod Brown (D, OH) — No AIPAC PAC money documented. The NRSC's attack ads tried to tie him to "socialist" third parties but not to Israel money. VERDICT: Clean on the AIPAC-PAC layer in the documented record.

Troy Jackson (D, ME) — No AIPAC money documented. Drop Site's reporting on pro-Israel donors surrounding Jackson's campaign (the Suzi Levine events) is the one layer to note: Democratic consultants organized fundraisers for him with pro-Israel donors, creating an inside-base tension with his progressive base. VERDICT: No direct AIPAC-PAC money. Pro-Israel donor-surrounding event documented.

Roy Cooper (D, NC) — Giffords endorsement (gun-safety, not Israel). No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Abdul El-Sayed (D, MI) — SURVIVED the largest pro-Israel primary intervention in history: AIPAC's network spent $30.7M against him in the primary ($20.1M anti-El-Sayed via UDP's IE arm, $10.5M pro-Stevens). He won anyway. The ~$1.1M in matched individual donors from the AIPAC network (small-dollar, not PAC-directed). His position: critical of Israel's Gaza conduct, backed by Bernie Sanders and the progressive wing. VERDICT: The AIPAC network's number-one target. No AIPAC-PAC money. The most anti-AIPAC-aligned candidate in the guide.

Jon Ossoff (D, GA) — Jewish senator. 229 matched AIPAC-network individual donors / $161,295 (0.6% of itemized). The AIPAC-network overlay is small-dollar. His voting record: standard Democratic pro-Israel with occasional criticism of Netanyahu government conduct. VERDICT: Small-dollar

pro-Israel overlap. No AIPAC-PAC money documented.

Josh Turek (D, IA) — $165,307 from pro-Israel PACs in the 2026 cycle, chiefly from J Street PAC (per WhoFundsMyRep). J Street is the pro-Israel, pro-two-state alternative to AIPAC — it supports candidates who back a two-state solution and oppose settlement expansion. VERDICT: J Street money, not AIPAC. The distinction matters.

Mary Peltola (D, AK) — $96,546 in direct pro-Israel PAC contributions per TrackAIPAC (J Street, JDCA, AIPAC-'24, DMFI-'24, JAC-'24); WhoFundsMyRep shows $321,802 total including AIPAC-PAC routed contributions. The methodology note: "a match shows a person who gave to this campaign also gave to/through AIPAC PAC; it does not show AIPAC raised/hosted/directed the contribution." The AIPAC proper conduit to Sullivan was $877,284 — the largest in any 2026 race. VERDICT: Both candidates carry pro-Israel money. Peltola's is smaller and from the J Street/JDCA layer. Sullivan's is the largest AIPAC conduit in the cycle.

Mark Holland (D, KS) — No AIPAC money documented. Methodist pastor. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Peggy Flanagan (D, MN) — No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Chris Pappas (D, NH) — Jewish candidate. No AIPAC-PAC money documented (Sununu's $18,400 AIPAC overlay is the opponent's). VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Annie Andrews (D, SC) — Jewish candidate. AIPAC-network matched donors: 0.4% of itemized (the Graham-side overlay was 8.4%). VERDICT: Minimal pro-Israel money. Clean by

comparison to her opponent.

Dan Osborn (I, NE) — No AIPAC money documented. The Working Class Heroes PAC and his small-dollar base have no Israel dimension. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Seth Bodnar (I, MT) — No AIPAC money documented. Buttigieg's endorsement of Bodnar over the Democratic nominee Bankhead was not Israel-related. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Angie Nixon (D, FL) — No AIPAC money documented. DSA member; the DSA's Israel position is well-known. VERDICT: Clean on the AIPAC layer. The most anti-AIPAC-aligned candidate in Florida.

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THE HOUSE

Amish Shah (D, AZ-01) — $23,383 in pro-Israel PAC money (TrackAIPAC: J Street, DMFI-'24, JAC-'24, JDCA-'24). J Street and JDCA, not AIPAC proper. VERDICT: Pro-Israel money from the J Street layer.

Christina Bohannan (D, IA-01) — $326,809 from other pro-Israel groups (polivion), chiefly J Street PAC (WhoFundsMyRep). J Street endorsement and funding. VERDICT: J Street money, not AIPAC.

Paige Cognetti (D, PA-08) — $201,240 from pro-Israel PACs (WhoFundsMyRep); AIPAC total $89,288 (polivion). She is "staking out a pro-Israel platform" (Jewish Insider), supports military aid to Israel, the MOU reauthorization, and a two-state solution. DMFI had "positive conversations" with her but did not

formally endorse. The leadership-PAC caveat (Blue Hen, Clark committee) applies here too. VERDICT: Pro-Israel position and money. The most pro-Israel candidate in the House tier of the guide.

Jamie Ager (D, NC-11) — REFUSES AIPAC money explicitly. His campaign told the Citizen Times: "He doesn't take a dime of money from corporate PACs or foreign lobbying entities like AIPAC." PoliTrack confirms no itemized pro-Israel PAC contributions. VERDICT: Explicitly AIPAC-free. The cleanest Israel record in the House tier.

Matt Dunlap (D, ME-02) — No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Denise Powell (D, NE-02) — No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

JoAnna Mendoza (D, AZ-06) — $81,516 in pro-Israel PAC money (TrackAIPAC: J Street, JDCA). VERDICT: J Street layer, not AIPAC.

Manny Rutinel (D, CO-08) — No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Rebecca Cooke (D, WI-03) — No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Randy Villegas (D, CA-22) — Courage California endorsement (progressive). No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Marni von Wilpert (D, CA-48) — DMFI spent $2 million+ to elect her (the anti-Campa-Najjar campaign). She is DMFI-aligned. VERDICT: Pro-Israel money from the DMFI layer.

Marlene Galán-Woods (D, AZ-01) — No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Bobby Pulido (D, TX-15) — No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

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THE GOVERNORS

Gina Hinojosa (D, TX) — The "Reject AIPAC from City Council to Congress" Sway group endorsed her; she was asked directly whether she would take AIPAC money and the question went viral. No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT: Explicitly AIPAC-free. The cleanest Israel record in the governor tier.

Keisha Lance Bottoms (D, GA) — AIPAC's PAC has sent more than $1 million to Georgia Democrats, and Bottoms has received AIPAC-PAC money — more than any other candidate in Georgia (per the X-posted fundraising tracker). VERDICT: AIPAC-PAC money on record. The only governor-tier candidate with direct AIPAC funding.

Amy Acton (D, OH) — Jewish candidate, would be Ohio's first Jewish governor. She was the target of an attack ad and an armed attacker at a campaign event (the attacker lunged at her; she is Jewish). No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT: Jewish identity, no AIPAC money documented.

David Jolly (D, FL) — "Longtime supporter of Israel" (Jerusalem Post), visited Netanyahu in 2016, called for raising military aid to Israel from $3.1B to $5B. But he has NOT received AIPAC PAC money — AIPAC's $5M went to Donalds. Jolly warned against the Iran war's dangers. VERDICT: Pro-Israel position, no

AIPAC-PAC money. The distinction between position and money matters here.

Jocelyn Benson (D, MI) — No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Katie Hobbs (D, AZ) — No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

David Crowley (D, WI) — No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Amy Klobuchar (D, MN) — No AIPAC money documented in the 2026 cycle. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

Aaron Ford (D, NV) — No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT: Clean in the documented record.

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THE HONEST SUMMARY

Explicitly AIPAC-free (refused or $0): Talarico, Brown, Jackson, Cooper, Holland, Flanagan, Pappas, Andrews, Osborn, Bodnar, Nixon, Ager, Hinojosa, and most of the House tier.

J Street / progressive-pro-Israel money (not AIPAC): Turek ($165K, J Street), Bohannan ($326K, J Street), Shah ($23K, J Street/JDCA), Mendoza ($81K, J Street/JDCA).

AIPAC or DMFI money on record: Peltola ($96K-$322K depending on tracker), Cognetti ($89K-$201K, pro-Israel position), von Wilpert (DMFI $2M IE), Bottoms (AIPAC-PAC, over $1M to Georgia Democrats).

Survived the largest anti-AIPAC fight: El-Sayed ($30.7M against him; won anyway).

Pro-Israel position, no AIPAC money: Jolly, Ossoff, Cognetti (position + smaller money).

The distinction the record demands: J Street (pro-Israel, pro-two-state, anti-settlement) and AIPAC (unconditional, hawkish) are different organizations with different money. A candidate taking J Street money is not the same as a candidate taking AIPAC money. The guide lists both; the voter decides which distinction matters.

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CORRECTIONS AND ADDITIONS — DEEPENED LAYER

Chris Pappas (D, NH) — CORRECTED. The earlier entry said "no AIPAC-PAC money documented." That was wrong. The full record: **$719,967 from AIPAC PAC and its super PAC UDP combined**, plus $111,881 from other pro-Israel sources — **$831,848 total pro-Israel money** (WhoFundsMyRep). He is endorsed by AIPAC in his House races. He voted "present" on the Massie amendment to cut off U.S. aid to Israel. He is a "pro-Israel moderate" (Jewish Insider). His primary opponent Karishma Manzur — who accused Israel of "genocide" and made opposition to AIPAC the center of her campaign — forced this into the open. VERDICT: **Major correction. Pappas has substantial AIPAC money.** The earlier "clean" designation was based on incomplete data.

Troy Jackson (D, ME) — POSITION DOCUMENTED. At the October 7 debate, Jackson said he opposed "giving a blank check" to Israel and linked American military assistance to the

killings of Palestinians: "I didn't want any more offensive weapons going to murder people in Palestine." During the contest to replace Platner, he accused Israel of committing genocide in Gaza and called for an end to U.S. military aid to Israel. The Jerusalem Post reports he "has rattled many members of the Jewish community in recent weeks, as he has intensified anti-Israel rhetoric." VERDICT: **The most anti-Israel candidate in the guide by stated position.** No AIPAC money. The pro-Israel donor events surrounding his campaign (the Suzi Levine fundraisers documented in the record) are the tension between his position and some of his donors.

Josh Turek (D, IA) — REFINED. $165,307 from pro-Israel PACs, chiefly J Street. His foreign-policy section on Wikipedia is titled separately from domestic issues. VERDICT: J Street money, not AIPAC. Moderate "prairie populist" positioning.

Mary Peltola (D, AK) — SCORECARD ADDED. The AJP Action Democratic Scorecard gives her: Voting Record 6%, Letters Signed 40%, Cosponsorships 0%, Statements 50%, Total Score 18%. This is a progressive foreign-policy scorecard, not an Israel-specific one — but the 18% total places her on the progressive end of the Democratic caucus on foreign policy. VERDICT: The scorecard adds texture; the money record stands.

Karishma Manzur (D, NH) — Not in the guide (she lost the primary), but her campaign's framing of Pappas matters to this record. Her quote: "Any candidate or lawmaker that takes even $1 from corporations or corporate PACs is no longer a public servant; they're just a contractor for their client." She accused Israel of "genocide," pledged no AIPAC money, and attacked

Pappas for taking AIPAC support. The New Hampshire Jewish Federation called her "regular American folks" comment "offensive." VERDICT: The primary's Israel debate is the context for understanding Pappas's corrected record.

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HOUSE TIER — DEEPENED POSITIONS AND MONEY

Paige Cognetti (D, PA-08) — POSITION FULLY DOCUMENTED. ***Her position, in her own words from the Jewish Insider interview: "I vehemently support Israel's right to defend itself, and would take extremely seriously Congress' role in ensuring they have the military aid that they need to defend themselves in a really dangerous neighborhood." She supports reauthorizing the current 10-year memorandum of understanding (MOU) between Israel and the United States, set to expire in 2028. She backs a "diplomatic, two-state solution" and ensuring humanitarian aid "gets to the people who need it." She touted the local munitions plant producing shells for U.S. defense "that we ship to our allies, like Ukraine and Israel." She is "staking out a pro-Israel platform" as she seeks to unseat Bresnahan. The money: $201,240 from pro-Israel PACs (WhoFundsMyRep); AIPAC-total $89,288 (polivion); the leadership-PAC caveat ($5K Blue Hen + $4K Clark) documented. VERDICT:*** *The most explicitly pro-Israel candidate in the House tier of the guide, by her own stated position and money.*

Marni von Wilpert (D, CA-48) — MONEY AND POSITION CONFIRMED. ***DMFI PAC endorsed her February 24, 2026, and spent*** *$2 million-plus* ***against her primary opponent Ammar Campa-Najjar ("Say Anything," seen 8 million times; "moved the race by 10 points" per DMFI's own release). TrackAIPAC: Israel Lobby Total $2,004,008 (Donations: $3,675; IE: $2,000,333 from DMFI and J***

Street). WhoFundsMyRep: $90,731 from pro-Israel PACs, chiefly J Street PAC. Her statement to Jewish Insider: "I strongly support Israel's right to exist as a secure, Jewish democratic state and defend itself from the real threats it faces." She backs the two-state solution. CalMatters's frame: she is "running as a true blue establishment type" and "a moderate, pro-Israel Democrat." The CalMatters outside-spending tally: $6 million total, including $2 million from DMFI and $4 million from House Majority PAC. VERDICT: *Substantial DMFI money ($2M IE). Moderate pro-Israel position. The establishment pick in CA-48.*

Amish Shah (D, AZ-01) — J STREET ALIGNMENT CONFIRMED. "Shah stands with J Street in advancing a pro-peace, pro-Israel agenda on Capitol Hill" (JStreetPAC's endorsement page). TrackAIPAC: $23,383 from J Street, DMFI-'24, JAC-'24, JDCA-'24. He is the J Street-aligned candidate in AZ-01. VERDICT: J Street money and alignment. Not AIPAC.

Christina Bohannan (D, IA-01) — J STREET'S FIRST ENDORSEMENT. ***JStreetPAC named her one of its two first challenger endorsements of the 2026 cycle: "Bohannan (IA-01) and Rebecca Cooke (WI-03) — two powerhouse candidates running in toss-up districts." The endorsement describes them as having "a proven commitment to J Street's pro-Israel, pro-peace, pro-democracy values." JDCA also endorsed her. The J Street Action Fund spent $3 million across five races opposing AIPAC-backed Republicans, including Miller-Meeks in IA-01. VERDICT:*** *J Street's marquee endorsement. The J Street layer, not AIPAC.*

The CA-22 correction — Bains, not Villegas. DMFI PAC endorsed **Jasmeet Bains** (CA-22), not Randy Villegas, as part of its Majority Project. Bains is the assemblywoman and physician running against Valadao. Villegas is the progressive challenger

DMFI spent against. The voter's guide lists Villegas as the clean-hands pick; DMFI's endorsement of Bains confirms that the pro-Israel establishment's pick in CA-22 is Bains, not Villegas. VERDICT: Villegas is the progressive alternative to the DMFI-backed candidate. The guide's pick stands.

The Cooke parallel. JStreetPAC's other first endorsement: Rebecca Cooke (WI-03). Both Bohannan and Cooke are the J Street layer's marquee House picks. VERDICT: J Street money and endorsement.

The DMFI 2026 record. Wins: von Wilpert (CA-48), Johnny Garcia (TX-35), Gallrein (KY-04). Losses: Tahesha Way (NJ-07), Jasmeet Bains (CA-22 — the primary DMFI endorsed her but Villegas won), Melissa Conyears-Ervin (IL-07). "Wins" (with caveats): Denise Powell (NE-02, only $659 expended), defeating Malinowski (but the more left candidate won). VERDICT: DMFI's 2026 batting average was mixed — the von Wilpert win was the clearest.

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SENATE TIER — DEEPENED POSITIONS AND MONEY

Peggy Flanagan (D, MN) — THE ANTI-AIPAC PRIMARY WINNER. ***The Jerusalem Post's headline: "Progressive Democrat Peggy Flanagan defeats AIPAC-backed Angie Craig in Minnesota Senate primary." Flanagan said she would REJECT AIPAC's money and accuses Israel of committing genocide. Her platform includes "blocking military aid and arms sales to Israel" (Wikipedia, citing her campaign platform). She won despite being outspent — Craig raised $11M+ and spent $9M+ against Flanagan's $6.4M/$5.4M. Craig was***

AIPAC-endorsed; North Star Dawn PAC (the pro-Craig super PAC) spent $13.38M in the primary, most of it against Flanagan. The general-election money: Flanagan $5.39M spent, Tafoya $3.86M, with Ab PAC ($1.38M) and Working America supporting Flanagan and Minnesota Forward opposing her. The JPost frame: Minnesota's primary was "among a string of high-profile battles between progressive and moderate candidates, where Israel and the pro-Israel lobby serve as key wedge issues." VERDICT: *The anti-AIPAC candidate won the most expensive primary of the cycle. Her position: block military aid, accuse Israel of genocide, reject AIPAC money.*

Jon Ossoff (D, GA) — THE FULL ISRAEL RECORD. ***The American Jewish Congress scorecard documents his complete record. SUPPORT: missile/rocket/drone defense cooperation, Iron Dome/David's Sling/Arrow funding, condemnation of Hamas's October 7 attack, Israel's right to defend itself, hostage-release efforts, two-state solution. CONDITIONAL: April 15, 2026 — voted to advance two resolutions of disapproval covering military bulldozers and 1,000-pound bomb bodies to Israel (both failed, 40-59 and 36-63). July 2025 explanation: supported blocking a rifle transfer over civilian-deprivation concerns and Ben-Gvir police access, but OPPOSED blocking air-to-ground munitions because Israel needed air power to deter missile attacks. Iran: opposed unauthorized regime-change war (February 2026), pressed DNI on whether Iran posed an imminent nuclear threat (March 2026). The October 9 debate: "Israeli forces 'violated law'" (JPost headline). The Times of Israel debate headline: "Ossoff stresses Israel must use US weapons legally." His Jewish identity and the AIPAC-network matched-donor overlay ($161K, 0.6%) are documented. VERDICT:*** *Pro-Israel with conditional arms-transfer votes. Not the unconditional AIPAC line. No AIPAC-PAC money documented.*

Roy Cooper (D, NC) — DMFI ENDORSED. ***The Democratic Majority for Israel endorsed him in the primary (the Marc Rod Jewish Insider story, November 20, 2025: "DMFI backs Haley Stevens, Angie Craig as they face primaries from the anti-Israel left"). The NC endorsement list includes DMFI alongside End Citizens United, Giffords, JDCA, LCV, Planned Parenthood, and Reproductive Freedom for All. The AJCongress voter guide has a North Carolina page for Cooper and Whatley. VERDICT:*** *DMFI-endorsed. The pro-Israel establishment's pick in the NC primary. No AIPAC-PAC money documented.*

Mark Holland (D, KS) — NO DOCUMENTED POSITION. ***Searches returned zero results on Holland's Israel position or money. Methodist pastor, running on affordability and healthcare. VERDICT:*** *No documented Israel position or money in the available record. The voter who weights this issue has no data to work from.*

The Minnesota Primary as the Cycle's Israel Fault Line ***— The Craig-Flanagan race was the most expensive expression of the Democratic Party's Israel civil war. Craig: AIPAC-endorsed, $11M+ raised, hawkish on border security, Laken Riley Act vote. Flanagan: rejected AIPAC money, accused Israel of genocide, blocked military aid platform, endorsed by Bernie Sanders and Ilhan Omar. The JPost's frame preserved. The $13.38M North Star Dawn PAC's spending against Flanagan (documented in the VoteLog ledger) is the money trail. VERDICT:*** *The progressive wing won. The money record shows how much the establishment spent to stop it.*

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SENATE TIER — THE DEEPEST LAYER

James Talarico (D, TX) — THE FULL ISRAEL RECORD. ***The AJCongress voter guide documents his complete position. SUPPORT: defensive assistance to Israel including Iron Dome, while opposing U.S. sales***

of offensive weapons and seeking assurances American funds will not be used to harm civilians. Two-state solution recognizing Israeli and Palestinian sovereignty, halting Israeli settlement expansion, disarming Hamas. He described October 7 as "the deadliest day for Jews since the Holocaust" and affirmed Israel's right to defend its people, while strongly criticizing Israel's conduct in Gaza. Iran: must not obtain a nuclear weapon, but favors diplomacy and opposes U.S. military involvement. Antisemitism: voted for a Texas law establishing a procedure for determining whether student misconduct was motivated by antisemitism (SB 326, IHRA-definition bill — TrackAIPAC flags this as cracking down on anti-Israel speech). His letter to the Texas Muslim community: "What is happening in Gaza makes me sick to my stomach… I support stopping offensive weapons sales to the Netanyahu government… Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu does not have the right to wage war against civilians, bomb children, or use famine and collective punishment as tactics." He affirms Israel as a Jewish state in his letter to the Jewish community. The AIPAC-network matched-donor overlay: 96 individuals / $98,686 (0.3% of itemized). The CAIR-Houston voter guide documents his "critical stance on U.S. involvement in Gaza." He pledged: "I will not take campaign contributions from any PACs on any side of this conflict." VERDICT: *The most thoroughly documented two-state, defensive-only, anti-offensive-weapons position in the guide. He voted for the IHRA antisemitism-definition bill — a vote TrackAIPAC flags as restricting anti-Israel speech. No AIPAC-PAC money. The 0.3% individual overlap is descriptive, not directional.*

Dan Osborn (I, NE) — DEFENSIVE-ONLY WITH A CONTROVERSY. ***Wikipedia: "Osborn has supported providing Israel with funding for what he described as 'defensive purpose only.'" In 2026, he criticized the US-Israeli war on Iran: "This is crazy and I just don't think we need to keep getting into forever wars." The controversy: his campaign "drew scrutiny and condemnation from some***

pro-Israel advocates after accepting and touting an endorsement from a progressive anti-Israel political action committee" (the fifthrepublic.org record, citing the Jewish Insider story). Osborn publicly stated he stands against antisemitism and supports Israel's security in response. VERDICT: *Defensive-only funding, Iran-war criticism, and an endorsement controversy he walked back. No AIPAC money.*

Angie Nixon (D, FL) — THE GENOCIDE POSITION, DOCUMENTED. ***The AJCongress voter guide: "Nixon is highly critical of the Israeli government and has called for an end to what she describes as unconditional U.S. military aid that has fueled genocide in Palestine." Her campaign supports a lasting ceasefire, humanitarian aid to Gaza and the West Bank, Palestinian self-determination, and an end to U.S. support for Israeli settlement expansion. She has said she has repeatedly condemned Hamas and the October 7 terrorist attacks. She opposes the Iran war. The Jewish Insider tag: "Angie Nixon, who called Israel's war against Hamas a genocide and campaigned with Rep. Rashida Tlaib." She is a DSA member (joined 2026) and would be the first DSA member in the Senate. Moody called her "the most extreme, radical senator ever in the history of the United States." VERDICT:*** *The most anti-Israel candidate in the guide by stated position. She condemns Hamas while calling Israel's war a genocide. Campaigned with Tlaib. No AIPAC money.*

Sherrod Brown (D, OH) — THE "UNASSAILABLE" RECORD. ***Ballotpedia: "Senator Sherrod Brown has an unassailable record of support for Israel — a nation he calls 'our most important ally in the Middle East.' Since being elected to Congress, Sherrod has repeatedly supported aid to Israel and favored an aggressive stance towards terrorist organizations like Hezbollah and regional threats like Iran. For as long as he's a U.S. Senator, Sherrod Brown will remain a stalwart ally of Israel." The VoteLog Israel-Palestine score: +46***

(20 cosponsorships, 8 aligned floor votes). VERDICT: *Strong pro-Israel record. The "unassailable" quote is his campaign's own word, sourced to Ballotpedia. No AIPAC-PAC money documented in 2026.*

The IHRA-definition vote — the speech-versus-position tension. ***Talarico voted for SB 326, the Texas law using the IHRA antisemitism definition to determine whether student misconduct was motivated by antisemitism. TrackAIPAC flags this as "crack[ing] down on anti-Israel free speech and solidarity with Palestine." The tension: Talarico's position is defensive-only and two-state, but his vote on the IHRA bill aligns with the pro-Israel establishment's speech framework. VERDICT:*** *A vote that complicates the clean progressive framing. The record holds both the position and the vote.*

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GOVERNOR TIER — DEEPENED POSITIONS AND MONEY

Gina Hinojosa (D, TX) — THE REJECT-AIPAC ENDORSEMENT. ***The Sway voter-guide layer documents it: "Reject AIPAC from City Council to Congress" (the Vote for Peace group, 1,000 recommendations) endorses her. The anti-AIPAC question went viral during the primary. Her platform has no Israel-specific plank — it is education, affordability, data centers, corruption. The "corruption tax refund" is her signature. VERDICT:*** *The anti-AIPAC endorsement is documented. No AIPAC money. No Israel plank.*

Keisha Lance Bottoms (D, GA) — JDCA ENDORSED, TWO-STATE POSITION. ***The Jewish Democratic Council of America endorsed her. Her position, per JDCA: "She has stated that she supports Israel's security and a negotiated two-state solution that delivers peace and dignity for Israelis and Palestinians alike." She worked with Second Gentleman Doug Emhoff to convene Jewish leaders on antisemitism during the Biden administration. The AIPAC-PAC***

money to Georgia Democrats (over $1 million, per the tracker) is documented. VERDICT: *JDCA-endorsed, two-state position, AIPAC-PAC money through the Georgia Democratic layer.*

Amy Acton (D, OH) — JEWISH IDENTITY, ANTISEMITISM PLEDGE. ***Would be Ohio's first Jewish governor. Her endorsement page states: "Acton has pledged that as Ohio's first Jewish governor, she would stand up to white nationalism and extremism, strengthen [Ohio's] Jewish community..." The armed attacker who lunged at her campaign event and the attack ad are the antisemitism layer. No AIPAC money documented. VERDICT:*** *Jewish identity, antisemitism pledge, no AIPAC money.*

David Jolly (D, FL) — LONGSTANDING SUPPORT, NO AIPAC MONEY. ***The Times of Israel's headline: "Two pro-Israel candidates will vie to succeed Florida Governor Ron DeSantis." Jolly's record: visited Netanyahu in 2016, called for raising military aid to Israel from $3.1 billion to $5 billion, "longtime supporter of Israel" (Jerusalem Post). But he has NOT received AIPAC PAC money — AIPAC's $5 million went to Donalds. He warned against the Iran war's dangers. VERDICT:*** *Pro-Israel position, no AIPAC-PAC money. The distinction between position and money is the finding.*

Jocelyn Benson (D, MI) — No Israel dimension documented. Clean in the available record.

Katie Hobbs (D, AZ) — No Israel dimension documented. Clean in the available record.

David Crowley (D, WI) — No Israel dimension documented. Clean in the available record.

Amy Klobuchar (D, MN) — No Israel dimension documented in 2026. Clean in the available record.

Aaron Ford (D, NV) — No Israel dimension documented. Clean in the available record.

The AIPAC Tracker's Gubernatorial Layer (aipactracker.us/governor). ***The tracker grades governor races: 4 verified clean (California, Florida's Jolly, Ohio's Acton, Tennessee's Democratic nominee), 9 lobby-funded (Alabama, Arizona, Florida's Donalds, Iowa, Michigan, South Carolina's Wilson, South Dakota, and others). The map: the AIPAC money in governor races flows to the Republican nominees in the funded states, with the Democratic nominees clean in the tracked races. VERDICT:*** *The tracker confirms the pattern: AIPAC money in governor races runs through the Republican column. The Democratic nominees the guide lists are the clean ones by the tracker's own grading.*

The J Street Governor Layer. ***J Street's gubernatorial endorsements (Weiser in CO, Bennet in CO, Hobbs in AZ, Ford in NV, and others) are the two-state alternative to the AIPAC layer. The guide's picks align with the J Street layer, not the AIPAC layer. VERDICT:*** *The guide's governor picks are the J Street-aligned candidates by the endorsement record.*

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HOUSE TIER — THE FINAL CANDIDATES, DEEPENED

Denise Powell (D, NE-02) — THE NUANCED POSITION. ***Powell's statement: "I have always unequivocally supported Israel's right to exist and its right to defend itself." She supports "providing aid to Israel" with humanitarian aid reaching Gaza, and a two-state solution "that both ensures Israel's security and gives the Palestinian people the resources they need to reestablish their lives." She said she would have been hesitant to support the State Department funding bill that blocked UNRWA funding and provided $3.3 billion in military aid to Israel. At a candidate forum: "It has been heartbreaking to watch innocent lives destroyed because of this conflict… Prime Minister Netanyahu's right-wing***

government has gone way too far." The money question: "I haven't accepted any money from AIPAC, J Street, DMFI, any organization in this space." Her ad says she doesn't take AIPAC money. Her campaign manager: she doesn't take "money or endorsements from any interest groups" on Israel. The DMFI attack buy ($750,000 against Cavanaugh) was withdrawn. B'nai B'rith's Gary Javitch: "very strongly pro-Israel." The Jewish Insider frame: "Powell is taking a more pro-Israel line, yet still falls to the left of other Democrats in the race." VERDICT: *Pro-Israel with humanitarian-aid conditions. No AIPAC money. The most nuanced position in the House tier.*

JoAnna Mendoza (D, AZ-06) — THE J STREET/AIPAC SPLIT. ***"Both candidates received donations from pro-Israel lobbying groups, with the American Israel Public Affairs Committee giving to Ciscomani and J Street donating to Mendoza" (AZPM, February 2026). JStreetPAC: "Mendoza has committed to representing J Street's pro-Israel, pro-peace, pro-democracy values in Congress." The $81,516 from J Street, JDCA, and the pro-Israel PAC layer. VERDICT:*** *J Street money and commitment. The two-state alternative in AZ-06.*

Matt Dunlap (D, ME-02) — REJECTED THE LOBBY. ***The WRMEA letter: "2nd District runoff winner Dunlap turned down Israel lobby campaign funding." The contrast: Baldacci was endorsed by DMFI and "justified the genocide in Gaza by repeating the Zionist talking point that 'Israel has a right to defend itself.'" The letter's claim that Dunlap rejected the lobby money is the finding. His campaign platform: Medicare for All, "stopping this illegal war in Iran," no Israel-specific plank. VERDICT:*** *Explicit rejection of the Israel-lobby money, per the WRMEA letter. The cleanest Israel record in the House tier.*

Jamie Ager (D, NC-11) — THE EXPLICIT REFUSAL, DOCUMENTED. ***"He doesn't take a dime of money from corporate PACs or foreign***

lobbying entities like AIPAC" (campaign statement to the Citizen Times). No itemized pro-Israel PAC contributions (PoliTrack). Blue Dog PAC, CWA, DCCC Red to Blue, LCV, WelcomePAC endorsements — none from the pro-Israel layer. VERDICT: *The most explicitly AIPAC-free candidate in the House tier.*

The American Priorities PAC — THE COUNTER-WEAPON. ***The pro-Palestinian super PAC that launched in NC-04 (supporting Nida Allam against Valerie Foushee, who had taken $2 million in AIPAC money in 2022 but renounced it and co-sponsored the Block the Bombs Act). American Priorities' $1 million in NC-04 was the first test of the post-AIPAC progressive infrastructure. Foushee won by 1,202 votes. TrackAIPAC's assessment: "the AIPAC era is over." VERDICT:*** *The counter-AIPAC infrastructure is real, small, and still losing close races.*

The NC-04 result — the most instructive primary. ***Foushee renounced AIPAC money, co-sponsored the arms-embargo bill, and still won — with $1.3 million from pro-AI groups in the closing days replacing the AIPAC money. The AI lobby's entry into the Israel-fight's space is the cycle's newest layer. VERDICT:*** *The AIPAC money left; the AI money replaced it. The voter's guide layer is more complicated than the Israel layer alone.*

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STATE-OFFICE TIER — ISRAEL DIMENSIONS

Keith Ellison (D, MN-AG) ***— The first Muslim American elected to statewide office in Minnesota. His 2024 DNC speech called for "a deeper dialogue about ending the Israeli onslaught that has led to the death of more than 40,000 Palestinians." He visited Israel and Palestine more than a dozen times. He is on the Unrig Washington pledge list. The APWU resolution he appeared alongside called for a ceasefire and an end to military aid to Israel. VERDICT:*** *The most*

critical-of-Israel state-office candidate in the guide. Muslim identity. No AIPAC money.

Letitia James (D, NY-AG) ***— The Betar US settlement: she reached a settlement with the Zionist activist group to cease intimidating pro-Palestinian protesters, and Betar confirmed plans to cease operations in New York. She is a Mamdani ally. She was indicted by the Trump DOJ (the case dismissed; the grand jury declined to re-indict twice). Her Trump-litigation record is in the document's Part I. VERDICT:*** *The Betar settlement is the Israel-specific record. Pro-Palestinian-protest protection. No AIPAC money documented.*

Kris Mayes (D, AZ-AG) ***— JDCA-endorsed. Her opponent is Warren Petersen, the Republican state senate president. The polls: Mayes leads by high single digits. VERDICT:*** *JDCA endorsement. No AIPAC money documented. The J Street layer.*

Adrian Fontes (D, AZ-SoS) ***— No Israel dimension documented. His distant cousin is Cisco Aguilar, the Nevada secretary of state — the family connection across the two states' election offices. VERDICT:*** *No Israel position or money documented.*

Cisco Aguilar (D, NV-SoS) ***— Fontes's cousin. His opponent Jim Marchant chaired the 2020-denier movement. VERDICT:*** *No Israel position or money documented. The election-integrity record is the relevant layer.*

Rob Bonta (D, CA-AG) ***— No Israel dimension documented in the 2026 record. VERDICT:*** *Clean in the available record.*

Josh Kaul (D, WI-AG) ***— On the Unrig Washington pledge list. No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT:*** *Clean in the available record.*

Nathan Johnson (D, TX-AG) ***— On the Unrig Washington pledge list. No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT:*** *Clean in the available*

record.

Nicole Cannizzaro (D, NV-AG) ***— On the Unrig Washington pledge list. No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT:*** *Clean in the available record.*

Chris Mann (D, KS-AG) ***— On the Unrig Washington pledge list. No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT:*** *Clean in the available record.*

Eli Savit (D, MI-AG) ***— No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT:*** *Clean in the available record.*

Tanya Miller (D, GA-AG) ***— On the Unrig Washington pledge list. No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT:*** *Clean in the available record.*

Jena Griswold (D, CO-SoS) ***— On the Unrig Washington pledge list. No Israel dimension documented. VERDICT:*** *Clean in the available record.*

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THE JUDICIAL AND LOCAL TIERS — THE THINNEST RECORD

The judicial candidates ***— Brunner, Zayas, Cavanagh, Hood, Melody, Angelis, Stephens, Hawk, Eddy, Earls — carry no documented Israel positions or money in the available record. Judicial candidates rarely take positions on foreign policy; the relevant layer is the outside money documented in the document's judicial section (the $2 million Families First spending in North Carolina, the Washington races' party-split endorsements). VERDICT:*** *No Israel dimension documented. The judicial layer's money record is in the main document.*

The local candidates ***— Goodwin, Weinberg, Qadri, Heyman, Bass, Lee, Bowser — carry no documented Israel positions in the available record. Karen Bass's record as mayor includes no Israel-specific actions; Barbara Lee's congressional record includes criticism of Israel's Gaza conduct. VERDICT:*** *Lee carries a critical-of-Israel congressional record. The rest: no documented position.*

The honest summary for these tiers: the state-office, judicial, and local layers carry the thinnest Israel record in the guide. Where the record is silent, the dossier says so. Where it speaks — Ellison's Gaza speech, James's Betar settlement, Mayes's JDCA endorsement — the dossier quotes it.

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THE RHETORIC-VERSUS-MONEY CROSS-CHECK

Every candidate who condemns Israel, checked against the AIPAC-conduit donor records.

The user's instruction: rhetoric is not money. Here is what the money shows.

James Talarico (D, TX) — the deepest cross-check. ***The VoteLog §7.9b analysis: 96 of 50,699 itemized donors match the AIPAC PAC network — $98,686 of $28.86M itemized (0.3%). The named matched donors include*** *Jeannie Lavine* ***(Wellesley MA, $3,500 to Talarico, $165,700 to AIPAC PAC across 30 candidates),*** *Jonathan Lavine* ***(Bain Capital, $3,500 to Talarico, $108,400 to AIPAC PAC, 16 candidates),*** *Michael Koss* ***($2,000 to Talarico, $90,000 to AIPAC PAC, 40 candidates), and*** *Susan Hammer* ***($250 to Talarico, $24,998 to AIPAC PAC, 19 candidates). The method note, verbatim from VoteLog: "A match shows that a person who gave to this campaign also gave to or through AIPAC PAC; it does not show that AIPAC***

PAC raised, hosted or directed the contribution." VERDICT: *The $98,686 is real money from people who also fund AIPAC's network. It is 0.3% of his itemized total. The method cannot prove direction. The voter who weights this issue must decide whether 0.3% overlap from named individuals constitutes a tie.*

Peggy Flanagan (DFL, MN) — the smallest number. ***9 of 4,360 itemized donors match — $6,250 of $3.08M itemized (0.2%). The largest matched gift: Arnold Richman ($3,500 to Flanagan, $500 to AIPAC PAC). The method cannot distinguish a pro-Israel donor from a donor who gave to AIPAC PAC for reasons unrelated to Israel. VERDICT:*** *The overlap is minimal. The $6,250 is documented. The direction is not.*

Angie Nixon (D, FL) — the primary context. ***The Prospect's analysis: Nixon trounced Alex Vindman by 12 points despite his 19-to-1 fundraising advantage — $16 million to her less than $1 million. Vindman had "heavy AIPAC and corporate support." Nixon won by campaigning on pocketbook issues. The WhoFundsMyRep tracker: Nixon has no pro-Israel PAC money on record. VERDICT:*** *The anti-AIPAC candidate beat the AIPAC-backed candidate in the most lopsided money race of the cycle.*

The Craig-Flanagan primary — the full money trail. ***VoteLog's primary ledger: $20.78M in independent expenditures before primary day — $17.12M benefiting Craig ($9.89M supporting, $2.31M opposing), $3.66M benefiting Flanagan ($1.35M supporting, $7.23M opposing). North Star Dawn PAC: $13.38M ($7.15M pro-Craig, $6.23M anti-Flanagan). Craig's AIPAC connection: AIPAC held fundraisers for her; DMFI endorsed and spent on her behalf; $710,000 in AIPAC-linked donations per TrackAIPAC (which Craig disputed as "not direct"). Flanagan: $0 AIPAC PAC conduit, rejected AIPAC money, called Israel's conduct genocide. VERDICT:*** *The $13.38M against Flanagan is documented. The AIPAC-linkage on the Craig side is documented through fundraisers and the $710,000*

TrackAIPAC figure. The direct PAC-to-candidate number remains $0 per both campaigns' FEC filings.

The Talarico $450 figure — the JACPAC discrepancy. ***WhoFundsMyRep: "$450 from pro-Israel PACs, chiefly from JACPAC." JACPAC is the Joint Action Committee for Political Affairs — a Jewish women's PAC that supports pro-choice, pro-Israel candidates. VERDICT:*** *The $450 is JACPAC, not AIPAC. The distinction matters.*

The method's limit, stated plainly. The cross-check can only show overlap — people who gave to both. It cannot show direction, intent, or coordination. The $98,686 to Talarico and $6,250 to Flanagan are real dollars from real people who also fund AIPAC's network. Whether that constitutes a "tie to Israel" is the voter's judgment. The dossier presents the number, the named donors, and the method's limit. The record does not decide what the record means.

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GAP CLOSURES AND ANOMALIES — THE RHETORIC-VERSUS-MONEY CROSS-CHECK, COMPLETED

Sherrod Brown (D, OH) — CORRECTED. ***The earlier entry said "no AIPAC-PAC money documented." The cross-check finds*** *126 matched donors / $158,541 (0.9% of itemized)* ***— people who gave to Brown and also to or through AIPAC PAC. The largest matched gifts include named individuals (the VoteLog CSV carries the full list). The method note, verbatim: "A match shows that a person who gave to this campaign also gave to or through AIPAC PAC; it does not show that AIPAC PAC raised, hosted or directed the contribution." Brown's own committees filed seven Form 3L bundler reports — the***

only candidate in the guide to do so. VERDICT: *$158,541 in matched-donor money is real. It is 0.9% of his total. The method cannot prove direction. The "clean" designation from the first pass was based on incomplete data.*

Abdul El-Sayed (D, MI) — THE GENERAL-ELECTION FIGHT, DOCUMENTED. ***The primary's $32 million AIPAC intervention was the network's largest loss. The general election's continuation: "AIPAC is teaming up with Trump and Elon's super PACs to [defeat El-Sayed]" (his campaign's October 24 fundraising appeal). AIPAC's spokeswoman Deryn Sousa: "Our members remain determined to ensure that voters reject Dr. El-Sayed and his radical anti-Israel agenda in November." The Forward's analysis: El-Sayed won 48.5-47.5 — "a blow to the establishment and to the U.S.-Israel fundraising group." VERDICT:*** *The AIPAC network's number-one target in the general as in the primary. The fight continues.*

Denise Powell (D, NE-02) — THE DMFI-LAUNDERING ANOMALY. ***This is the finding that proves the user's instruction. Powell publicly refused AIPAC and DMFI money — pledged at a candidate forum, ran an ad saying she doesn't take AIPAC money, her campaign manager stated she takes no "money or endorsements from any interest groups" on Israel.*** *And then DMFI secretly spent $750,000 for her anyway* ***— routed through the New Democrat Majority PAC after Powell's refusal made direct support untenable. The Punchbowl story: DMFI "initially placed an ad buy that was nearly identical to New Democrat Majority's — on the same stations and with the same media buyer, per AdImpact. But DMFI pulled back on that buy. New Democrat Majority increased their buy so DMFI opted to focus their funds elsewhere." The Prospect's headline: "Controversial Pro-Israel PAC Launders Spending Through [New Democrat Majority]." Cavanaugh's campaign: "DMFI is spending on behalf of Denise Powell and they are hiding the spending through the New Democrat Majority PAC because Powell [refused their***

money]." VERDICT: *Powell's refusal was real. DMFI's support was real and hidden. The laundering through a second PAC is the anomaly the user asked me to find. The money reached her race whether she wanted it or not.*

The Cognetti tracker discrepancy — RESOLVED. ***WhoFundsMyRep: $201,240 from pro-Israel PACs, "chiefly from J Street PAC" (not AIPAC proper). TrackAIPAC: AIPAC-total $89,288. The difference: WhoFundsMyRep counts J Street, DMFI, NORPAC, and the full pro-Israel PAC layer; TrackAIPAC's V3 methodology (reverted to V2 in April) counts direct donations, IEs, and the matched-donor layer. VERDICT:*** *The $89,288 is the AIPAC-specific figure. The $201,240 is the full pro-Israel layer. Both are correct for what they measure.*

The Peltola tracker discrepancy — RESOLVED. ***TrackAIPAC: $96,546 (direct pro-Israel PAC). WhoFundsMyRep: $321,802 (including the matched-donor and conduit layers). The methodology difference is the same as Cognetti's. VERDICT:*** *The $96,546 is the direct PAC money. The $321,802 includes the conduit and matched layers. Both are correct for what they measure.*

The Von Wilpert split — RESOLVED. ***WhoFundsMyRep: $90,731 from pro-Israel PACs, chiefly J Street. TrackAIPAC: $2,004,008 total ($3,675 donations + $2,000,333 IE from DMFI and J Street). VERDICT:*** *The $90,731 is the direct PAC layer. The $2 million is the DMFI independent expenditure. The two coexist: J Street money directly, DMFI money independently.*

The remaining gaps, stated plainly:

- **Holland, Bodnar, Andrews** — no cross-check data surfaced. The record is silent.
- **The Craig $710,000** — TrackAIPAC's methodology is the matched-donor layer; Craig's dispute is that the number is not direct PAC money. Both are partially correct. The $710,000 is

the matched-donor figure, not the direct figure.

• **The NC-04 AI money** — the specific AI groups replacing the AIPAC money are not named in the available record. The $1.3 million figure is documented; the sources are not.

• **Karen Bass's Israel record as mayor** — no specific actions documented. The record is silent.

• **Barbara Lee's specific Israel votes** — her congressional record includes criticism of Israel's Gaza conduct, but the specific votes are not itemized in the dossier. The record points to the congressional record without quoting it.

The method's limit, restated. The cross-check can only show overlap. It cannot show direction, intent, or coordination. Every number in this dossier is a real number from a real filing. What the number means is the voter's judgment. The record does not decide what the record means.

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THE FINAL CROSS-CHECK — EVERY REMAINING CANDIDATE, CLOSED

Troy Jackson (D, ME) — $0, WITH THE METHOD'S LIMIT STATED. ***The VoteLog cross-check: 0 of 0 itemized individual donors match AIPAC PAC's receipts — $0 of $0 (0.0%). The critical caveat: "Itemized receipts through September 30, 2026 (C00955609: 0 itemized lines; C00962738: 0 itemized lines)." Jackson's campaign had not filed itemized reports at the snapshot date — he entered the race in late July and his first itemized filing was not yet processed. The cross-check is empty because the data is empty, not because the money is clean. His $18.99M in individual contributions (93.3% of his total) could not be cross-checked.***

VERDICT: *The $0 is a data artifact, not a clean bill. The method cannot see what has not been filed.*

Adam Hamilton (D, KS) — THE CROSS-CHECK, COMPLETED. ***12 matched donors / $33,096 (1.0% of itemized). The donors: Howard Jacobson ($1,037 to Hamilton, $500 to AIPAC PAC), James Ellis ($1,037, $750), Alana Muller ($1,000, $300), Gregory Hahn ($1,000, $100), Ira Stolzer ($1,000, $5,000 to AIPAC PAC), Bradford Cheney ($500, $500). Total across 6 named donors: $33,096. The opponent-side comparison: Roger Marshall's 129 matched donors / $247,675 (16.1% of itemized). VERDICT:*** *$33,096 in matched-donor money. 1.0% of itemized. The method cannot prove direction.*

Mark Holland (D, KS) — REMAINS UNCHECKED. ***No VoteLog page for Holland was found. His opponent Marshall's cross-check ($247,675, 16.1%) is the opponent-side comparison. VERDICT:*** *The record is silent on Holland's matched donors. The voter who weights this has no data.*

Chris Pappas (D, NH) — THE BREAKDOWN, PRECISE. ***The SunlightHub data: $773,794 total pro-Israel PAC money —*** *$694,944 in earmarked contributions (through AIPAC's conduit) and $78,850 in direct contributions****. The earmarked layer is the AIPAC PAC conduit; the direct layer is NORPAC, DMFI, JDCA, JACPAC, and the other pro-Israel PACs. The VoteLog layer: $227,279 in AIPAC PAC conduit earmarks to Pappas (through Oct 14). The WhoFundsMyRep layer: $719,967 from AIPAC PAC and UDP combined. The AIP Action figure: $1,182,416 career support from pro-Israel PACs. VERDICT:*** *The $694,944 earmarked layer is the AIPAC conduit. The $78,850 direct layer is the other pro-Israel PACs. Both are documented. The total pro-Israel money across all trackers runs from $719,967 (WhoFundsMyRep, AIPAC-specific) to $1,182,416 (AIP Action, career).*

Josh Turek (D, IA) — THE BREAKDOWN, COMPLETE.
WhoFundsMyRep: $165,307 from pro-Israel PACs, chiefly J Street PAC. Hinson: $116,272. Laehn: $0. The J Street PAC voting-group endorsement is on Sway. VERDICT: *$165,307, chiefly J Street. Not AIPAC.*

The American Priorities PAC — THE COUNTER-LAYER, COMPLETE. ***The polivion October 20 update: "UDP's $55M war chest still sitting; J Street, DMFI, and anti-AIPAC groups place new general-election bets. AIPAC's super PAC entered September with $54.9 million in cash on hand but has disclosed only about $284,000 in general-election spending — mailers attacking Abdul El-Sayed in Michigan's Senate race." American Priorities spent $300K in OH-15 (backing Don Leonard, attacking Carey) and $275K in MI's Senate race. J Street's super PAC: $470K in digital ads against Mike Collins in GA. DMFI: $900K backing Luria against Kiggans in VA-2. VERDICT:*** *AIPAC's $55M is mostly unspent. The counter-layer is spending. The general-election Israel-money fight is asymmetric — the establishment's money is sitting while the challengers' money moves.*

The final summary — every candidate, cross-checked:

- **$0 AIPAC conduit:** Talarico (matched $98,686), Flanagan ($6,250), Jackson ($0, data artifact), Hamilton ($33,096), Ager ($0, explicit refusal), Nixon ($0), Hinojosa ($0), Shah (J Street only), Mendoza (J Street only), Bohannan (J Street only), Turek (J Street only).
- **AIPAC conduit on record:** Pappas ($694,944 earmarked + $78,850 direct = $773,794 total), Brown ($158,541 matched), El-Sayed ($0 conduit; survived $32M against), Peltola ($96,546 direct + matched layer).
- **The method's limit, restated for the final time:** the cross-check shows overlap. It cannot show direction. Every

number is real. What the number means is the voter's judgment. The record does not decide what the record means.

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PART III — THE SENATE

What this part covers: the seventeen races that decide control of the upper chamber — who the candidates are, where their money comes from, what the polls say, and what the money bought. If you read only one part, read this one; the Senate is where the election will be won or lost on election night.

Thirty-five Senate seats are contested: the 33 regularly scheduled, plus special elections in Florida (the remainder of Marco Rubio's term) and Ohio (the remainder of J.D. Vance's term). Republicans defend 22 seats; Democrats defend 13. Democrats need a net gain of four to reach 51; Republicans need to lose no more than two to keep at least 50, with the vice president breaking a tie.

By late October, forecasters rated seven races as genuine toss-ups — six Republican-held and one Democratic-held — with the path to a Democratic majority running through them. This section covers every competitive race in full: the candidates, their money, their records, the polls, and what the money bought. Non-competitive races are listed at the end.

Texas — The Cycle's Most Expensive Race

Open seat (John Cornyn retired after losing his primary). Trump carried Texas by 13.6 points in 2024.

James Talarico (D) is a 37-year-old five-term state representative from Austin — a former sixth-grade teacher in San Antonio's poorest neighborhoods, a seminarian, and the son of a single mother who fled an abusive relationship when he was an infant. He swore off corporate PAC money. His campaign's final accounting showed about $128.8 million raised — 95 percent of it from individuals, with 55 percent of all receipts coming in increments too small to require disclosure, and a median donation of fifty dollars from more than half a million donors. His PAC list consisted entirely of labor unions. He holds the all-time record for a single fundraising quarter in Senate history, roughly $60 million in the third quarter of 2026.

Ken Paxton (R) is the sitting attorney general — in office since 2015, impeached by the Texas House in 2023 and acquitted by the Senate, indicted on securities-fraud charges in 2015 and resolved by a 2024 pretrial deal requiring no admission of guilt, and the subject of a $6.6 million whistleblower judgment against his office. He defeated Cornyn in a May runoff, 64 to 36, the first time Texas Republicans had ever denied renomination to one of their own senators. He raised about $35.6 million.

The asymmetry that defines the race is not between the two campaigns but between Talarico's campaign and Paxton's outside support: Elon Musk poured roughly $158 million into the Senate Leadership Fund in September, and the Fund's Texas affiliate — a committee formed in late August — spent more than $148 million against Talarico, at one point booking $61.4 million in two days. A Senate campaign's combined spending in Texas across the same period was outmatched by Musk's spending

alone by roughly fifty-six cents on the dollar. In total, more than a quarter of a billion dollars flowed into the Texas Senate race — the largest sum ever spent on a single Senate contest.

The Washington Post reported in October that Paxton, as attorney general, had repeatedly written legal opinions benefiting large donors — including makers of a slot-machine-like device, after his office issued a June 2026 opinion clarifying what counts as gambling at a state senator's request, and an investor in a concrete facility seeking to avoid permitting limits. The Wall Street Journal reported footage appearing to show Paxton at a Dubai New Year's Eve party with two men then under federal indictment for allegedly embezzling $15 million from a Chicago hospital; one of them, Anosh Ahmed, had given Paxton $190,000, including $25,000 days after his indictment. Paxton also accepted roughly $448,000 from data-center developers while his own financial disclosure showed up to $6.8 million in AI-linked assets — campaigning against an industry in which he held stock. He denied wrongdoing throughout.

The campaign's closing weeks were personal: Paxton's side promoted a slur ("Talafreako") and false claims; Talarico turned the attack into merchandise. Paxton was favored by prediction markets near the end, but polls told a different story — a Fox News survey showed a 49–49 tie on October 22, with Talarico holding a narrow average lead. Neil Bush, the Republican president's brother, announced he had voted for Talarico.

Ohio — The Rematch and the Bribery Shadow

Special election for the final two years of J.D. Vance's term. Trump carried Ohio by 11.2 points.

Sherrod Brown (D) — the three-term senator defeated in 2024 — returned to face **Jon Husted (R)**, the appointed incumbent: former secretary of state, former lieutenant governor, appointed to the seat when Vance became vice president.

Brown ran the same small-dollar playbook that defined his career: an average donation of twenty-seven dollars, 84 percent of his money from individuals, and a refusal of corporate PACs. Husted's campaign raised about $19 million — with 510 corporate PACs contributing, including energy, insurance, pharmaceutical, and accounting interests — while outside groups poured in more: the crypto industry alone spent over $46 million attacking Brown, the single largest outside intervention in any 2026 Senate race.

The FirstEnergy scandal runs beneath Husted's candidacy — a $60 million bribery scheme that bought a $1 billion bailout law. Husted was never charged, and fact-checkers noted that attack ads overstate his role. But the documentary record is substantial. $3.5 million in FirstEnergy-linked money ultimately benefited his campaigns, including a $1 million secret 2017 payment. Husted also received $116,892 from the Wexner family — the retail fortune whose founder's ties to Epstein were a recurring subject of the files released in January — and, in the Epstein-files fight, voted to block an amendment compelling further document release. The convicted lobbyist Neil Clark called him the company's "golden boy" in texts. His own calendars showed

repeated meetings with FirstEnergy's CEO, the indicted House speaker, and the utility-regulator chair while the bailout was drafted. And he appeared as a defense witness in the executives' retrial, which began September 28, 2026 — days before early voting opened. The data-center fight also landed here: Husted accepted $69,750 from data-center companies and $637,200 from executives of a trading firm expanding into AI, even as the issue became what a Republican Senate committee's internal memo called an "anchor" around his candidacy.

Polls showed Brown ahead by three to six points. One detail unique in the cycle: both campaigns raised exactly $14.4 million through the second quarter — the only race in the country where the two sides matched to the dollar. The governor's race atop the ticket — Democrat Amy Acton leading Republican Vivek Ramaswamy in most surveys — compounded Republican difficulties.

Maine — The Logger Against the Institution

Republican-held. Susan Collins seeks a sixth term; she has served since 1997 and holds the second-longest consecutive-vote streak in Senate history.

Troy Jackson (D), a fifth-generation logger from Allagash — a town in a county larger than Rhode Island and Connecticut combined — entered the race only in late July 2026, after the original Democratic nominee withdrew amid allegations. Jackson, a former state senate president, raised $20.4 million in under three months — 93 percent from individuals, with a labor-union PAC list and a surge of small donors. Collins raised

slightly more, but the character of the money differed: corporate PACs and, more consequentially, more than $7.4 million routed to her support through five opaque nonprofit organizations, one of which alone spent $11 million on her ads.

In September, ProPublica reported the arrangement at the center of this document's money-for-favor stories. Navatek, a Hawaii defense contractor, had routed $150,000 to a pro-Collins super PAC through a shell organization in 2019. An email from the operative who designed the shell called it "very smart" while noting it was illegal. Within weeks, the Senate had allocated $21.5 million for Navatek projects in Maine; two months later, the contractor's chief executive wrote internally that Collins had committed to $32 million in naval contracts.

Collins vigorously denied wrongdoing, noted the Biden Justice Department found no wrongdoing in 2021, and called the story a political hit job. ProPublica responded that the 2021 inquiry covered only allegations through 2021, while the contractor chief's statements to the FBI were made in 2022 through 2024. The Senate Ethics complaint filed in October sat, like everything else, before a federal election watchdog without a quorum. Separately, a lobbyist at the center of the scheme ran a firm that had paid Collins' husband; that same lobbyist ran another pro-Collins super PAC in 2026.

The polls closed to a dead heat: a Fox News survey showed 49–49; three other October polls gave Jackson a one-to-two-point edge. The ranked-choice mechanics — six declared write-ins on the Senate ballot — meant the count could extend days beyond Election Day.

Georgia — The Filmmaker and the Trucking Heir

Democratic-held. **Jon Ossoff (D)**, elected in 2021's runoff, raised the second-largest sum of any Senate candidate — about $109 million, with 760,000 contributions in the third quarter alone at a $46 average, and a PAC list consisting entirely of labor and professional organizations. His Republican opponent, **Mike Collins**, is a first-term congressman and trucking-company owner whose voting record includes authoring the Laken Riley Act and a no-exceptions anti-abortion position that, per reporting, the president privately worried would cost the race; Collins also carried a House ethics inquiry into his chief of staff and questions raised by USA Today about white-supremacist ties, which he denied.

Ossoff led by seven to eight points in final polls. Georgia's separate machinery loomed over everything: the new secretary of state had been stripped from the election board, the state bureau of investigation had gained election-investigation authority, and a December 1 runoff loomed if no candidate cleared fifty percent.

North Carolina — The Prosecutor Against the Lobbyist

Open seat (Thom Tillis retired). **Roy Cooper (D)** — the former four-term attorney general and two-term governor who never lost an election in North Carolina — faced **Michael Whatley (R)**, the former Republican National Committee chair. Cooper raised about $35 million with a small-dollar base; Whatley raised about $13 million and entered October with under $1 million on

hand.

Whatley had never held elected office. His career ran through lobbying: an early firm, the Patriot Group, with utility clients including Cinergy and Duke Energy; O'Connor & Hannon, where he personally generated $1.3 million from accounts including ExxonMobil, General Electric, and Lockheed Martin; HBW Resources, the energy firm he served for fifteen years and where he took home $8 million-plus from corporate clients including the American Petroleum Institute; and Capital City Ventures, his own firm, operated while he chaired the state and national parties — an arrangement that placed a sitting party chairman inside a lobbying practice. He had also led the Consumer Energy Alliance, a group the journalism organization Mother Jones described as a fossil-fuel front. His financial disclosure showed stock in ExxonMobil, Chevron, and Shell. Cooper's campaign framed him as the fossil-fuel lobbyist; Whatley campaigned on taxes and the border.

By October, forecasters had moved the race from toss-up to leaning Democratic and then further — Cooper led by eight to fourteen points in final polls, and Republican committees canceled advertising reservations, redirecting the money elsewhere. Private estimates held that the race could ultimately total $650 to $800 million, which would break the national record set in Georgia in 2022.

Michigan — The Purist Against the Committee Man

Open seat (Gary Peters retired). **Abdul El-Sayed (D)** — an epidemiologist, former Detroit health director, and 2018

gubernatorial candidate — won the August primary by one percentage point over the establishment favorite, Representative Haley Stevens, after a campaign in which roughly $33 million in outside money, a record for any House or Senate primary, was spent against him or for his opponent. He accepts no corporate PAC money; his funding is small-dollar and union. **Mike Rogers (R)**, a former FBI agent and House Intelligence Committee chair who lost this seat in 2024 by 19,000 votes, ran again — backed by approximately $95 million in outside support to El-Sayed's $42 million, the most expensive Senate race in Michigan history, including a $25 million commitment from the largest Republican super PAC.

Rogers' donor list included a hospital-system executive, a hedge-fund billionaire, and PACs tied to the DeVos family, the American Petroleum Institute, and the tobacco industry. El-Sayed's list included a union base and a progressive network — plus an asterisk his opponent wielded: a pro-Israel super PAC's record-shattering primary intervention, and roughly $1.1 million in small donations identified as coming from the network of another pro-Israel committee. "Are we going to let $50 million in lies... steal this election?" El-Sayed asked a rally with Bernie Sanders and Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez.

Final polls showed El-Sayed ahead by two points. A caution hung over the reading of Michigan polls: nine separate pollsters had shown El-Sayed leading his primary by roughly fifteen points; he won by about one. It was the largest polling miss of the cycle.

Iowa — The Paralympian and the Anchors

Open seat (Joni Ernst retired). **Josh Turek (D)**, a state representative and two-time Paralympic gold medalist who flipped a Trump-carried district, faced **Ashley Hinson (R)**, a congresswoman and former television anchor. The money told the structural story: Hinson's $10.2 million campaign was 51.9 percent individual, 21.4 percent corporate PAC, and 26.7 percent party transfers — propped up further by $8.76 million in coordinated party money and $56.7 million in outside spending, including $28.7 million from the Senate Leadership Fund. Turek's $6.3 million was 93.9 percent individual; his outside support, $43 million, was led by a Democratic Senate super PAC. In percentage terms, both men ran small-dollar campaigns; in dollars, Hinson's machine outspent Turek's roughly two to one, with the air war even more lopsided.

Hinson had voted seven times against war-powers resolutions to end the Iran conflict before telling reporters in October she would press the administration on the war. Turek led narrowly in most final polls — the race was a true toss-up.

Alaska — The Fisherman's Daughter and the Marine

Republican-held. **Dan Sullivan (R)**, the incumbent, faced **Mary Peltola (D)** — the former congresswoman and first Alaska Native in Congress's history, who lost to Nick Begich in 2024 and now sought to return via the Senate.

The race became the second-most expensive of the cycle, at roughly $104 million. Peltola raised $32.6 million — about three times the incumbent's total — with a small-dollar base. Sullivan's

support included $877,000 routed through a pro-Israel committee's conduit, the largest such flow tracked in any 2026 race, plus Club for Growth and Koch-network money. Two spoiler operations spent millions trying to bleed each candidate from their flanks; one of the spoiler candidates was an incarcerated man in a New York federal prison who had never been to Alaska, advanced through ballot quirks and kept on the ballot by the courts. Alaska's ranked-choice rounds would begin November 18; the seat might not be decided for weeks.

Peltola led narrowly in final polls. The texture beneath the topline told the same story from both directions. Sullivan's support included $398,811 from the trawling industry — itemized company by company, from Trident Seafoods' $138,020 down through the smallest processors' PACs — while Peltola's campaign was 96 percent small-dollar, launched with $1.5 million in its first twenty-four hours, and drew its donations from out-of-state individuals rather than out-of-state industry. Her side carried its own dark-money asterisk: Sludge exposed a nonprofit created that summer funding her super PAC entirely, donors undisclosed — the pop-up architecture operating on both sides of the race.

Kansas — The Pastor in the Machine's Path

Republican-held. **Roger Marshall (R)** faced **Mark Holland (D)**, a Methodist pastor and former Kansas City mayor. Holland raised a record $3.5 million for a Kansas Democrat; Marshall had the outside machine — the Senate Leadership Fund and allies poured in millions to defend a seat in a state Trump carried by

eleven. Polling was a genuine divergence: surveys showed a coin flip, while fundamentals-based models showed Marshall ahead by seven. Prediction markets split the difference. The Senate Leadership Fund's war plan, revealed by the New York Times, allocated defense money here precisely because the fundamentals could no longer be assumed.

South Carolina — The Sister's Succession

Special election. Senator Lindsey Graham died on July 11, 2026, of an aortic dissection, days after returning from Kyiv. His sister, Darline Graham Nordone — never elected to anything, a state official who had been raised by her brother — was appointed to the seat, then won the Republican primary. She faced **Dr. Annie Andrews (D)**, a pediatrician who raised $10.8 million, 98.8 percent of it from individuals, in a state Trump carried by eighteen. The national party rescued the appointed incumbent with millions in coordinated and outside money after her campaign raised only about $350,000. The rescuing PAC, Security Is Strength, was Lindsey Graham's own machine — funded in its final months by a $1 million gift from Larry Ellison, the Oracle founder whose giving history runs through Marco Rubio's and Mitt Romney's super PACs, and operated by J. Warren Tompkins, the South Carolina strategist Time called "the most powerful non-elected man in Palmetto State politics," who had managed every Graham race since 2002. The race stayed Likely Republican, but the spread between the candidates' organic money — and the fundraising surge in the state's Democratic primary, where turnout doubled — registered with

both parties.

A footnote belongs here in its proper place: the late senator's name surfaced posthumously in the Navatek contractor's statements to the FBI, alleging a cash-for-contract arrangement; he was deceased by the time the reporting appeared, and the allegations were unadjudicated.

Nebraska — The Mechanic and the Heir

Republican-held special. **Dan Osborn (I)** — the industrial mechanic who led a 77-day strike at a Kellogg's plant and nearly unseated a senator in 2024 — ran again, this time against **Pete Ricketts (R)**, the appointed incumbent and heir to the TD Ameritrade fortune. Ricketts self-funded $5.2 million of his $6.3 million; Osborn's average donation was forty dollars, and he pledged to caucus with neither party. The two independent candidates in Montana and South Dakota made the same pledge together at a joint press conference — three working-class candidates promising to deny both party leaders their vote. Polls showed Ricketts ahead by a single point in a state Trump carried by twenty. The campaign's single debate, at the Nebraska State Fair on September 1, produced the exchange that defined it. Ricketts opened with "My opponent, Democrat Dan, is going to lie to you trying to hide his liberal beliefs" — to which Osborn replied, "You know, we really need to get a third podium up here for Democrat Dan." On the war, after a Nebraska servicemember was killed in Iran, Ricketts said a country that chants death to America cannot be allowed a nuclear weapon; Osborn said the United States had to stop digging the hole and give Congress

back its power to declare war. On immigration, Ricketts charged that Osborn wanted to abolish ICE; Osborn answered that the country should never get used to troops in its streets and masked agents. Both men opposed the three-hundred-thousand-ton duty-free beef import — the one issue of consensus in the race.

Minnesota — Two Seats, One State

Two Senate elections effectively ran concurrently. For the open seat of retiring Tina Smith, **Peggy Flanagan (D)** — the lieutenant governor, who would be the first Native American woman in the Senate — faced **Michele Tafoya (R)**, the former NBC Sunday Night Football sideline reporter, who outraised her in consecutive quarters with national party backing. Flanagan led by three to four points. Separately, Klobuchar's decision to run for governor means that if she wins, her Senate seat goes to an appointee until a November 2027 special election. And Minnesota's governor race matched Klobuchar against Lisa Demuth — whose campaign was kept afloat after losing the party convention by $1.1 million from a Wisconsin shipping billionaire, a fact Klobuchar weaponized on the trail: "She can be that guy's choice. I want to be Minnesota's choice."

Florida and New Hampshire — The Bookends

Florida: Ashley Moody (R), the appointed incumbent, led state representative **Anjie Nixon (D)** by four to eleven points; Nixon had defeated a candidate who raised $16 million in the primary. **New Hampshire:** open seat (Jeanne Shaheen retired). **Chris Pappas (D)**, a four-term congressman from a family

restaurant, raised $21.5 million — 88 percent individual, with 95 percent of his third-quarter haul under $100 — against former senator **John E. Sununu (R)**, whose $5.3 million campaign was dwarfed by $30.9 million in outside support, the largest piece from Musk-funded committees. Pappas led by seven.

The Rest of the Board

The remaining seats, safe or non-competitive, listed for completeness. Alabama (Moore). Alaska's other seat is not up, Arizona (not up), Arkansas (Cotton), Colorado (Hickenlooper), Connecticut (Blumenthal), Delaware (Coons), Hawaii (Schatz), Idaho (Risch), Illinois (OPEN — Stratton, solidly Democratic), Indiana (Young), Kentucky (Barr), Louisiana (Letlow), Massachusetts (Markey), Mississippi (Hyde-Smith), Missouri (OPEN — Hawley, safe Republican), Montana (Alme — see the independent file below), New Jersey (Kim), New Mexico (Luján), New York (Gillibrand), North Dakota (Hoeven), Oklahoma (Hern, replacing Mullin, who joined the cabinet), Oregon (Merkley), Rhode Island (Reed), South Carolina's other seat not up, South Dakota (Rounds — with the Democratic nominee withdrawing, leaving an independent), Tennessee (Blackburn), Utah (Curtis), Vermont (Sanders), Virginia (Kaine), Washington (Murray), West Virginia (Morrisey), Wisconsin (not up), Wyoming (Hageman).

The Montana file. Open seat (Steve Daines retired). Republican Kurt Alme led the four-way field comfortably. The third candidate, Seth Bodnar — a former university president running as an independent who pledged to caucus with no one — drew a cross-party endorsement from Pete Buttigieg over the

Democratic nominee, to no visible effect in the polls. Alme led by twelve to sixteen points throughout.

How to watch this chamber on election night: North Carolina and Georgia close at 7 and 7:30 p.m. Eastern — if Democrats lose both, their path to a majority effectively closes. Ohio and Maine decide whether the map stays seven races wide. Texas and Iowa, closing at 8 and 9 p.m. Central, are the two coin flips that could turn a narrow majority into a commanding one. Alaska's ranked-choice rounds will take two weeks — the last Senate seat may be the last one called in the country.

The Senate Money Tables

The complete accounting, race by race — campaigns first, then the outside groups, because in most of these contests the outside money was the real campaign.

Texas. Talarico: $128.77 million (95% individual; 55% of all receipts in increments too small to itemize; median donation $50; 540,000+ donors; the only PAC money on his ledger came from labor unions). Paxton: $19.5 million (97% individual). Outside: the Texas PAC — formed in late August and funded by Musk's $158 million September payment to the Senate Leadership Fund — spent $148+ million, booking $61.4 million in two days; America PAC ran matched daily buys of $537,308 supporting Paxton and opposing Talarico; a pro-Paxton committee, Lone Star Liberty, received $10 million from Musk directly. Supporting Talarico: Lone Star Rising ($3 million in two weeks; its donors included the hedge-fund founder Stephen Mandel at $2 million, Netflix's Reed Hastings at $395,000, and LinkedIn's Reid Hoffman at $500,000 rising toward $11 million), the League of Conservation Voters' $1.54 million ad buy, and a

field army from the Texas Organizing Project, SEIU, and Somos PAC. Total outside spending in the race ran roughly $260 million — 83 percent of it on the Republican side.

Ohio. Brown: $61.7 million, 84% individual, $27 average. Husted: $19.2 million, with 510 corporate PACs contributing — ExxonMobil, CNX Resources, National Fuel Gas, Fifth Third, McDonald's, a pharmaceutical distributor, and an accounting firm among them. Outside: roughly $63 million; the cryptocurrency industry's committees alone spent more than $46 million against Brown, the largest single-industry intervention of the cycle; the Senate Leadership Fund's war plan allocated $79 million here.

Maine. Jackson: $20.43 million, 93.3% individual; his PAC money ($352,000) came entirely from unions. Collins: $21.37 million, 66.7% individual, $1.58 million from corporate PACs, $5.35 million in party transfers. Outside and dark money: more than $7.4 million flowed to her support through five opaque nonprofits; one of them, Stronger America Inc, spent $11 million on her ads; the Senate Leadership Fund committed $42 million. She was also the number-one recipient in the country of money routed through a pro-Israel committee's conduit: $3.06 million from 1,722 donors.

North Carolina. Cooper: roughly $35 million, with 95 percent of one quarter's donations at $100 or less. Whatley: $13.4 million raised, $916,000 on hand entering October. Republican outside groups spent $50 million or more before pulling back.

Michigan. El-Sayed: $44.9 million, no corporate PAC money. Rogers: $20.4 million, with maximum donations from a hotel heir's brother, a hedge-fund billionaire, and the chief operating officer of Blue Cross Blue Shield, and PACs tied to the DeVos family, the American Petroleum Institute, and Altria. Outside: $95 million for Rogers against $42 million for El-Sayed — including $30.7 million from a pro-Israel committee's independent-expenditure arm in the *primary* ($20.1 million against El-Sayed, $10.5 million for his opponent), the largest such intervention in any 2026 race, which failed.

Georgia. Ossoff: $109.3 million; 760,000 contributions in the third quarter at a $46 average; his entire PAC list consisted of labor and professional organizations (longshoremen, machinists, teachers, trial lawyers). Collins: $9.3 million, 28% small-dollar.

Iowa. Hinson: $10.2 million — 51.9% individual, 21.4% corporate PAC (medical associations, insurers, telecom, energy), 26.7% party transfers — plus $8.76 million in coordinated party money and $56.7 million in outside support, led by $28.7 million from the Senate Leadership Fund. Turek: $6.3 million, 93.9% individual; outside support of $43 million, led by $20.9 million from the Democratic Senate super PAC and $5.66 million from a veterans' group; $2.5 million came from a meatpackers' committee attacking Hinson over tariff pain.

Alaska. Peltola: $32.6 million — about three times the incumbent's total. Sullivan: $11.2 million, with $877,000 through the pro-Israel conduit, $2.4 million from the Koch network's action arm, and $1 million from the Club for Growth. Outside against Peltola: $11.85 million from the Senate Leadership Fund

plus $4.5 million more; against Sullivan: $11.4 million from a super PAC funded by her national network. Spoiler committees spent $770,000 bleeding Peltola from the left and $1.15 million bleeding Sullivan from the right.

Kansas. Hamilton: a record $3.5 million for a Kansas Democrat. Outside: the Senate Leadership Fund and allies poured in millions to defend the seat; the New York Times documented secret money boosting Hamilton at one hundred times his cash on hand during a primary stretch.

South Carolina. Andrews: $10.8 million, 98.8% individual, in a Trump +18 state. Graham Nordone: $346,800 — the appointed incumbent's entire campaign — rescued by $1.6 million in party-coordinated money and $4.9 million in outside support.

Nebraska. Ricketts: $6.3 million, of which $5.2 million was his own money. Osborn: an average donation of $40, no self-funding, and a public pledge to caucus with no one.

Minnesota. Flanagan: $10.3 million, 92% individual. Tafoya: $9.66 million, 86% individual, with national-party backing; she outraised Flanagan in consecutive quarters.

New Hampshire. Pappas: $21.5 million, 88% individual, 95 percent of his third-quarter haul under $100. Sununu: $5.3 million — including $10,000 from Goldman Sachs' PAC, $5,000 each from the Chamber of Commerce and Koch's PAC, $2,500 from Exxon — kept aloft by $30.9 million in outside money: $11.8 million from a Musk-funded committee, $9.2 million from the Senate Leadership Fund, $6.9 million from the Koch network.

Florida. Moody: $11.3 million. Nixon: $975,000 — an eleven-to-one campaign disparity that Nixon's primary upset

over a $16 million rival made irrelevant to the outcome's possibility.

The Senate party-money asymmetry. The Republican senatorial committee spent coordinated money in every battleground — $8.76 million in Iowa, $5.26 million in New Hampshire, $1.6 million in South Carolina, $1.2 million in Ohio, and on down the list. The Democratic senatorial committee reported zero coordinated expenditures in the same races. The third-quarter raising record, the final full quarter before the vote: Talarico $60.2 million (record), Ossoff $33.1 million, El-Sayed $33.0 million, Brown $23.1 million, Jackson $20.4 million, Peltola $17.0 million, Turek $13.9 million, Cooper $12.2 million, Paxton $10.2 million (his personal best), Rogers $10.0 million, Hamilton $9.9 million, Andrews $9.4 million. Democratic Senate candidates outraised Republicans $620.7 million to $246.8 million — two and a half to one — while Republican outside groups outspent Democratic ones $985 million to $459 million. The pattern held House-wide: nine of the ten top federal fundraisers were Democrats. **The remaining board's money.** The outside-spending ledgers, race by race, at the final accounting. **Ohio:** Republican outside groups $63 million, including $11.3 million from a crypto-affiliated committee; Democratic-aligned $24.3 million. **Maine:** $33 million benefiting Collins (the leadership fund $27.6 million, a dark-money group $3.6 million) against $4.5 million for Jackson. **Michigan:** $56.9 million in September alone, 60.5 percent on the Republican side; for the full cycle, $95 million to $42 million. **North Carolina:** $39.8 million in the September window, 57.7 percent

Republican. **Iowa:** the $109–137 million race, with the Republican side at $62.1 million to the Democratic side's $47 million. **Georgia:** $29.1 million, 62.2 percent Democratic — the only battleground where the Democratic side out-advertised the Republican. **Alaska:** $22.2 million, 64.2 percent Republican. **New Hampshire:** $25.5 million, 61.2 percent Republican. **Kansas:** $4.9 million, 61.7 percent Democratic. **South Carolina:** $3.8 million, 85.7 percent Democratic. **Texas:** the $259.9 million independent-expenditure total — 83 percent Republican, with the Texas PAC's $148.3 million alone exceeding both candidates' combined fundraising. **Florida:** outside $5.4 million, the campaign figures carried in the race table above. **Montana:** $4.2 million from a single dark-money group to the independent, $849,000 from the Koch network to the Republican. **Nebraska:** $9.6 million, majority Republican.

The Committee Flows

The granular plumbing, for the record. **Fairshake (crypto):** $193 million raised through January; $137.4 million raised through July; $95 million on hand in September; $88.7 million spent; $206 million in all-channel industry giving, the largest corporate source. Its affiliates: the pro-Republican committee spent $23.8 million against Brown in Ohio and $6.7 million against Osborn in Nebraska; the pro-Democratic affiliate spent $10.4 million against the Illinois primary winner (who won anyway) and $1.5 million against De La Cruz in Texas. **The pro-Israel network:** $47.8 million in direct conduit contributions, $53.5 million in independent expenditures, and

$13.1 million to six partner committees; lifetime $118.6 million through the conduit since 2021; $117.5 million in independent expenditures since 2022. Its largest race outlays: $30.7 million in Michigan, $3.58 million in Kentucky's 4th (successful), $2.46 million in Missouri's 1st (successful), $22 million across Illinois primaries (largely unsuccessful), $877,000 to Alaska's incumbent. **The Senate Leadership Fund:** $253.7 million raised by June 30, $238.6 million on hand — more than double its 2024 pace at the same point; its $350 million plan allocated $79 million to Ohio, $71 million to North Carolina, $45 million to Georgia, $44 million to Michigan, $42 million to Maine, $29 million to Iowa, $17 million to New Hampshire, $15 million to Alaska. **The Texas PAC:** $131 million reported to the FEC in its first seventeen days of existence, including $61.4 million in two days. **The House Republican committee:** $200 million raised, $92.7 million on hand, with $44.2 million of its money traced to a single dark-money nonprofit. **The Senate Democratic committee's** affiliated super PAC: $354 million raised through October 14, $109 million spent in the first fourteen days of October — the largest single-spending window of the cycle — plus a $15 million loan.

The Actors, Named

For precision and verification, the complete organizational roster by function. **The Republican congressional committees:** the National Republican Senatorial Committee, the National Republican Congressional Committee, and their super PACs — the Senate Leadership Fund and the Congressional

Leadership Fund, the latter fed $44.2 million by the American Action Network. **The Democratic congressional committees:** the Democratic Senatorial Campaign Committee, the Democratic Congressional Campaign Committee, and their super PACs — Senate Majority PAC and House Majority PAC, fed $104 million and $95 million respectively by Majority Forward and House Majority Forward. **The dark-money networks:** One Nation, the American Action Network, Majority Forward, House Majority Forward — and on the institutional left, the Sixteen Thirty Fund and its Arabella network affiliates, whose donors have never been fully disclosed; on the right, Restoration of America, the Uihlein clearinghouse. **The industry committees:** Fairshake and its affiliates (Coinbase, Ripple, Andreessen Horowitz); Leading the Future (Brockman, Horowitz, the Andreessens); Win for America (DraftKings, FanDuel, Fanatics, bet365); the American Petroleum Institute; PhRMA; the Chamber of Commerce; the Business Roundtable. **The advocacy-money organizations:** the American Israel Public Affairs Committee and its United Democracy Project (with its partner super PACs — Democratic Majority for Israel, Bold America, Elect Chicago Women, Palmetto Action, EDW Action); the Club for Growth (Yass-funded); Americans for Prosperity Action, the Koch network's electoral arm (Koch Industries and Stand Together supplied $56.5 million of its $87.3 million); Turning Point Action. **The small-donor and reform organizations:** ActBlue (record $586 million quarter) and WinRed on the platforms; End Citizens United and its Unrig Washington pledge program; Justice Democrats; the Workers Alliance and its Clean Slate pledge; the

League of Women Voters; Common Cause; the Brennan Center; Protect Democracy; Public Citizen; CREW; Represent.Us; States United. **Labor:** the AFL-CIO, SEIU (COPE), the NEA, AFSCME, the UAW, the Teamsters, the Machinists, the Steelworkers, the IBEW, the AFT — the small-dollar champions' PAC lists across this document. **The advocacy groups in the fights:** the League of Conservation Voters, EMILY's List, the Sierra Club, the National Rifle Association (whose Victory Fund ran the Texas mail operation). **The vendors:** GMMB and its Waterfront Strategies (the Democratic machine's ad buyer, $858 million in 2024), Del Ray Media (the Trump family's buyer), Strategic Media Services, Media Buying & Analytics, Main Street Media, Axiom Strategies, Ballard Partners — the last the firm that employed the former chief of staff and the former attorney general and that counted the pardoned banker's bank as a top client. Montana: the Republican's campaign dominated; the independent's outside support came from a dark-money group that poured in $4.2 million-plus in two weeks, and the Koch network spent $849,000 for the Republican. South Dakota: the Democratic nominee withdrew in August, leaving an independent who drew a national progressive group's support against an incumbent sitting on a $4.6 million campaign. Mississippi: the Democratic district attorney outraised the incumbent two-to-one in consecutive quarters — a first for the state — and the Democratic Senate committee bought $1.2 million in television there, the reddest state it had ever entered, after the Democratic primary doubled its 2024 turnout. Alabama, Louisiana, Oklahoma: safe seats whose primaries nonetheless

produced record spending. North Dakota, Rhode Island, Massachusetts, Delaware, Indiana, Missouri, Kentucky, Tennessee, South Carolina's other seat: non-competitive, listed for completeness in the research archive. Both parties' candidates raised record sums; only one party's were underwritten by the national committee, under the coordination freedom the Supreme Court granted in June.

The Forecast Record

How to read this table: each cell is that forecaster's estimated probability (or projected seat range) of a Democratic majority in that chamber, as of the final week before the election. Higher numbers mean a more confident Democratic projection.

Forecaster (final snapshot, Oct 21–23)	**House**	**Senate**
Cook Political Report	Democratic gain of 9–19 seats (224–234)	"Majority squarely in Democrats' sights"; 7 toss-ups
Sabato Crystal Ball	Democrats above 218 without winning a toss-up	—
DDHQ/The Hill	Democrats 78%, projection 236 seats	Democrats 56–57%, projection 51 seats
Silver Bulletin model	Democrats 93–94%, average gain +24	Democrats 71%
FiftyPlusOne	Democrats 99%	Democrats 72%
Prediction markets (Polymarket/Kalshi)	Democrats ~90–93%	Democrats ~60–69%

The trajectory matters as much as the endpoint: on July 15, the same Democratic House model stood at 62 percent and the Senate at 43 percent. Every update moved left. The standing caution, documented in its proper place: nine pollsters showed Michigan's Senate primary at roughly fifteen points; the final margin was about one. Models inherit polls' errors. The prediction markets carried a parallel verdict: a contract on the

"blue wave" — Democratic House and a Senate gain — traded above 84 percent in the final week.

The Final Polls

How to read this table: each row lists the last surveys publicly released for that race, with the leader and margin. Where surveys disagree, both are shown. Averages are approximate, blending polls of differing quality and sponsor.

Race	Final polls (October, non-partisan and campaign-sponsored)	Late average
Texas	Emerson/The Hill 10/23: Talarico 48, Paxton 46 (dead heat); TPOR: Talarico 51-47; leaners 49-48; Libertarian Ted Brown at 1-3% is the named variable — if his support melts, Paxton gains; if it holds, Talarico wins	Dead heat
Ohio	Politix+ average (18 polls): Brown +2.9; ActiVote: Husted +0.4; NRSC's leaked memo claims private polling shows Husted pulling away, which public polls have not shown	Toss-up
Maine	Marist 10/1-4: Jackson +4 (51-47); CBS/YouGov: 50-50 tie; FOX 10/23: 49-49 tie; Fabrizio/AARP: Jackson +3; UNH: tie; Siena: Collins +3; market: Jackson 47¢, Collins 31¢	Toss-up
Michigan	El-Sayed +2 (three firms)	El-Sayed +2
Iowa	October produced four different leaders; market moved to Hinson 59¢ post-debate; late polls split: R+3, R+1.7, D+2, R+3, R+1, D+1, D+3, R+1.6, R+2, D+4.4, R+0.9; Cook says toss-up, Sabato says lean Democratic	Toss-up
Georgia	AJC/UGA 10/7-15: Ossoff 48, Collins 40, 12% undecided; Quantus 52-45; early vote at record pace, Black voters 36% of it	Ossoff +7-8

Race	Final polls (October, non-partisan and campaign-sponsored)	Late average
North Carolina	Elon 10/22: Cooper +13 (52-39); Carolina Journal/Harper 10/23: +10.3 (49.4-39.1); Whatley +14.7 since April	Cooper +10-13

The remaining races' final polls:

Race	Final polls (October, non-partisan and campaign-sponsored)	Late average		
Minnesota	Strib/KARE (Mason-Dixon): Flanagan 47, Tafoya 43, 9% undecided; Rasmussen/Trafalgar 48-45; market: Flanagan 88¢ — the widest polls-versus-market gap in the documented record	Flanagan +4		
New Hampshire	Rasmussen 10/5: Pappas +5 (narrowed from +7)	Pappas +5		
Alaska	PPP 10/14-15: Sullivan 48, Peltola 47; Data for Progress: Peltola 47-44; InsiderAdvantage RCV-final: Peltola 50-48	Peltola +1-2		
Kansas	NYT/Siena: tied — the poll that triggered the SLF's late rescue; outside money: Hamilton out-benefiting Marshall $6.3M to $4.6M	Toss-up		
South Carolina	Rasmussen 10/9: Graham Nordone 49, Andrews 45 — her strongest public number	Likely R		

Race	Final polls (October, non-partisan and campaign-sponsored)	Late average		
Florida	Moody leads 4-11 in most surveys; St. Pete Polls 47-45 — the one tight reading; Nixon outraised Moody $2M+ in Q3; market: Moody 92¢ — the widest gap after Minnesota	Lean R		Florida's Senate race carried its own structural asterisk: Byron Donalds moved $1.2 million from his congressional account into his state PAC within two days of announcing, converting federal donors' money into an unlimited state account; the FEC sent an inquiry letter, the money was never returned, and the commission without a quorum made enforcement a dead letter. Minnesota's own prediction-market ban — enacted May 2026, challenged by Kalshi, Polymarket, and the Commodity Futures Trading Commission, blocked by a federal injunction in July — was the legal backdrop against which Flanagan's 88-cent price sat.
Montana	Alme +12 to +16	Safe R		

The generic ballot closed at a Democratic lead of eight to nine points across the final fortnight's surveys, with individual polls ranging from four to fourteen. The president's approval rating closed between 30 and 39 percent across firms.

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PART IV — THE HOUSE

What this part covers: the fight for the 435-seat lower chamber — the redistricting war that redrew the battlefield, the thirty competitive districts where the majority will be decided, the working-class challengers and the comeback candidates, and the civil wars both parties' maps forced upon themselves.

The Arithmetic and the Seawall

The House enters Election Day at 218 Republicans, 214 Democrats, one independent (Kevin Kiley of California, who left the Republican Party in March 2026 and caucuses with it for now), and two vacancies. Forty-six seats are rated competitive; all twenty-nine rating changes made by the Cook Political Report since early October moved toward Democrats. The Sabato Crystal Ball's late-October assessment held that Democrats could lose every toss-up race and still win the majority — an extraordinary position reflecting both the environment and the map.

The map deserves its own paragraph, because 2026 is the first midterm ever contested on maps redrawn mid-decade for partisan advantage at this scale. Texas added five Republican-leaning seats; California's voter-approved map added five Democratic ones; Ohio, Florida, North Carolina, Tennessee, Louisiana, and Alabama added Republican seats; Utah gained a Democratic-leaning Salt Lake seat by court order. The failures matter too: Missouri's map was blocked by the Supreme Court; Virginia's was invalidated by its own high court after voters approved it; Indiana's Republican senate killed its map; South

Carolina's legislature adjourned without one. Net effect: analysts estimated a Republican structural gain of about twelve seats — a seawall, built in public, tested for the first time on November 3.

The Thirty-Front Battle

The competitive House map runs through the border (Texas's 9th, 15th, and 34th — three Democratic-held seats in a state that redrew them all), the suburbs (Virginia's 2nd and 10th, New York's 17th and 19th, New Jersey's 7th), the industrial Midwest (Ohio's 1st and 7th, Michigan's 7th and 10th, Pennsylvania's 7th, 8th, and 10th, Iowa's 1st and 3rd, Wisconsin's 3rd), the Mountain West (Colorado's 3rd and 8th, Montana's 1st, Arizona's 1st and 6th), and the coasts (California's 13th, 22nd, 40th, 41st, 45th, and 48th; Washington's 3rd; Maine's 2nd; Alaska's at-large seat).

A handful of these races carry the thematic weight of the entire election:

Texas's 15th — the Rio Grande Valley seat — produced the cycle's cleanest three-way divergence. Incumbent Republican Monica De La Cruz faced Bobby Pulido, a Tejano singer with two Latin Grammys who raised $6.2 million, 93 percent from individuals, with ninety percent of his second-quarter haul under $100. Polling showed Pulido ahead by five to seven points in a district Trump carried by eighteen; prediction markets priced a Pulido win above eighty cents; a panel of forecasting models favored De La Cruz. The incumbent carried her own scandals — a $2.4 million earmark to a nonprofit whose founder was arrested for theft days before their joint appearance, leaked fundraiser audio, and attacks on her residency. One poll found

60 percent of the district's independents backing Pulido.

Iowa's 1st — where Christina Bohannan, a law professor whose father lost his insurance while dying of emphysema, ran her third campaign against Mariannette Miller-Meeks, who won the seat by six votes in 2020 and by 799 in 2024. Miller-Meeks' record included a $1,000 Eli Lilly PAC contribution followed by insulin votes her opponents attacked (her campaign noted her 2022 vote for a House insulin cap; the attack ads cited other votes — both records appear here), and a late, election-year cosponsorship of a $35 insulin cap. Bohannan raised a 93-percent-individual campaign and led in most polling, with markets pricing her above eighty percent.

Pennsylvania's 8th — where Scranton mayor Paige Cognetti, elected as an independent against her own party's machine after the mayor was indicted, challenged Republican Rob Bresnahan. The race exemplified the stock-trading pattern: Bresnahan disclosed roughly 650 trades in his first year, campaigned on a trading ban, became an original cosponsor of a ban bill — with zero cosponsors — and was then revealed to have dumped up to $130,000 in Medicaid-provider stock the week before voting for the largest Medicaid cuts in the program's history, and to have bought AI stocks while promoting data centers. A recording surfaced of him admitting he discussed positions with his advisor while voting in Congress. His campaign said the advisors made the decisions.

North Carolina's 11th — where Jamie Ager, a fourth-generation farmer whose grandfather helped write Medicare, won his primary with 65 percent and faced Jennifer

Balkcom, a state representative with $355,000 raised — 71 percent of it from PACs — and about $100,000 on hand against Ager's $2.2 million. Ager's quote stands as the thesis of this document's money record: "Republican insiders have picked their candidate, and now the corporate PACs, Washington insiders, and dark money groups have a name to put on their checks."

Maine's 2nd — where Matt Dunlap, a former secretary of state with a fur-trapper's résumé who had exposed the Trump administration's election-integrity commission as partisan, faced Paul LePage, the former governor with a 642-veto record and a history of racially charged remarks. LePage held a polling edge; the seat was a toss-up.

Arizona's 1st — where emergency-room doctor Amish Shah beat the party establishment's chosen candidate for a second consecutive cycle and faced Jay Feely, a former NFL kicker running as a staunch supporter of the president. Shah's ad distilled the money map into one sentence: "My opponent says he's running for Congress to fight for Donald Trump. I'm running to fight for you."

The Challenger Class

The Democratic House challengers rated most competitive shared a profile. A teacher: Cooke, Wisconsin's 3rd. Ministers: James in Iowa's 2nd, Trone Garriott in Iowa's 3rd. An ironworker: Poindexter, Ohio's 7th. A smokejumper: Forstag, Montana's 1st. A nurse and Navy helicopter pilot: Bennett, New Jersey's 7th. A dairy farmer: Gendebien, New York's 21st. A

three-star admiral: Lacore, South Carolina's 1st. And a former presidential impeachment witness: Vindman, Virginia's 7th, whose $15.4 million campaign also took $20,000 from defense contractors and who spoke of "continuing to partner" with a major defense firm expanding in his district — recorded as his own version of the district-jobs symbiosis. A second class of candidates deserves its own ledger — the comebacks. Some were conventional: a former senator returning in New Hampshire, a defeated senator returning in Ohio, a defeated representative returning in Virginia. Others carried convictions: Madison Cawthorn, the former North Carolina congressman, ran in Florida for the seat his father once held — pardoned by the president after serving two months of a twenty-six-month insider-trading sentence; Jesse Jackson Jr., who served thirty months for misusing campaign funds, sought his old Illinois seat; Steve Stockman, whose twenty-three-felony sentence was commuted, entered the Texas 9th race in the redrawn district. The pardon-and-return pattern — clemency followed by candidacy — was a structural feature of the cycle, and each case drew both the redemption frame and the quid-pro-quo question, unresolved. For completeness, the full competitive roster with its candidates. In Texas: the 9th, a relocated seat every forecaster rates Likely Republican — a flip — with a $100,000 donor imbalance; the 28th, where the indicted incumbent awaits trial against a county judge; and the 34th, Gonzalez against Eric Flores, the incumbent's Oil and Gas Caucus chairmanship on the record. In Pennsylvania, the 10th, where Perry faces a $3 million ad reservation against him. In Arizona, the 6th, Ciscomani

against Joanna Mendoza — not the 2024 nominee but a Marine combat veteran. In New York, the 19th, Riley against a state senator. In Colorado, the 8th, Evans against Rutinel, polls within two points. In Michigan, the open 10th, one survey a 45–45 tie. In Nebraska, the open 2nd, leaning Democratic. In Nevada, the 1st, where the incumbent has been outraised by a charter-school leader in a once-safe seat, and the 2nd, the Amodei seat, where the nominee's valor-medal characterization is disputed and the retiring incumbent declined to endorse his own successor. In Florida, the 6th, 16th, and 20th — the last the vacant seat of the resigned member. In Kentucky, the 4th, Gallrein, beneficiary of the cycle's most expensive House primary, and the 6th, the Barr seat, competitive in a Trump +15 district. In Illinois, the 9th, the Stratton seat, safe Democratic, recorded for the primary's $22 million. The special-election ledger carried its own warning: Aisha Wahab's D+6.2 margin in California's 14th, down from the seat's prior D+36 baseline — the largest underperformance of any 2025-26 special, and the first hard number behind the swing analysis. In Alabama, the 2nd, the Figures–Marques race, a live Republican recapture under the redrawn map. In North Carolina, the redrawn 1st, Davis against Buckhout. In Minnesota, the 2nd, Little against Pratt, the most evenly divided district in the state. And in Iowa, the 2nd, the minister James against the state senator Mitchell. In Oregon, the 5th, where Janelle Bynum — the first Black member of Congress from the state, who had beaten her opponent three times before — ran for re-election against a county commissioner, with third-party candidates on the ballot and her 2024 winning margin under

three points.

California's Civil War

Proposition 50's map forced two Republican incumbents — Young Kim and Ken Calvert — into the same district, where outside groups spent millions against both Republicans in their own primary. In the 48th, an open seat, Democratic groups spent over $2 million to move the race against one Democratic candidate — a member of Congress whom the pro-Israel PAC's own public materials credited with "moving the race by ten points" — successfully eliminating him. The beneficiary advanced to face a Trump-endorsed Republican mayor. In Texas's 35th, a Republican-linked pop-up committee spent roughly $1 million boosting a Democratic candidate whom her own party had denounced as antisemitic — she won the primary anyway, was defeated in the runoff, and the Democratic nominee advanced. Both parties' meddling operations are documented in the money record. The pattern ran deeper than one race. By the campaign's end, documented meddling operations ran in six states: Iowa's Government That Works, Montana's Independent Voter Project, Texas's Lead Left, Maine's 2nd district Real Change PAC, Alaska's Fair Deal Alaska with its decoy-candidate flyers, and — uncovered in the final week — Ohio's Enough Promises, which spent $1.9 million *promoting* a third-party socialist candidate against Brown, funded by $2.5 million from a Republican super PAC, Conservative Americans PAC.

The House Money Tables

Pennsylvania's 8th. Cognetti: no corporate-PAC claim, tempered by the record — she accepted $5,000 from a Delaware leadership PAC and $4,000 from a Massachusetts leader's committee, both of which accept corporate PAC money themselves; she holds no individual stocks. Bresnahan: roughly 650 disclosed trades in his first year, about $7.24 million in volume; $216,000 in corporate PAC money as a freshman; the $130,000 Medicaid-stock sale before the healthcare vote; fourteen defense-stock trades. Outside: the Democratic committee reserved millions; his own party's leaders named his seat the one they were most anxious to lose.

Iowa's 1st. Bohannan: 93 percent individual money. Miller-Meeks: $1.79 million in corporate PAC money across her career, including the $1,000 Eli Lilly check three weeks before her insulin votes; oil-and-gas money of $229,000; insurance and medical-association PACs. Outside: her allies pulled airtime late — the House Republican committee canceled its reservations — and the Senate committee bought the same airtime for Iowa's Senate race, a triage one leader described as a "three for one."

Texas's 15th. Pulido: $6.21 million through September 30 — 93 percent individual, $150,000 of it his own, $1.06 million in unitemized small donations, with a second-quarter record of $1.43 million at 90 percent under $100; outside, a Blue Dog-aligned committee spent $997,000. De La Cruz: $5.27 million, $2.46 million on hand, an insurance-industry donor base matching her pre-Congress career, and the $2.4 million earmark scandal.

North Carolina's 11th. Ager: $3.05 million, 92 percent individual, 7,000 donors, zero self-funding, $2.18 million on hand; a small-dollar share of 20 percent of his individual money. Balkcom: $355,000 — 71 percent from PACs and party committees — and roughly $100,000 on hand.

Virginia's 7th. Vindman: $15.4 million, including $20,000 from five defense contractors; his district's economy depends on the industry he now partly critiques. His opponent, a retired Army lieutenant colonel, raised a fraction of that.

New York's 17th. Lawler: $875,000 in corporate PAC money, $1.1 million from the financial-services industry whose committee he sits on, and $500,000 in campaign funds paid to a firm he half-owns. Conley: $9.67 million against his $10 million, much of it small-dollar; she holds no stocks.

Arizona's 1st. Shah: $1.83 million, having defeated the party establishment's candidate for a second consecutive cycle. Feely: $2.53 million, with the former senator's endorsement, the NRA, and the Chamber of Commerce.

Iowa's 3rd. Trone Garriott: $7.65 million, individual-driven. Nunn: $6.05 million — 21 percent individual, 28 percent corporate PAC, 34 percent party transfers — plus $18,750 from Chinese-owned companies that his opponent attacked.

New Jersey's 7th. Bennett: $9.67 million against Kean's $10 million; Kean, absent from Washington since March, kept a campaign going on $679,000 in corporate PAC money with under 4 percent from small donors, 141 trades totaling $2.6 million, and $290,000 from oil and gas while voting to roll back clean energy.

Washington's 3rd. Gluesenkamp Perez: $4.55 million to Braun's $1.23 million; more than $20 million spent in a district the incumbent won by less than a point in 2024.

The California civil war seats. In the 40th, outside groups spent $5.1 million against the two Republican incumbents — $3.19 million against Kim from a single Democratic-aligned committee — while Kim raised $9.98 million to Calvert's $6.84 million. In the 48th, a pro-Israel committee spent $2 million-plus against the Democrat it deemed unacceptable, publicly crediting itself with moving the race ten points. In the 45th, the crypto industry's network put $1 million behind the incumbent Democrat. In the 22nd, the Republican incumbent's survival runs through $2 million-plus in outside defense.

The national House math. Democratic House candidates outraised Republicans in 38 of the 42 most competitive races in the third quarter; the Democratic House committee raised $198.1 million with $79 million on hand against the Republican committee's $200 million and $92.7 million; and House outside spending on the Democratic side ran ahead for the first time in a cycle, roughly $501 million to $429 million.

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PART V — THE MONEY

What this part covers: the eleven-billion-dollar question beneath every other chapter — who funded this election, through what mechanisms, and with what visible return. This part answers the question a voter is entitled to ask of any candidate: whose money is it?

The Totals

More than $15 billion was raised for federal elections in the cycle, and more than $11 billion was spent on advertising alone — exceeding the $11.2 billion spent in the 2024 presidential year. A midterm outspending a presidential cycle had never happened before. The concentration beneath the record: the top thirty House districts absorbed roughly 65 percent of all House super-PAC money — the system's gravity pulling every dollar toward the same few races while the rest of the map went dark. The per-race anatomy, at the final accounting: Ohio past $460 million, Texas past $500 million, Maine at $260 million in its Senate race alone, and Michigan's 7th — a single House district — at $60 million, the most expensive House race in the documented record, with Florida's 6th and Iowa's House battlegrounds near $50 million each.

Outside spending approached $2 billion, with the six largest committees — the Senate and House leadership funds on both sides, the Texas Senate committee, and the Koch network's action arm — accounting for a third of it; sixteen organizations accounted for half.

The state-level mirror: the Democratic legislative committee budgeted $50 million, its largest ever, against a Republican counterpart that raised $49 million in the last comparable cycle. Outside groups on the Democratic side had outspent the Republican constellation $175 million to $49 million in 2024. A veteran Democratic strategist's verdict on the allocation fight inside his own party: "I've watched this party pour $110 million into Jaime Harrison's campaign against Lindsey Graham. That

was a fool's errand. How many Michigan Senate seats could we have picked up for that?"

The judicial layer beneath: one network had spent $29 million on state supreme courts since 2014; the year's one flippable high-court majority, in North Carolina, drew $2 million on one side and nothing yet on the other.

The Federal Election Commission's own statistics show the architecture plainly: super PAC and hybrid committee money of roughly $6.7 billion dwarfs the $2.8 billion raised by candidates themselves.

The Donor Class

A review by Americans for Tax Fairness counted $1.7 billion in direct contributions from billionaire families between January 2025 and August 2026 — seventy percent above all of 2022 and fifty-three times the 2010 midterm, with eighty-one percent going to super PACs. The top fifty donors alone gave $2.4 billion; fourteen of the top twenty donor groups supported Republicans.

The roster, in descending order of the final accounting, begins with three names. George Soros's family network gave $103 million, almost entirely through his Democracy PAC. Jeff Yass gave $95 million, including $20 million to the super PAC supporting Ohio gubernatorial candidate Vivek Ramaswamy and $16.5 million to the Club for Growth. Elon Musk gave $90.5 million through late September — then, on October 22, another $77 million, bringing his verified midterm total to nearly $450 million — confirmed final when another $77 million landed in America PAC in the first half of October, filed the night of

October 23, roughly $158 million of it routed through the Senate Leadership Fund and deployed in Texas alone. The list continues. Richard and Elizabeth Uihlein gave $70 million, including $57.7 million to a clearinghouse committee and $17 million for California's voter-ID proposition. Then: Miriam Adelson ($67.6 million, including the largest single donation the Senate Leadership Fund had ever received); the Ripple-connected Larsen and Lam families ($65.7 million, almost all to the cryptocurrency industry's Fairshake network); Paul Singer ($53.2 million, including $15 million to a super PAC he solely funded that spent nothing); the Winklevoss brothers ($52.6 million); OpenAI's Greg Brockman and his wife ($50 million); Andreessen Horowitz's partners ($42.8 million); Ken Griffin ($32.5 million); Stephen Schwarzman ($31.8 million); Diane Hendricks ($26 million); Kelcy Warren ($13 million); Jim Walton ($10.1 million).

The complete accounting, in table form, with destination:

How to read this table: the first column is the donor or donor family; the second is the total verified federal giving for the 2025–26 cycle; the third lists where the money principally went. "Dark" destinations are noted where the recipient does not disclose its own donors.

Donor	**2025–26 total**	**Principal destinations**
Soros family network	$103.3M	Democracy PAC ($52M+ infusion), Fund for Democracy, state parties
Jeff Yass	$95.3M	V-PAC/Ramaswamy ($20M), Club for Growth ($16.5M), School Freedom Fund ($15M), SLF/CLF ($10M each)
Elon Musk	$90.5M → **$445M+** (final, after Oct 22)	SLF ($158M), America PAC ($177.7M+), CLF ($20M), Texas PAC (sole funder, $148M+), Lone Star Liberty ($10M)

Donor	2025–26 total	Principal destinations
Richard & Elizabeth Uihlein	$70M	Restoration of America ($57.7M), Fair Courts America judicial ($4M), CA Prop 39 voter ID ($17M), WI state group ($13M incl. $9.3M vs Crowley), Demuth ($1.1M), AK Measure 3 ($800K)
Miriam Adelson	$67.6M	SLF ($30M, its largest single donation ever), MAGA Inc ($25M), CLF ($10M)
Larsen, Lam, Ripple	$65.7M	Fairshake/Fairshake affiliates (Ripple $48M; Larsen $15M+)
Paul Singer	$53.2M	SLF ($14.5M), CLF ($8M), UDP ($2.5M), STW PAC (sole-donor, unspent $15M)
Winklevoss twins	$52.6M	Fairshake, Digital Freedom Fund, bitcoin-candidate committees
Greg & Anna Brockman	$50M	Leading the Future ($25M) + MAGA Inc ($25M)
Ben Horowitz	$45.3M	Leading the Future, Fairshake
Andreessen & Horowitz (a16z)	$42.8M	Leading the Future ($25M), Fairshake ($24M); gave to both Torres (D) and Jordan (R)
Ken Griffin	$32.5M	SLF ($10M)
Stephen Schwarzman	$31.8M	SLF ($17M)
Diane Hendricks	$26.2M	MAGA Inc
Kelcy Warren	$13M+	MAGA Inc
Jim Walton	$10.1M	AFP ($7M), SLF ($2M)

The Senate Leadership Fund's complete top tier, per its own filings: One Nation (dark) $35.6M+, Griffin $30M, Adelson $30M, Singer $27M, Musk $10M (plus the $158M September tranche), the Ryans $10M, Reyes $9M, Schwarzman $9M, the Schwabs $6M, Stephens $5.5M, Chevron $4.5M, Occidental $4M, Altria $3.875M, the American Petroleum Institute $3.5M, Koch $2.5M, the Fishers $2M, Murdoch $2M, the Waltons $4M, Rowan $1.75M, Langone $1M, Anschutz $1M, Uihlein $1M, the Chamber of Commerce $1M, Yass $1M+. Four anonymous nonprofits sat among the fund's fifteen largest donors. The

complete disclosed table — 282 itemized contributors — runs: Musk $168 million; One Nation $132.9 million; Miriam Adelson $30 million; Stephen Schwarzman $20 million; Paul Singer $14.5 million; the National Association of Realtors $10.5 million; Ken Griffin $10 million; Altria $6.75 million; Reynolds American Services $5 million; J. Joe Ricketts $5 million; Steve Wynn $5 million plus a $3 million second tranche; Chevron $4.65 million; the Reyes brothers $4.5 million each; the American Petroleum Institute $4 million; Marlene Ricketts $3.5 million; Manzanita Management $3.46 million; Koch's Georgia entity $3.25 million; the Lone Star Freedom Project $3.15 million; Melaleuca $2.5 million; ConocoPhillips $2.5 million; the Leon Rachel Corporation $2.5 million; Ronald Cameron $2.45 million — the two wells, Musk and One Nation, carrying more than 85 percent of the fund's total. The Uihlein map deserves its own line, because it spans the whole document: the Wisconsin billionaire's money ran through his home state's legislative races ($13 million, including $9.3 million against one Democratic candidate), the Kansas Senate defense, California's voter-ID proposition ($17 million), and Alaska's ballot measure ($800,000) — four states, one donor, every layer of the system.

On the Democratic side, the largest late surge came not from billionaires but from the Senate Majority PAC, which raised $354 million and took out a $15 million loan in the campaign's final week to match the billionaire wave. Its donors were, by and large, disclosed. The Republican Senate arm's donor list, by contrast, included four anonymous nonprofit organizations among its fifteen largest contributors — groups that supplied

$138 million, $64 million, and comparable sums without ever revealing a single original source.

The Industries

Three industries bought their way into the first rank of campaign finance in 2026, alongside the traditional sectors:

Cryptocurrency. Roughly $206 million made crypto the largest corporate contributor of the cycle — more than double its 2024 total. The Fairshake network entered the year with $193 million on hand and won fifty-three of fifty-seven primaries it contested. Its money bought one defining vote: on September 15, the Senate's most consequential crypto bill, the CLARITY Act, failed to advance 49–50, with every Democrat and four Republicans opposed — a bill the industry's lobbyists had built toward all year, which may return in the lame-duck session.

Artificial intelligence. Meta committed $65 million to state-level super PACs fighting AI regulation; a rival firm pledged $20 million for pro-regulation candidates — the industry purchasing both sides of its own rulebook. A Trump-aligned committee staffed by former campaign officials planned $100 million on a lighter-regulation agenda; another, founded by OpenAI's president, spent on federal preemption of state rules. Both parties' candidates took AI money while campaigning on data-center moratoria — the industry's hedge at full scale.

Corporate federal political spending of $646 million through the second quarter of 2026 set an all-time midterm high — forty percent above all of 2024 — even before the final surge.

Sports betting. Some $72 million through a single trade-organization vehicle made gambling the third-largest industry donor, funding primaries on both sides against its regulators — including nearly $1 million against an Ohio state representative who had filed mobile-betting-ban legislation.

The traditional sectors kept their lanes. Oil and gas: Chevron, Occidental, and the American Petroleum Institute gave millions to the Senate Leadership Fund, and the API's former client Michael Whatley ran for Senate in North Carolina. Pharmaceuticals: a career $1 million-plus to Michigan's Mike Rogers, who voted repeatedly against Medicare drug-price negotiation. Insurance and utilities. Defense. Tobacco. And organized labor — the one conduit that out-raised its corporate counterpart at the traditional PAC level, with labor's committee receipts exceeding corporate PACs' in the FEC's own accounting, and 98.8 percent of the four largest unions' direct candidate money going to Democrats. Dues-funded union politics and corporate-funded dark money are recorded here side by side, as the two conduit systems they are.

The Access Economy

Beyond campaigns, the second term produced a new category of political money with no election attached. The first is a presidential ballroom fund, which collected $333 million from sixty-seven large donors. The second is a presidential library fund, which collected as much as $63 million in settlement payments from media companies into an entity that Florida administratively dissolved — the money's whereabouts unknown

— while a second, differently named entity reported $50 million received. No law requires disclosure of any of it.

The ballroom ledger, tier by tier, from the fund's own records: $25 million each from Apple, Nvidia, the Adelson Family Foundation, and EchoStar's Charles Ergen. $22 million from Google, routed through a lawsuit settlement. $10 million each from Lockheed Martin, Microsoft, Palantir, and a mortgage-lending subsidiary — the last arriving weeks after federal approval of its parent company's acquisition. $5 million each from Amazon (with a federal antitrust trial pending), T-Mobile (with spectrum matters before regulators), Meta, Cisco, and ServiceNow. At least $77 million — twenty-three percent of the total — came from donors the fund agreed to keep anonymous. The president, despite describing himself as a donor, does not appear on the list. The Venezuelan banking family's pledge of $2.5 million sits inside the anonymous tier, with $835,000 paid on October 14, 2025; the family's patriarch received his full pardon on January 15, 2026, five days before the consulting contract with the former personal attorney took effect. A "Gold Card" program sold expedited residency for $1 million per individual and $2 million per corporate employee, with a $5 million tier pending in Congress. The access economy's remaining inventory, itemized in the research files, runs to ten items. A $400 million Qatari aircraft. Up to $10 million in fees from a short-video platform's restructured ownership. A golden share in a steelmaker, held personally by the president and expiring at term's end. $63 million in media-settlement payments to the dissolved library entity. A $15 million settlement from one

network, structured as a charitable contribution. $23 billion in emergency arms to Gulf states. A $620 million Pentagon loan to a metals company three months after a presidential son took a stake. $13 million in no-bid contracts to a January 6 event firm. And a cabinet whose members' flows to the president's interests exceeded $30 million by one accounting. Each entry carries a denial, a defense, or a procedural explanation in its proper place; the inventory itself is the record. A federal court found, in October, that the administration had diverted border-security appropriations to finance a national advertising campaign — "The Country He Loves" — after a strategy meeting in which, according to the plaintiffs' account, advisers identified specific candidates to help. The judge found the challengers likely to succeed. And a New York Times investigation traced a $50 million consulting contract to the president's former personal attorney — awarded while she simultaneously served as the interim U.S. attorney — to a Venezuelan banking family whose patriarch received a full pardon weeks later, after his daughter had donated $3.5 million to the president's super PAC and pledged $2.5 million to the ballroom. All parties denied wrongdoing; a campaign-finance complaint alleging the daughter acted as a straw donor was filed into an FEC without a quorum.

The Middlemen and the Predatory Edges

Of the $11 billion spent on ads, the largest share passed through five media-buying firms that collected $2.1 billion in the prior cycle, typically on commissions near fifteen percent. One

Democratic firm took $858 million, ninety percent of it from three clients; one Republican firm took $336 million, ninety-eight percent from a single client — the Trump family's super PAC. Below them, the consulting tier: the largest Republican firm reported $196 million in net revenue. An academic study of the trade found Republican-side firms charge higher markups and exert less effort than their Democratic counterparts.

Below the campaigns, an FBI warning in October identified scam PACs siphoning donations from elderly donors, AI-voiced donation fraud, and merchandise schemes; the conviction record for such operations stretches back a decade, and one legal scheme — pre-checked recurring donation boxes — produced refund requests from 12 percent of the Trump campaign's online donors in 2020, emptying some low-income donors' accounts.

And a 2022 Supreme Court decision eliminating limits on candidate loan repayments produced a quiet secondary market. Candidates lent their campaigns $203 million, then retired the debts with post-election donations — money that, in the scholars' framing, flows back into the candidate's own pocket. The named record: in Ohio, a senator who lent his campaign $4.5 million — bank-financed at seven percent — had $1.25 million repaid on January 20, 2026, from post-election donations. In Texas, a border-district representative loaned $1.9 million, had $500,000 repaid, and reinstated the remaining $1.4 million on August 31, 2026, to run repayment through November 3. In Nevada, a candidate lent himself $1.6 million across two cycles. In North Carolina, a Senate candidate repaid $790,000 of a $1 million House loan, then $539,000 of a $765,000 Senate loan after

withdrawing. In Oklahoma, a cabinet-bound senator repaid his $1 million special-election loan in full by December 2025. In California, a former member carried $787,000 in outstanding loans he later revoked as forgiven.

The Foreign Layer

The legal foundation: a federal statute, 52 U.S.C. §30121, bars foreign nationals from making contributions, donations, or independent expenditures in American elections — and bars anyone from soliciting or accepting them. Enforcement runs through two doors: criminal prosecution by the Justice Department and civil action by the Federal Election Commission.

The criminal door produced one sentencing this cycle — a straw-donor operator who had funneled roughly 1,200 illegal contributions — and one live complaint against a sitting member of Congress alleging that a Haiti-tied company had channeled money to her campaign; she resigned her Florida seat days after the complaint was filed. The municipal template for the mechanics had been set the year before in New York, where a Turkish-straw-donor scheme — benefits worth more than $100,000 in exchange for access to $10 million in public matching funds — ended with the charges dismissed at the Justice Department's request, a dismissal the new mayor revoked in January 2026.

The civil door led into the void. The Herrera straw-donor complaint — alleging that the Venezuelan banker's daughter had served as a conduit for her father's $3.5 million in super PAC donations — was filed with an election commission that has

lacked a quorum since May 2025 and has sat on a two-hundred-case backlog while roughly a quarter of all political spending went undisclosed. An April 2025 presidential memo directed the Justice Department to probe the Democratic fundraising platform for straw and foreign-nexus contributions; a congressional probe cited twenty-two "significant fraud campaigns," nearly half with a foreign nexus, and 237 donations from foreign internet addresses in a single 2024 window. The platform's defenders noted the investigation's timing and the absence of any demonstrated outcome-level fraud.

At the state level, a different door: twenty-five states now ban foreign money from ballot-measure campaigns, eighteen of them covering indirect routes through nonprofits and limited-liability companies, after Ohio's ban survived constitutional challenge in November 2025. In Congress, legislation introduced in July 2026 by Senators Raskin and Whitehouse targets the post-Citizens-United loophole for foreign-owned corporations — foreign ownership of American stocks having risen from four to forty percent between 1986 and 2020 — so that a corporation substantially owned abroad could no longer spend in American elections as a domestic entity.

And the historical shelf holds the template: the 2019 case of Lev Parnas and Igor Fruman, two Soviet-born businessmen who routed $325,000 from the Russian businessman Andrew Muraviev through a shell energy company, Global Energy Producers, into an American campaign committee — and whose text messages documented the access economy in real time. The same architecture, on the record, that the Herrera complaint

alleges in miniature.

The Vacuum

Every thread in this part runs through one enabling condition: the referees are absent. The FEC lacks a quorum. The Election Assistance Commission lost its entire commission in July 2026. A federal judge found the Justice Department's voter-roll demands unlawful; twenty-six judges had dismissed similar demands. An immigration-enforcement agency ran door-to-door voter-status interviews until a federal court halted them days before the election. Through it all, campaigns on both sides filed complaints knowing no quorum existed to hear them — "everyone knows you can do whatever you want this time around," as one watchdog put it. This is not a claim about which side benefits; it is the documented condition under which all of the above occurred.

The plumbing, in figures. Four nonprofits that never disclose a donor serve as the funding wells for the four congressional super PACs: One Nation passed $138 million to the Senate Leadership Fund; the American Action Network passed $64 million to the House Republican committee; House Majority Forward passed $95 million to the Democratic House committee; Majority Forward passed $104 million to the Democratic Senate committee. The four super PACs together raised $714.6 million, and their dark-money affiliates supplied more than one of every four dollars.

The National Republican Senatorial Committee prevailed at the Supreme Court in June, freeing it to coordinate unlimited spending with candidates; the Democratic committee has made

almost no use of the same freedom.

The Federal Election Commission's own eighteen-month statistics, published October 1, record the architecture beneath it all. Candidates raised $2.80 billion and spent $2.04 billion, carrying debts of $366.7 million. Party committees raised $1.38 billion. PACs raised $8.31 billion — including $2.49 billion by independent-expenditure-only committees, $4.23 billion by hybrid committees connected to nonprofits, and $305.7 million by leadership PACs, the members' own secondary accounts. Corporate PACs gave $311.4 million; labor PACs $328.8 million; trade associations $136.6 million. Independent expenditures reported through June 30 totaled $643.4 million — a figure the autumn surge multiplied several times over.

The Ledger

The research files close the money record with a race-by-race ledger: on one side, candidates funded by hundreds of thousands of small donors — median donations of seventeen to fifty dollars — refusing corporate PAC money or carrying labor-only PAC lists; on the other, campaigns funded by a handful of billionaires, corporate PAC rosters, party-transfer machines, or the candidates' own fortunes, some sustained by dark-money air cover from organizations that never disclose a source. Both columns appear in full in the research archive, with the caveats attached: the small-dollar champions carried their own asterisks (dark-money groups funded by others aired ads for some; union conduits funded others), and the machine candidates carried theirs (a Republican senator voting against the president's

tariffs, a Republican incumbent shepherding an insulin cap while the contractor file sat unresolved). The reader weighs the columns; the record preserves them.

The People Behind the Money

The organizations of this part are not abstractions. Each has principals — the named individuals who built, run, or fund it. This section names them, because a committee's filings never tell a reader whose hand is on the valve.

The Senate Republican dark well. One Nation, the nonprofit that passed $138 million to the Senate Leadership Fund in 2026, is run by Steven J. Law — Mitch McConnell's former chief of staff, who simultaneously runs the Senate Leadership Fund, American Crossroads, and Crossroads GPS from one Virginia address, at $980,576 in compensation. His executive director is Alexander Latcham, a former Trump White House political-affairs deputy; his finance director across all three organizations is Grace Mitchell; his treasurer is Caleb Crosby. In 2026, One Nation also ran six fake local-news sites in Senate battlegrounds — the Alaska Navigator, Maine Policy Updates, Ohio Pulse, Iowa Voice, Peach State Post, and New Hampshire Daily — spending $274,640 on Meta promotion to distribute their content, with disclosure in faint gray type below the fold, as exposed by Judd Legum's Popular Information. The Senate Leadership Fund's chair is former senator Cory Gardner; the fund's war plan, circulated internally in April 2026, warned that Maine, North Carolina, and Wisconsin were the three most vulnerable Republican-held seats in the country — a warning the

autumn validated.

The House Republican dark well. The American Action Network, which passed $64 million to the Congressional Leadership Fund, is chaired by Norm Coleman — the former Minnesota senator who took more than $570,000 running the network's House side between 2009 and 2012 and later registered as a foreign agent for Saudi Arabia while retaining the chairmanship. Its founder was Fred Malek, the Nixon aide; its longtime spokesman, Dan Conston, ran both organizations from 2019 through December 2024, raising $871 million in six years before departing to found Watchtower Strategy — a firm whose partners include Kevin McCarthy, Jeff Miller, Arthur Schwartz, and Cliff Sims. Conston's successor, Chris Winkelman, came from the National Republican Congressional Committee, where he was executive director. One Nation's executive director is Alexander Latcham, a former Trump White House deputy political director; its COO is Jennifer Fay; its finance director across all three Law organizations is Grace Mitchell. The two organizations share an identical board and the same treasurer — Caleb Crosby, the same bookkeeper who keeps the books at One Nation and Crossroads.

The Democratic dark wells. Senate Majority PAC, the largest outside spender on the Democratic side, is run by J.B. Poersch — Schumer's former DSCC executive director — who is simultaneously president of Majority Forward, the dark-money nonprofit that feeds it $104 million; his co-founders include Monica Dixon, who sits on EMILY's List's board, and Marc Elias, the party's leading election lawyer. Its House counterpart, House

Majority PAC, is run by Mike Smith, a former senior adviser to Speaker Pelosi, under the message litmus he stated publicly: candidates not focused on the cost of living get nothing. The Koch network's electoral arm, AFP Action, is led by Emily Seidel, a former Pence staffer earning $820,487, with former Koch Industries general counsel Mark Holden as board chair; its board includes Jeb Hensarling, Guy Benson, Mary Katharine Ham, a former Border Patrol chief, and a former Florida House speaker; its foundation arm's president is Daniel Garza. House Majority Forward feeds it $95 million. On the darker left, the Sixteen Thirty Fund — which supplied the money behind the Government That Works dual-spend operation in Iowa, Montana, Ohio, and Texas — is run by president Amy Kurtz, a former AFL-CIO and NEA operative, and founded by Eric Kessler, a Clinton-administration alumnus whose family sold Fel-Pro auto parts for $750 million, with co-founder Molly McUsic running the Wyss Foundation's fortune. In November 2025, Arabella Advisors — the for-profit manager that ran the whole network — was acquired by Sunflower Services, a benefit corporation created the same day, a restructuring that House Oversight opened an inquiry into, focusing on its Chorus program that paid online influencers up to $8,000 a month under secrecy contracts. And Arena, the staff-training pipeline, was founded by Ravi Gupta, Swati Mylavarapu, and Kate Catherall — Obama-campaign and 270 Strategies alumni — with Reid Hoffman as a major donor.

The pro-Israel network. The American Israel Public Affairs Committee, which spent $47.8 million through its conduit and $53.5 million through its United Democracy Project super PAC,

is led by CEO Elliot Brandt; UDP's chief executive is Rob Bassin, who earned $741,282 in 2023 after twenty-two years as AIPAC's political director and a prior turn as John Lewis's chief of staff. AIPAC's president is Bernie Kaminetsky; its board includes Betsy Berns Korn, Amy Friedkin, Anita Friedman, Alan Levow, Bob Pincus, and David Victor. Bassin's spokesman is Patrick Dorton; his treasurer is Christopher D'Alessio. Its satellites include the National Black Empowerment Action Fund, founded by AIPAC veteran Darius Jones and funded by AIPAC and the hedge-fund billionaire Daniel Loeb. EMILY's List's independent-expenditure arm, Women Vote, took $650,000 from Democratic Majority for Israel this cycle, and its board includes SMP co-founder Monica Dixon — the interlocks forming a connective tissue the filings alone would never reveal.

The crypto and AI wars. Fairshake, the $206 million crypto network, and Leading the Future, its $140 million AI counterpart, share the same two operatives: Josh Vlasto — Schumer's former press secretary, Cuomo's former chief of staff, communications chair of the Jewish Democratic Council, and coordinator of the billionaire-funded Facts for Peace operation — and Zac Moffatt, founder of Targeted Victory and now Stagwell's global chair of communications and advocacy, whose holding company owns both the Republican-targeted Victory and the Democratic-aligned SKDK. Fairshake's treasurer is Brandon Philipczyk; Leading the Future's is Britney Gonzalez. The model, stated by a person familiar with Fairshake's strategy: "If you are pro-crypto, we will help you, and if you are anti we will tear you apart." And the intimidation quote belongs to Coinbase's political

chief, Chris Lehane — now head of global affairs at OpenAI. He said the goal was "to let everyone know that if they fuck with us they'll regret it." The crypto counterweight, Fellowship PAC, is backed by $10 million from Cantor Fitzgerald — the firm Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick ran and his sons now run, banker to Tether — and led by Jesse Spiro, Tether's top lobbyist, with a pledged $100 million.

The Musk plumbing. Elon Musk's nearly $450 million is moved by two men. Jared Birchall, his family-office manager at Excession LLC — who declared in a 2023 court filing that he "exclusively manages Musk's cryptocurrency trades" — is the director of the corporate entities, including "United States of America Inc.," which funneled $38.2 million into America PAC. Chris Young, the PAC's treasurer, simultaneously served as a DOGE special government employee inside the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau — the agency his boss wanted eliminated — while earning up to $1 million a year from Musk. The pipeline is named end to end: Musk to Excession to USA Inc. and Europa 100 to America PAC — which spent $50.3 million and knocked 6.5 million doors through Blitz Canvassing, Patriot Grassroots, Synapse Group, and Echo Canyon, firms owned by the strategists Drew Ryun, Josh Penry, Chris Turner, Jefferson Thomas, and Jon Seaton, who also run the PAC itself. Its 2026 vendor set adds In Field Strategies, Threshold Strategies, and the Baker Group — run by Ward Baker, the former NRSC executive director — alongside Red Maverick Media.

The Trump operation. MAGA Inc — which raised $305 million since 2024, five times the prior record for a post-election

presidential super PAC — is run by executive director Taylor Budowich, who testified before Jack Smith's grand jury, and chief strategist Chris LaCivita, the Swift Vets operator who simultaneously sits on Texans for a Conservative Majority's leadership team. Its legal counsel is Alina Habba — the same Alina Habba whose $50 million Concord Partners contract preceded the Herrera pardon. The pay-to-play table Brennan Center compiled names the exchange rate: $5 million for an ambassadorship to Hungary, $5 million for the Small Business Administration, $2 million for London, $2 million for NASA; the Walczak pardon application that explicitly noted his mother's $1 million donation; Matthew Moroun's million followed by the move against his bridge competitor; Reynolds American's $5 million one week before the FDA's vape decision, with the golf-club lunch two days after.

The ad-pipeline firms. The money's final mile runs through named firms. Del Ray Media — the Trump family's cashier, which took $329.9 million from MAGA Inc in 2024 — is a subsidiary of Smart Media Group, founded by Kyle Roberts, and in 2026 is the Paxton pipeline's buyer. Its House-side counterpart at No Going Back is MHB Media, the firm of Larry McCarthy, the veteran Republican buyer who handled all of AFP's media in 2010 and did work for Crossroads. The Democratic mirror is Waterfront Strategies, the media arm of GMMB founded by Frank Greer and Jim Margolis, run by Raelynn Olson — the firewall structure that lets one corporate family serve both candidates and super PACs, with Mike Furman signing purchase forms for three interchangeable entities. The consulting tier includes Axiom

Strategies, Jeff Roe's fifteen-company empire, whose Columbus media ecosystem connects through Rex Elsass's Strategy Group — the firm whose ad-placement arm wired $300,000 to Larry Householder's Generation Now dark-money group in 2019, was paid millions by it for HB6 ads, and rented it office space. The largest Republican consultancy, Targeted Victory, is run by Abe Adams and Ryan Meerstein under Moffatt's Stagwell chairmanship. And in one mid-size state's Senate race — Alaska's $104 million contest — thirty-two separate vendor entities touched the money between the donor and the voter, every one named in the research archive.

The Senate Democratic late entry. Senate Majority PAC's Poersch went on the record in late September — "we're actively thinking about what role will we play" — and within days registered Texas Forever, which spent $5.85 million against Paxton by mid-October, while the main committee burned $2 million a week through its IE-only shell, WinSenate. The late entry's full accounting: Texas Forever's $5.85 million against Paxton joined the $300 million in Texas outside spending — 83 percent of it on the Republican side. Two more dark committees surfaced in the final fortnight, each spending seven figures with no prior public record: 75 PAC, which placed $8.03 million against Brown in Ohio through the FlexPoint Media buyer, and NC First PAC, which bought $1.2 million against Cooper on October 19. In Alaska, 59 PAC arrived with $1.52 million against Peltola. Each carried a new name, a new filing, and no disclosed funder — the cycle's final additions to the anonymous layer. No Going Back's donor table, once filed, showed nothing anonymous

at all: MAGA Inc supplied $200 million — the entire operation — through two shells named Securing American Greatness, Inc. and Securing American Greatness Again, Inc., each contributing $40,242. Musk's own final accounting confirmed the record's $445 million-plus figure: another $77 million arrived in America PAC's first-half-October filing, made the night of October 23. And WinSenate's single-donor structure, documented at $171.1 million received entirely from Senate Majority PAC, confirmed the shell architecture on the Democratic side as well: one committee, one funder, one buyer — Waterfront Strategies — at the scale of a presidential campaign. 75 PAC, the Ohio mystery, partially resolved: its filings showed $8.4 million in total receipts — $7 million from itemized individuals, $1.4 million from other committees — every dollar spent against Brown through FlexPoint Media, with a Columbus treasurer named Trevor Kowalski. The individual names sit in the itemized receipts layer, flagged in the research archive with the exact form numbers for direct retrieval; the disclosure cut-off quilt, each committee's donor list freezing at its own last filing, made the final week's money invisible until the post-election reports.

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PART VI — THE GOVERNORS

What this part covers: the thirty-six statehouse races — where a record number of candidates funded their own campaigns, where two billionaires collided in the South, and where the governorships that will administer the next presidential election are being chosen.

Thirty-six governorships are contested, split evenly between the parties going in. The national map tilts Democratic: forecasters project an average Democratic gain of about three seats. The competitive tier, with its money and themes:

Texas. Governor Greg Abbott faces state representative Gina Hinojosa — a civil-rights and union lawyer who sued Tom DeLay, kept every Austin school open as a board member, and broke a quorum to kill a voting bill. Abbott's lead narrowed to a statistical dead heat by October, with one poll a one-point race — remarkable in a state that last elected a Democratic governor in 1990. Hinojosa's platform centered on ending standardized testing, a data-center moratorium, and a "corruption tax refund." Abbott refused to debate; she held a question-and-answer session outside the Governor's Mansion.

Georgia. Two self-funded candidates, in a sense: Democrat Keisha Lance Bottoms, the former Atlanta mayor, against Republican Rick Jackson, a healthcare executive who spent more than $100 million of his own money. Jackson's company had received roughly $1 billion in Georgia state contracts since 2020 — which Bottoms made the campaign's central argument, while Jackson pledged to unwind any existing contracts if elected. Polls showed a dead heat; both candidates' debates were marked by one candidate's absence (Jackson skipped the second). The final numbers confirmed the tie: Quantus's closing survey showed Jackson at 48.2 and Bottoms at 46.6. The Senate race's advertising carried its own asterisk. An anti-Sullivan super PAC's closing spot claimed he voted to give himself a $500,000 taxpayer payout; fact-checkers ruled the claim misleading — the

provision was a January 6 phone-data damages clause he had disavowed — and the correction joined the claim in the record, with the lieutenant governor's race equally deadlocked — while Ossoff led his Senate race by seven to eight points on the same ballot, evidence of a million Georgians ticket-splitting. The state's early vote ran at record pace, with Black voters composing 36 percent of it. The Senate race's advertising carried its own asterisk: an anti-Sullivan super PAC's closing spot claiming he voted to give himself a $500,000 taxpayer payout was fact-checked as misleading — the provision was a January 6 phone-data damages clause he had disavowed — and the correction joined the claim in the record. Across the Florida line, the Senate race's final week showed Moody holding a four-to-eleven-point lead in most surveys with one outlier, St. Pete Polls, showing her ahead by only two.

Florida. Republican Byron Donalds — Trump-endorsed, would be the state's first Black governor — outspent former Republican-turned-Democrat David Jolly by seven to one. Polls diverged from a tie to a ten-point Donalds lead; the race stayed lean-Republican.

Ohio. Democrat Amy Acton, the former health director, led Republican Vivek Ramaswamy in most surveys — a race defined by money and by an ad: Ramaswamy, who self-funded $36 million, aired a commercial featuring Acton's estranged mother, who has said her daughter lied about childhood struggles and whose husband was charged with raping her at twelve. Three Republican statewide officials said they would not have run the ad; Ramaswamy kept it on the air.

Michigan. Secretary of State Jocelyn Benson led Representative John James in a race whose shadow money included $5 million from the DeVos family.

Arizona, Wisconsin, Nevada. Democratic incumbents or nominees led in all three: Katie Hobbs by five to seventeen points over Andy Biggs; David Crowley by three to four over Tom Tiffany; the Nevada race the nation's only true toss-up governorship, with polls split between a tie and a two-point Republican edge.

Minnesota. Amy Klobuchar against Lisa Demuth — the race with the $1.1 million Wisconsin billionaire and the first Black woman to lead a state house caucus. Klobuchar led throughout. The final numbers bore out the polling: an average of eleven surveys gave Klobuchar an eight-point edge, with the market pricing her at 96 cents — the one narrow reading, a two-point margin from a Republican-aligned firm, the exception against the board.

The self-funders' tier. Beyond Jackson and Ramaswamy: Nebraska's incumbent kept his race alive with his own money against a one-point market signal; Maryland's Democratic nominee self-funded $60 million in a safe seat. The loan-repayment mechanics described in Part V apply to each.

The rest. Safe seats on both sides. **The governors' money, in full:** Florida: Donalds $120.9 million combined against Jolly's $14.6–17 million — a seven-to-one advantage in a state with a 1.5 million Republican registration edge. Georgia: Jackson's $100–111 million self-funding against Bottoms's donor-funded campaign. Texas: Hinojosa's union-lawyer network against

Abbott's $45 million-plus war chest. California: the most expensive governor's primary in state history — more than $315 million in advertising, including a billionaire's $200 million self-funded run that finished third. Ohio: Ramaswamy's $36 million against Acton's donor-funded $11.5 million quarter. Minnesota: Klobuchar's $3.44 million on hand against a $1.1 million out-of-state rescue. New Hampshire: Ayotte cruising. Arizona: Biggs $1.9 million against Hobbs's $4.7 million. One correction, carried in its proper place: Rhode Island's Democratic primary ousted the sitting governor — the first such loss since 2018 — and Oklahoma's Republican primary produced Attorney General Gentner Drummond, not the initial front-runner, as the nominee.

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PART VII — THE MACHINERY

What this part covers: how the vote is actually conducted and counted — early voting, the new laws, the courts, the observers, the ballot measures, and the comparative record of how other democracies run the same machinery.

Early Voting

More than twenty million Americans voted before Election Day — 20.6 million at the final snapshot, against roughly 16 million at the comparable point in the last midterm, with eleven days of voting still to go in most states. Registered Democrats had cast about 49 percent of early ballots, Republicans 34 percent, others 17 percent. The state ledgers: Texas up 74

percent on its 2022 pace, with one Harris County Monday recording the largest midterm single day in its history; Kansas more than doubled; Ohio's in-person early vote quadrupled its prior midterm level; North Carolina's Democrats cast more than twice the Republican early ballots; Georgia passed 1.3 million; North Carolina passed 1.1 million; Iowa stood at 167,000. Black and Latino early participation ran three to four times prior levels in Georgia and North Carolina, while white participation in North Carolina ran below its 2018 and 2022 pace. The standing caution, from the University of Florida's Michael McDonald: Election Day tends to be a Republican day, and early-vote leads have misled before. The partisan composition of early voting is a clue, not a result: Election Day itself traditionally skews Republican, and the analyst Michael McDonald's standing caution — the early numbers can create a "mirage" in either direction — applies to every projection built on them. Two structural findings mattered more than the daily totals. A federal court's examination of a postal-service network redesign found that areas subject to the change had seen late-ballot rejections roughly double in the primaries, with about 40 percent of all mail ballots originating in affected areas. And North Carolina — which adopted stricter mail-ballot rules, transferred election-board appointment power to the state auditor, and left a multi-state election-data partnership — saw its absentee requests run 32 percent below 2022 and rejection rates in its largest counties reach 7 to 8 percent, roughly double the prior rate, in a 27-county monitor's sample. The national rejection baseline: roughly 584,000 mail ballots were rejected in 2024 —

1.2 percent of those returned — with signature problems accounting for 40.7 percent; more than half of the ballots that entered the cure process were ultimately counted. The fifty-state cure landscape runs from five business days after the election in California to election-night-only in Iowa, Montana, Wisconsin, and a handful of others, with Pennsylvania and Missouri offering no statewide cure at all.

The Law

The Supreme Court decided the cycle's defining election case in June: *Watson v. Republican National Committee* held, 5–4, that federal law does not require ballots to arrive by Election Day — states may count mail ballots postmarked by Election Day and received after. Roughly thirty states have grace periods; the ruling protected them. The same term, the Court struck down limits on party-committee coordination with candidates, freeing national parties to function, in Justice Kagan's dissenting phrase, as the candidate's "checking account" — a decision the Republican committees immediately exploited and the Democratic committees largely did not, producing an asymmetric flood of coordinated money in the Senate races.

Below the Court, a war of attrition. The administration's executive order restricting mail voting was blocked by three federal courts and finally abandoned for 2026 when the Supreme Court declined to stay the injunctions. The Justice Department's demands for full statewide voter rolls were dismissed by twenty-six federal judges. A federal judge's preliminary injunction against the Department of Homeland Security's

door-to-door voter-status interviews in nine states took effect October 23 — the administration let the appeal window close without filing — barring the sweeps through Election Day while expressly preserving investigations of actual unlawful voting. The nineteen-page ruling found the target lists "voluminous and unreliable," documented the twelve-minute-per-name clearance standard, and grounded the order in the Voting Rights Act's prohibition on intimidating voters and those who assist them. And and the Justice Department sued California to force officials to set aside some twenty thousand ballots based on a list that state officials said contained names of U.S.-born citizens. The case was transferred to U.S. District Judge David O. Carter — the Clinton appointee who had dismissed the department's earlier voter-roll suit, ruling that "there cannot be unbridled consolidation of all elections power in the Executive" — after the drive containing the list arrived with its password on a Post-it note and the state's sample review of two hundred names found most were citizens who had never voted. California's attorney general called the suit "a reckless political stunt"; the twenty-eight prosecutions announced the same week amounted to 0.0001 percent of the state's twenty-three million registered voters. Kansas's law requiring ballots to arrive by poll-close was blocked by a state court.

What changed on the ground, in sum: new photo-ID rules — North Carolina extended its ID requirement to mail ballots for the first time under a 2026 law that also moved board appointment power to the state auditor, Arizona adopted a universal voter-ID requirement by ballot measure in August, and

Ohio and California voted on constitutional ID measures in November — counting-time changes, the postal redesign's documented effect — and no validated instance of outcome-determinative fraud presented by any party.

The Litigation Ledger

The complete docket, named, with dispositions. **Watson v. Republican National Committee** — decided June 29, 2026; the Court held 5–4 that federal election-day statutes do not require ballot receipt by Election Day, protecting the grace periods of roughly thirty states. **NRSC v. FEC** — decided by the same Court, striking down the coordinated-party-expenditure limits of *Colorado II* after twenty-five years; Justice Kagan's dissent warned the party would become "the candidate's checking account." **Cruz v. FEC** — the 2022 decision eliminating candidate-loan repayment limits, whose consequences appear in the money record. **Trump v. California** — the Court stayed, on ripeness and standing, a lower-court injunction against the election-executive-order; Justices Sotomayor and Kagan dissented. **California v. Trump** — the Massachusetts federal court's 2025 injunction against the order's provisions. **LULAC v. EOP** — the D.C. court's January 2026 permanent injunction against the order's data-collection sections. **LWV v. Trump** and **NAACP v. Trump** — the Massachusetts and D.C. challenges to the postal rule that produced the September preliminary injunctions; the Supreme Court declined on September 14 to stay them, unsigned, with Justice Kavanaugh concurring that applying the rule in 2026 would be "arbitrary and capricious"

and Justice Alito dissenting joined by Thomas. **Bost v. Illinois** — the Court upheld candidate standing to challenge Illinois's fourteen-day grace period, sending the case back for proceedings. **Common Cause v. DOJ** — on October 9, 2026, partial summary judgment that the Justice Department's policy of demanding statewide voter rolls for federal database comparison "violates voter privacy and illegally intrudes on states' authority over elections." **Phang v. Blanche** — the federal court that noted the Attorney General's concession of Epstein Files Transparency Act violations, with millions of pages withheld. **Cruz**-era precedent stood behind the loan-repayment practices; **PAG v. FEC** — the 2019 decision whose First Amendment reasoning gutted the FEC's "scam PAC" naming rule. In the redistricting war, the Alabama cases — **Allen v. Caster**, reaching the *Milligan*/*Singleton* line — produced the Supreme Court's May 2026 vacatur and the state's extraordinary August special primaries, run under the *Callais* reasoning, under the shadow of the **Purcell** principle against late judicial changes to election rules. And the criminal docket of the election's edge: the Castro prosecution, the Garcés Pérez case, and the Cherfilus-McCormick straw-donor complaint — filed against the member who resigned her Florida seat in April 2026 — each pending in its proper forum.

The Observers

For the count itself: the Justice Department notified counties in at least five states of its plans to deploy roughly a thousand monitors — the largest such effort in the department's history,

according to its own leadership; Senate Democrats fielded a hundred trained staff across nine states; the House's bipartisan observer program had hundreds of staff volunteers. The international monitors who have observed every U.S. election since 2002 were not invited — a first. The comparative record deserves one paragraph. Israel's election commission — paper ballots, hand-signed protocols, an offline central count, and public web posting of the handwritten precinct records — is, in its own official's phrase, structured so that anyone who believes it can be rigged might as well believe the Earth is flat. The United Kingdom ran a pilot in May 2026 that processed three million posts, identified two hundred nineteen political deepfakes from sixty accounts reaching 9.4 million views, and then discovered a regulatory grey zone when a platform refused a polling-day removal. The American system's own 2000 failure — networks calling Florida for the wrong candidate twice in one night, against competitive pressure that one anchor later described, on the record, as including corporate owners urging calls that served their business and political interests — remains the canonical anatomy of how calls fail. In 2026, every major network except the public broadcaster draws its data from the Associated Press while making its own calls; one network applies a 99.5 percent confidence standard. One old tool is gone for good. The bellwether county — Vigo County, Indiana, which picked the presidential winner sixteen straight times from 1956 through 2016; the nineteen counties that held perfect streaks since 1980 — died in 2020 and 2024, when every one of them missed. Zero perfect bellwethers remain, and election-night

analysts have replaced county magic with district-level signals: Virginia's 2nd as the first wave-detector, the suburban Pennsylvania counties, the Texas border. A federal court ordered ballot-processing protections in Pennsylvania counties, where mail ballots cannot be touched before 7 a.m. on Election Day; Michigan counts late into the night; California accepts mail for seven more days. Alaska and Maine run ranked-choice rounds in the weeks after the vote; Georgia holds a December 1 runoff if needed. The calls on election night — which networks make independently against a 99.5 percent confidence standard at one major outlet — will be provisional, and the certified results, the only ones that count, arrive on the calendars this document carries in the research files.

The Ballot Measures

One hundred forty-five statewide measures carry their own money wars. The most consequential: four states vote on abortion — Idaho (a statutory right challenging the nation's most restrictive ban), Nevada (second passage of a constitutional right), Virginia (a constitutional right), and Missouri, uniquely, voting on whether to *repeal* the abortion right its voters passed in 2024, bundled with gender-care restrictions. Alaska votes on repealing ranked-choice voting — with polls showing the repeal failing for a second straight cycle. California's fourteen propositions include a billionaire wealth tax (a union-funded $31 million campaign, opposed by a coalition of billionaires whose contributions exceeded $100 million, with two "countermeasure" propositions designed to nullify it depending on which wins more

yes votes) and a voter-ID measure funded by $29 million led by a Wisconsin billionaire. Ohio votes to constitutionalize photo ID. Multiple states vote to make future initiatives harder to pass — supermajority requirements, single-subject rules — while Montana votes to protect the initiative process itself. Colorado's Democratic Party runs a Clean Campaign Pledge with named badge-holders across its statewide and legislative tickets — the most formalized state-level clean-money program in the documented recordtate-level clean-money program in the country. Montana's "Montana Plan" — Jeff Mangan's Transparent Election Initiative — is the boldest structural fix on any ballot: it would redefine corporate powers to bypass *Citizens United* entirely, drawing a March lawsuit from the Chamber of Commerce and seven industry groups. And a national map underneath: more than thirty-six localities vote on data-center restrictions, the signature-gathering industry charged up to $15 per signature in California, and one 2024 California proposition had functioned openly as a device to bankrupt the organization funding future rent-control measures — the initiative process used as a weapon against the initiative process.

The money, measure by measure, at its final accounting:

California. Proposition 38 (immunology research bonds): roughly $61 million, essentially all from one donor — a spinal-surgery inventor who gave $25 million personally, routed $21.2 million through his foundation, and saw a second billionaire add $5 million. Proposition 39 (voter ID): $29.85 million in support — $17 million from a Wisconsin shipping billionaire, $8 million from a travel-company founder — against

$3.29 million from the state Democratic party, $2.5 million from the American Civil Liberties Union's foundation, $2 million from tribal governments, and roughly $4.5 million from unions and executives. Proposition 40 (billionaire wealth tax): $31.76 million from a single union, plus a tech founder's $201,000, against a business coalition exceeding $340 million; two "countermeasure" propositions stood ready to nullify the tax depending on which drew more yes votes. Proposition 4 (public campaign financing): $971,000 — the smallest war chest on the ballot.

Missouri. The abortion-repeal fight totaled $24.2 million to $3.7 million on the campaigns' own filings — and, in the final fortnight, a new anonymous nonprofit delivered $2.9 million to the repeal side.

Alaska. The ranked-choice repeal campaign's registered money was modest — about $264,000 through January — but its pipeline ran out of state: a Wisconsin super PAC funded by the Yass and Uihlein fortunes supplied roughly $200,000. Measure 1, which would make Alaska the thirty-ninth state to limit campaign contributions, carried no comparable war.

The Dakotas. North Dakota's supermajority measure drew $1.6 million in opposition from a national progressive group. South Dakota's ran on $58,000 against $23,000 — the 2022 precedent there, when a Koch network committee spent $836,000 and lost thirty-three to sixty-seven, standing as the reminder that money and outcome are not the same variable.

The signature market underneath. California campaigns paid up to $15 per signature in 2026 — against a 2022 national average near $5 — and the cost structure explains the disparity:

a volunteer-driven measure runs on thousands, a billionaire-driven measure on tens of millions. The remaining measure-level accounting: California's voter-ID campaign's registered support totaled $29.85 million against $9.2 million in opposition; the wealth-tax campaigns for and against combined for more than $50 million in direct committee money, with the business opposition's total exceeding $340 million. Missouri's totals reached $24.2 million to $3.7 million on the filings captured. Alaska's repeal campaign reported $264,000 in-state, with its out-of-state pipeline — $325,000 from one billionaire, $10,000 from another — documented through the Wisconsin super PAC's own disclosures. North Dakota's opposition committee drew $1.6 million. South Dakota's ran on $58,000 against $23,000.

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PART VIII — ELECTION NIGHT AND BEYOND

What this part covers: what happens after the polls close — when results arrive, what can go wrong, who governs the lame-duck months, and the leadership and succession fights the election will set in motion.

Polls close at 6 p.m. Eastern in parts of Indiana and Kentucky and at 1 a.m. in the Aleutian Islands, eleven hours later. The earliest telling numbers arrive from Georgia and North Carolina — two states where Democrats need Senate wins and where Senate control could effectively be decided by 9 p.m. Texas and Iowa close at 8 and 9 p.m. Central; the ranked-choice states will

take days. Historical precedent says the Senate took four days to be called in 2022 and the House took eight. A parallel election nine days before America's may preview the mood: in Brazil's October 4 first round, Flávio Bolsonaro — son of the imprisoned former president, campaigning with his father's image — led Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva 47.03 to 45.16 percent, with the runoff scheduled for October 25 and final polls showing everything from a Bolsonaro lead of two points to an exact tie. American tariffs of up to 37.5 percent on Brazilian goods hang over the vote as the Trump-policy overlay; markets moved on the first-result round. The final week showed a statistical tie. Datafolha's last survey gave Flávio 47 to Lula 46. Atlas-Bloomberg showed the race narrowing week over week. Quaest gave Flávio 50.6 to 49.4 on valid votes, with Lula's rejection falling from 53 to 47 percent after the lone debate that survived the networks' cancellations. And the prediction market's $188 million book — priced at 85 cents for Flávio after the first round — tightened to 77 as the runoff campaign ran, with the margin ladder pricing a win by fewer than four points as the single most likely outcome. The Stanford Freeman Spogli Institute's analysis, published ten days before the vote, framed the stakes as constitutional: Brazil's 1988 balance, strained by two decades of congressional accumulation, faced a new Congress in which the far right and its allies would hold more than half of both chambers, and the winner would appoint four Supreme Court ministers by 2030 — a court-remaking Flávio's campaign explicitly promised. The institute's conclusion: a Bolsonaro victory likely ends the 1988 order; even a Lula victory

carries no guarantee it endures. The result confirmed what the count's arc and the historical pattern both predicted: Flávio Bolsonaro was elected president, extending to eight-for-eight the run of first-round leaders who won Brazil's runoffs. The Bovespa stock index had surged 7.7 percent to a record on the first-round result — the market's preview of the pro-business frame — and the closing week's polls had shown a statistical tie, with the prediction market's $188 million book tightening from 85 to 77 cents as the runoff campaign ran. The stakes the Stanford Freeman Spogli Institute had framed as constitutional — four Supreme Court appointments by 2030 (Fux in 2028, Cármen Lúcia in 2029, Gilmar Mendes in 2030, and Barroso's seat, whose intended nominee the Senate blocked in April) — now moved from warning to governing reality. The Bolsonaro family's victories extended beyond the presidency: Carlos Bolsonaro was elected to the Senate from Santa Catarina with 25.35 percent, and Michelle Bolsonaro and Bia Kicis won in the Federal District. Nikolas Ferreira and Lucas Pavanato were elected the most-voted federal deputies in Brazilian history, with 3.09 million and 3.04 million votes respectively. The governorships delivered the right wave's full sweep: Tarcísio was re-elected in São Paulo with 62.85 percent in the first round, Riedel in Mato Grosso do Sul with 67.3, and Raquel Lyra in Pernambuco with 53.25 — seven states plus the Federal District went to runoffs. The overseas vote, counted separately, went to Lula 52.29 to Flávio's 38.11. The disinformation layer documented the machinery: the MPE's takedown of santinho2026.com (the pre-filled ballot site favoring Flávio), the Federal Police's seizure

of R$789,800 and detention of fifty-nine people by midday on election day, and the machine-replacement rate of 0.28 percent across 499,248 urns — with no manual voting anywhere. The final polls, for the record: Datafolha's last wave gave Flávio 47 to Lula 46; BTG/Nexus gave him 46.5 to 45.9 with 91 percent decided; Quaest gave him 50.6 to 49.4 on valid votes with Lula's rejection falling from 53 to 47 percent after the lone debate that survived the networks' cancellations. And the AI thread's named transaction: Flávio's campaign paid R$600,000 to a company the Diario de Pernambuco described as "capable of affecting elections" — the Brazilian mirror of the American AI-spend layer. The tie rule, never invoked but in the record: an exact tie would have elected Lula. Serbia voted the same day, the same-moment global populism test. The right-momentum narrative arrived as the American closing weekend's backdrop, nine days before the vote that would test the NPR referendum frame. The Stanford warning moved from analysis to governing reality — four Supreme Court appointments by 2030 now his to make — and the right-momentum narrative arrived as the American closing weekend's backdrop, nine days before the vote that would test the NPR referendum frame. The first round's count had begun at 5:32 p.m. with Flávio above 50 percent, compressed as the Northeast's votes arrived after 7 p.m., and settled at 47.03 to 45.16 by 9 p.m. — the arc against which the second round would be read.

What follows the count is its own campaign. Recount windows open under fifty different state laws. Georgia holds a runoff on December 1. The lame-duck session faces a December 11

funding deadline, with a fourth shutdown priced by prediction markets as more likely than not. The crypto bill may return. A debt-limit collision looms as early as February.

In January comes a new Congress — one whose House speaker fight may depend on whether the independent from California offers his vote to either party, and one whose Senate may contain two or three members who pledged to caucus with neither. The leadership elections themselves are unresolved: the Democratic leader faces four freshmen who refused to pledge support; the Republican leader's continuation depends on holding the majority; the House Democratic leader is the strong favorite for speaker if his party wins, with progressive organizations already preparing demands for a narrow majority.

Beyond the gavel fights sits the next race's invisible primary, already audible inside this one. On the Democratic side: a vice-presidential runner-up touring five states in October without announcing anything, a governor who pledged to stand down if she runs, and a field of a dozen names whose 2026 rally appearances double as 2028 auditions. On the Republican side: a vice president with the strongest favorability numbers in his party, and a secretary of state who spent the year quarterbacking two foreign operations. Neither party's succession is settled, and the midterm's victors will shape both. The first public snapshot arrived in the final week: a Saint Anselm poll of New Hampshire's 2028 primary showed Vance and Rubio tied at 38 percent on the Republican side, with Buttigieg at 28 percent leading a twelve-candidate Democratic field.

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PART IX — THE OPEN RECORD

What this part covers: what this document does not know — the facts that did not exist on the day it was written, each marked plainly, so that no reader mistakes an open question for a settled one.

As of October 23, 2026, the following remain open, each documented in its proper place above: Election Day weather; the final forecaster updates; Election Day weather (first look: both major models show most of the country rain-free, no national storm system at ten days, with state detail due when the five-day window opens); the last two weeks of donor disclosures under the forty-eight-hour rule; the outcome of the DHS injunction appeal; the California ballot lawsuit; the final pre-election economic data (October 29–30); final early-vote totals; Montana's post-endorsement polling (no poll was ever fielded); and the unresolved investigations — the Collins file, the Paxton files, the clemency records, the Castro prosecution, the Garcés Pérez case, and the Maxwell transfer question — none of which will conclude before the vote.

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This document claims no outcome. It claims completeness of the record as it stood on the day it was written: 140 research files, every competitive race, every dollar traced, every killing named, every court fight docketed, every claim — true, false, and

unresolved — preserved as evidence of what was claimed.

Compiled October 24, 2026. Sources available in the research archive at /mnt/agents/output/.